The Introduction to the Birth Stories

Jātakanidāna · Toh 32 · Derge Kangyur

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The Introduction to the Birth Stories, known in Sanskrit as the Jātakanidāna and in Tibetan as Kyepa Rab kyi Lengzhi, is a narrative work that sets the stage for the Buddha's tales of his former lives. It opens in the Jeta Grove at Anāthapiṇḍada's park, where the elder Arthadarśin asks the Blessed One to teach the lineage of the buddhas. The compilers then introduce the background of the birth stories in successive stages, beginning with the distant introduction, which traces the long path of a bodhisattva across many ages. The text is Toh 32 in the Kangyur, and it belongs to the broad class of jātaka and narrative literature on the Buddha's past lives and the origins of his awakening.

In the language of India: jātakanidānaṃ. In the language of Tibet: The Introduction to the Birth Stories.

With reverence I pay homage to the noble Three Jewels.

Once, when the Blessed One (the Buddha) was dwelling in the Jeta Grove, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, the great elder Arthadarśin went to the Blessed One. He prostrated, circumambulated him, and sat down to one side. Then he addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable One, I wish to hear the Dharma of the Lineage of the Buddhas (Buddhavaṃsa), the Blessed Ones."

He declared, "Arthadarśin, hold it in mind, and I shall explain." So it is related.

Here the compilers, the arhats of discerning wisdom and peace, set forth a praise of the meaning of the introduction to the birth stories. There is the distant introduction, the intermediate introduction, and the proximate introduction. Having considered these three introductions, this is the praise that one is to hear. First of all, one should understand how these introductions are delimited.

Here, at the feet of Dīpaṃkara, the Great Being made his aspiration. The path from then until he gave up his body as Viśvantara, and up to the Dharma discourse at his birth in the Tuṣita heaven, is called the distant introduction. From his passing from the Tuṣita heaven, through his attaining omniscience at the seat of awakening, up to the Dharma discourse, is called the intermediate introduction. Whatever he entered upon in this place or that, and whatever he attained there, is called the proximate introduction.

Now, what is here called the distant introduction begins four incalculable eons and a hundred thousand eons ago. There was a city called Fearless, and in it there lived a brahmin called Sumati. Both his father and his mother had entered the womb in a good family, and for seven generations of the lineage it was pure, free of any dispute, reproach, or blame from others. He was a man of fine form, lovely to look upon, exceedingly handsome, and of the finest complexion. He did no other work, but studied only the work of a brahmin.

While he was still a youth, both his father and his mother passed away. Then the minister who managed his wealth took the register of riches, opened up the storerooms filled with gold, silver, jewels, pearls, and the like, and said, "Young man, this is your mother's wealth. This is your father's wealth. This is the wealth of your grandfather and great-grandfather. This is the wealth of seven generations of the lineage." He said this so that each portion would be looked after.

The wise Sumati thought, "My father, my grandfather, and the rest took hold of this wealth, yet when they went on to the next world, not one of them carried off even a single gold piece. I must see to it that I carry it with me as I go." Having spoken to the king, he had it proclaimed through the city with music, gave everything as gifts to all the people, and went forth into the going forth of the ascetics.

To make the meaning of this clear, Sumati gave a discourse at this point. Yet this is not all. It was taught without interruption in the Lineage of the Buddhas, and it was further set out bound in verse; but since even so it is hard to understand, I shall explain it here and there with clarifications in the words of the verses.

Beginning four incalculable eons and a hundred thousand eons ago, ten sounds arose without ceasing in that city of Fearless. The Lineage of the Buddhas tells of it:

Four incalculable eons
and a hundred thousand more ago,
a city by the name of Fearless
gladdened all who looked on it.
Ten sounds there never ceased;
it was rich in food and drink.

The ten unceasing sounds are these: the sound of elephants, the sound of horses, the sound of chariots, the sound of music, the sound of mṛdaṅga drums, the sound of vīṇās, the sound of song, the sound of śamya cymbals, the sound of cymbals, and the sound of laughter, drinking, and eating. These ten sounds never ceased. Those sounds are gathered together:

The sound of elephants, the sound of horses,
music, conches, the sound of chariots,
eating and drinking themselves,
and the sound of food and drink.

Having spoken this verse in the Lineage of the Buddhas, it goes on:

The city, complete in all its parts,
had every desire close at hand,
was endowed with the seven precious things,
and was filled with all kinds of people.
Like a perfect city of the gods,
it was the dwelling of the meritorious.
In the city of Fearless
the brahmin called Sumati
amassed many things to enjoy,
much wealth and grain.
A keeper of the inner secret mantras,
he had crossed to the far shore of the three Vedas,
of the characteristics and the itihāsa,
and of the sublime Dharma.

Then one day the wise Sumati sat alone, cross-legged and secluded, on the roof of his finest mansion, and thought: "For the wise, taking up a womb in birth after birth is suffering. Likewise, wherever one is born, the body perishes. I am subject to birth, subject to aging, subject to sickness, and subject to death. Being so, it is right for me to seek the great nirvāṇa, which is free of birth, free of aging, free of sickness, free of suffering, blissful, cool, and like nectar. Surely there must be a single path that leads to nirvāṇa, liberation from existence."

Therefore it is said:

Dwelling alone in solitude,
at that time I thought this way:
"Birth in existence is suffering,

and when the body falls apart,
subject to birth, subject to aging,
subject to sickness, I then
should seek the bliss of the unborn and the deathless,
nirvāṇa, in every way."
"When this foul-smelling body,
filled with every kind of filth,
pointless, with nothing to depend on,
must be cast off as I go,
is there a path to that?" I thought.
"Without effort the path is not found.
I must seek that path,
and I shall be freed from existence," I thought.

Then he reflected further: "Just as for worldly people there is what is called happiness, which stands opposed to suffering, so if there exists an opposite to existence, one can pass into nirvāṇa." He thought further: "Where there is heat, there is the coolness that soothes it. Likewise there must be a nirvāṇa that quenches the fires of attachment and the rest."

He thought further: "Just as there exist blameless, wholesome dharmas that stand as the opposite of evil, so too, since there is birth, tainted with evil and the like, there must also be the nirvāṇa known as the unborn, which brings all births to an end." Therefore it is said:

"Just as, where suffering exists,
what is called happiness exists as well,
so, where craving exists,
the end of existence exists as well.
Just as, if there is heat,
there is coolness as well,
so, if the three fires exist,
nirvāṇa exists as well.
Just as, if evil exists,
virtue too exists,
so, if birth exists,
the unborn too, it is held, exists."

He reflected further: "Suppose a man has fallen into a heap of excrement and sees from far off a great lake with lotuses of five colors. He ought to make his way there by whatever path he can and enter that lake. If he does not take the path to it, that is not the fault of the great lake. Likewise, there is the great lake of deathless nirvāṇa, which washes away the stains of the afflictions. If one does not enter it, that is not the fault of the great lake of deathless nirvāṇa.

"Again, suppose a man is surrounded by robbers and there is a path by which he can escape. If he does not flee quickly, that is not the fault of the path; it is the fault of the man. Likewise, there is a path to peaceful nirvāṇa for a man who is surrounded and held captive by the afflictions. If he does not seek that path, that is not the fault of the path; it is the fault of the person.

"Suppose a man is tormented by illness and there is a physician who cures illness. If he does not go to where that physician is and seek him out, that is not the fault of the physician; it is the fault of the patient. Likewise, for a man tormented by the illness of the afflictions there is one supremely skilled in pacifying the afflictions. If he does not seek out that teacher, that is the man's fault, not the fault of the teacher who overcomes the afflictions." Therefore it is said:

"Just as when a man smeared with filth,
though he sees a brimming lake,
does not go into that lake,
that is not the fault of the lake,
so, when there is a lake of nectar
that washes away the stain of the afflictions,
if one does not go into that lake,
it is not the fault of the lake of nectar.
Just as when one is surrounded by robbers
and there is a road on which to go,
if the man does not flee,
that is not the fault of the road,
so, when one is surrounded by afflictions
and there is the path of peace,
if one does not set out on that path,
it is not the fault of the path of peace.
Just as when a man tormented by illness
has someone who can treat him,

yet does not have his illness cured,
that is not the fault of the physician,
so, when one is tormented by the illness
of the afflictions and is suffering,
if one does not seek a teacher,
the fault is not the teacher's."

He reflected further: "When something filthy is tied around the neck of a man adorned with ornaments, he throws it off and goes on his way at ease. In the same way I too should give up this impure body and, without a backward glance, enter the city of nirvāṇa.

"Again, when men and women have relieved themselves at the latrine, they do not put the excrement into a vessel and carry it away. In disgust they leave it behind without a backward glance and go. In the same way I too should cast off the impure body and the rest without a backward glance and enter the city of deathless nirvāṇa.

"Again, boatmen abandon leaking boats without a backward glance and go on. In the same way I too should cast off this body, from whose nine wound-like openings things flow out, and without a backward glance enter the city of nirvāṇa.

"Again, suppose a man has taken all kinds of jewels and is traveling along the road in the company of robbers. Fearing that his jewels will be lost, he leaves them behind and takes a good road. In the same way, this body full of many impurities is like a robber who steals jewels. If I indulge this craving, I fear I shall lose the jewel of the wholesome dharmas of the noble path. Therefore I should cast off this robber-like body and enter the city of nirvāṇa." Therefore it is said:

"Just as when a man has something foul-smelling
tied around his neck, he is sickened,
but if he casts it off and goes,
he is no longer sickened and goes at ease,
just so, to cast off this foul-smelling body,
filled with all manner of things,
and go on one's way
is to leave the worthless without a backward glance.
Just as at the latrine

men and women relieve themselves,
and leaving it behind they go,
leaving the worthless without a backward glance,
so this body of mine as well,
filled with all kinds of impurity,
I too shall cast off and go,
just as one leaves the latrine.
Just as when a boat springs a leak
the water comes flowing in,
and the boatman abandons it,
leaving the worthless without a backward glance,
so this body of mine as well,
with its nine openings, is impermanent;
when I cast it off and go,
it is as when the boatman abandons his boat.
Just as a man traveling with robbers
and carrying his wealth,
when he sees the danger to the wealth he carries,
leaves the place of danger and goes on,
just so this body
is like a great robber;
when one casts it off here and goes,
the practice of virtue is free of fear."

In the same way, the wise Sumati, by means of these various examples, reflected on the meaning of the benefits. In his own home he gave a great gift of his immeasurable heaps of wealth, as described before, to the destitute and others. Having abandoned the desire for wealth and the desire that belongs to the afflictions, he went outside the city of Fearless, and alone he took refuge in the Himalayan mountain called Dharma Mountain. There he made a leaf hut and a walking path, with the five faults turned away and abandoned. So that he might, with his mind first settled in equipoise, take up the power of the higher knowledges endowed with eight qualities, he stayed there. He cast off the garment he wore, which had nine faults, and put on a garment of strips of bark, which has twelve qualities. He went forth in the going forth of a sage, and having gone forth, he left that leaf hut, which had eight faults, and settled at the foot of a tree, which has ten qualities. Having given up all riches, he

lived eating the choicest fruits of the trees. In that place he practiced austerities, keeping to his walking path. Within seven days, right there, he entered the eight attainments and obtained the five higher knowledges. Thus, by striving for that aim, he obtained the power of the higher knowledges.

Therefore it was said:

Just as I had resolved,
I gave wealth of many hundreds of koṭis
To those with protectors and those without,
And went near to the Himalaya.
Not far from the Himalaya,
On what is called Dharma Mountain,
There I made my firm abode,
And built a leaf hut well.
There I made a walking path,
Wholly free of the five faults,
Truly endowed with the eight qualities;
I possessed the power of higher knowledge.
The garment that had nine faults
I cast away right there,
And put on a garment of bark strips,
Which has twelve qualities.
The leaf hut that had eight faults
I abandoned, and then
I settled at the foot of a tree,
Which has ten qualities.
Grain that is plowed and sown
I gave up entirely,
And first I ate the choicest fruits,
Which possess every quality.
There, having practiced austerities,
In the places where I sat and walked,
Within seven days alone
I obtained the power of higher knowledge.

Here too, the account tells of the leaf hut where the wise Sumati stayed, and of the walking path, as though he had made them with his own hands. Here too the meaning is this. Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, saw that the Great Being had come out from within the Himalaya and was coming that day to

Dharma Mountain. He said to the god Viśvakarman, "This wise Sumati has set out, wishing to go forth. Make dwelling places for him!" Hearing his words, Viśvakarman made a delightful dwelling: a cave, a fine leaf hut, and a walking path.

And the Blessed One (the Buddha), because what he had then reflected on and cultivated had come to completion, said for that reason:

Śāriputra, on that Dharma Mountain
I made a good dwelling,
Furnished with a fine leaf hut.
Walking and staying there,
I was wholly free of the five faults.

So he said. What are the five faults of a walking path? Ground that is hard and uneven; trees with rough trunks inside it; dense thicket; being too narrow; and being too wide.

When one walks back and forth on a patch of hard and uneven ground, blisters arise on the feet, the mind does not rest one-pointedly, and the work of practice is not accomplished. Walking on level and smooth ground is pleasant, and the work of practice is fulfilled. Therefore a patch of hard and uneven ground should be understood as the first fault.

When there are trees in the middle, inside, or at the end of the walking path, one comes along heedlessly while walking and strikes one's forehead and head. This harm from trees inside is the second.

When the walking path is made in a dense thicket of grass, creepers and the like, in the black of darkness creatures such as snakes are trodden underfoot and die, or they bite with their fangs and do one harm. This is the third fault, that of dense thicket.

If the walking path is made at a very narrow spot, a path along an edge one cubit or half a cubit wide, one cuts oneself on the inside, and one's nails or toes get broken. This is the fourth fault, that of being too narrow.

When one walks on a walking path that is too wide, the mind becomes distracted and does not attain one-pointed stability. This is the fifth fault, that of being too wide.

As for the dimensions of the walking path, it is fitting for it to be half a cubit in depth, about one cubit on either side, and sixty cubits in length, with a smooth and level floor, spacious and covered with sand. It is fitting to make it like the

walking path of the great elder Mahendra, bright as a lamp, of the kind found at a stupa. Therefore it was said: "There a walking path should be made, and the five faults should be avoided."

Endowed with the eight qualities means endowed with the eight joys of an ascetic. What are these eight joys of an ascetic? Having no desire to possess wealth and grain; having no desire beyond blameless almsfood; having no desire to go seeking food; having no wish that the people of the realm should suffer, as happens when the royal class, prizing wealth, makes the land wretched or levies taxes by the head and the like; having no desire for any of the requisites; having no fear of being robbed by thieves; having no harm from kings, viceroys and ministers; and having no harm when traveling in the four directions. Living there in this way, one is able to experience the eight joys.

Having stayed in this place endowed with the eight qualities, one obtains the power of the higher knowledges. Then, dwelling there, one performs the kasiṇa practices in order to generate the higher knowledges and the meditative attainments, and, undertaking impermanence, suffering and insight, one attains that state. Having taken up the power of insight, by dwelling in this way one is able to take up its power. Thus, dwelling there and making the power of insight conducive to its higher knowledge is the purpose for which the hut was made.

"There I discarded the garment possessed of nine faults": this refers to all the things described here earlier, one after another. At that time the small chamber, the large chamber, the walkway and the rest were each adorned. With its groves of flowers, fruit and trees that delight the mind, as pleasing to the thoughts as water, with no fierce wild animals and no flocks of harmful birds, it was made a place for dwelling in deep seclusion. On both sides and in the middle of the adorned walkway there were places for sitting with a backrest to lean against. Within the walkway the ground was level, yellow in color and mixed with stones. Inside the leaf hut were the requisites of an ascetic: a coil of matted hair, a robe of pieces of bark, a triple staff, a water pot, and so on. In the dwelling there was water, water in a large pot, water in a conch, a bowl, a fire house, a vessel with charcoal, firewood, and the like: whatever is fitting for one who goes forth.

Having made all this, he wrote on the wall of the leaf hut, "Whoever wishes to go forth, take these requisites and go forth!" Then the god's son Viśvakarman went back to the world of the gods.

The wise Sumati, following a river along the edge of the Snowy Mountains, the Himalaya, and looking for a place suited to himself, saw at a bend of the river the delightful place emanated by Viśvakarman and given by Śakra (Indra). He went to one end of the length of the walkway, and seeing no footprints he thought, "Renunciants, weary from seeking alms in a distant village, must have come back, entered the leaf hut, and be staying there." When no one came at once, and still no one had come after a long time, he thought, "I must find out." He entered the door of a chamber of the wooden house and went inside. Looking here and there, he read the writing on the great wall and thought, "All these I may regard as my requisites. If I take them, I shall go forth." He discarded his own pair of garments, upper and lower. That is why it is said: "There I discarded the garment."

Dwelling thus, Śāriputra, I discarded that leaf hut and the garment with its nine faults. Moreover, he clearly saw the nine faults. For ascetics who have gone forth, a garment has nine faults: the fault of being hard to obtain; the fault of arousing desire in others; the fault of quickly becoming soiled when used, and once it is soiled it must be washed and dyed; the fault of tearing when used, and when it grows old it must be sewn and patched; the fault of being hard to obtain when one seeks it again; the fault of being unfitting for an ascetic who has gone forth; the fault of being stolen by enemies and the like, so that in one way or another it must be hidden lest enemies and others take it; the fault of becoming an adornment when worn; and the fault of becoming a great burden on the body when carried along.

"A bark garment" means this: at that time, Śāriputra, seeing these nine faults, I discarded the garment. Cutting muñja grass into many pieces and binding and fastening them onto bark is for the purpose of making lower and upper garments of bark.

"Possessed of twelve qualities" means that the bark garment has twelve benefits. Being cheap, beautiful to look at, and allowable: these are the first benefit. Being something one can make with one's own hands is the second. That even when it has become soiled through use it can be washed quickly is the third. That even when it has grown old through use it can be sewn is the fourth. That when one seeks it again it can easily be made is the fifth. Being fitting for an ascetic who has gone forth is the sixth. Being of no use to robbers and thieves is the seventh. Becoming an adornment of asceticism when worn is the eighth. Being light when worn is the ninth. Having few desires with regard to each robe is the tenth. Being blameless for a religious person when it

is obtained is the eleventh. Having no concern even if the bark garment is lost is the twelfth.

"Discarded the leaf hut with its eight faults": how did he discard it? He took a red garment, of the kind of the two finest garments, like a garland of aṇoja flowers, and wore it below, and over it he wore another, a bark garment of yellow color. He put on a leopard-skin mantle with its feet, like a seat of punnāga flowers. He bound the coil of matted hair on his head and, to make the topknot firm, fixed a hard hairpin in it. He placed a water pot the color of coral inside a carrying net like a net of pearls, and took up the pole bent in three places. On one side of that carrying pole he hung the water pot, and on the two sides the hook, the bamboo basket, the triple staff and so on. Carrying them as a load on his shoulder and holding a walking staff in his right hand, he came out of the leaf hut and walked back and forth on the great walkway, sixty cubits long. Looking at his own attire, he thought, "I have completely fulfilled my wish. I have beautifully gone forth. Praised and extolled by heroic beings such as buddhas and pratyekabuddhas, this thing called going forth: abandoning the bonds of the household, I have truly gone out, and having heard of the supreme going forth, I have taken up the way of the śramaṇa. I have obtained the fruit of happiness." And joy arose in him.

Gently setting his load on the ground, he sat like a golden statue on the yellow stone in the middle of the walkway. When the daytime had passed, in the evening he stayed inside the leaf hut and lay down on his side on a fine wooden bed.

With the breeze brushing his body, he rose in the last part of the night and reflected on his own situation: "Having seen the faults of the household life, I gave up the enjoyment of ambrosia and boundless fame, and went forth in order to dwell in the forest and seek renunciation. If from now on I were to give up solitude for thoughts of careless conduct, I would be devoured by the flies of wrong ways; so now it is right for me to cast off what passes for my solitude. I saw the household life as full of entanglements and left it. Yet this pleasing leaf hut has its floor well plastered in yellow, walls white as silver, and a roof of leaves red as the color of a pigeon's feet. Lying down and sitting on a wooden bench of many colors, looking so comfortable: I see all this as very much like the wealth of a householder."

Looking at the faults of the leaf hut, he saw eight faults. The eight faults of making use of a leaf hut are these. Much timber requires much wealth, and

one must gather it, build the house, and search for materials: that is the first fault. Grass and earth wear away, and because they are used up again and again, repairs are needed without end: that is the second fault. What is called a sleeping place befits a senior; because one must then get up at unsuitable times, the mind does not remain one-pointed, and one must go: that is the third fault. It wards off cold and heat, it is soft, and it makes the body comfortable: that is the fourth fault. Once inside the house one can commit evil, and shame is kept away: that is the fifth fault. Guarding it with the thought "It is mine" is the sixth fault. Having a companion, as in "there is a householder," is the seventh fault. Many creatures, such as lice, bedbugs and fleas, come to live there: that is the eighth fault.

Having seen these eight faults, the Great Being abandoned the leaf hut. Therefore it was said:

"The leaf hut that possessed
Eight faults was abandoned, it is said.
If one comes to dwell at the foot of a tree,
One possesses ten good qualities.
Abandoning covered dwellings,
One dwells at the foot of a tree
That possesses ten good qualities."

As for what was said there, these are the ten good qualities. It need not be built: that is the first quality. One obtains it simply by lying down there, without needing to guard it: that is the second. One makes use of it without sweeping, lives there happily, and there is no being roused: that is the third. When one feels shame there is no cover, no evil is done there, and nothing is concealed: that is the fourth. As in a place without a roof, the body never settles down for good: that is the fifth. There is no wish to own it: that is the sixth. Desire for a home is abandoned: that is the seventh. There is no grasping that requires much, no guarding, and no longing when one leaves: that is the eighth. When staying there, there is no delight to cling to: that is the ninth. Dwellings at the foot of a tree are easy to find wherever one goes, and there is no dependence: that is the tenth.

Having seen these ten good qualities, he declared, "I shall dwell beside a tree," and resolved to do such things.

The next day the Great Being went for alms, and as soon as he reached the village the people, filled with great eagerness, gave him alms. When his meal

was over he returned to his dwelling, and having arrived and sat down, he thought: "I did not go forth in order to obtain alms. This so-called tasty food increases the intoxication of pride and the intoxication of a man's desire, and from dependence on the business of eating there comes endless suffering. I shall give up food made from grain that is born of sowing and cultivation, and live on the food of excellent fruits." From then on he took up that practice. Doing so, he strove with bodily hardship, and within seven days the eight attainments and the five superknowledges arose in him. Therefore it was said:

"Grains that are sown and cultivated
He gave up without remainder,
And took to fruits and the like,
Which possess many good qualities.
There he dwelt in austerity,
And in his places of sitting and walking,
Within just seven days,
He gained the power of the superknowledges."

Having thus attained the superknowledges, the ascetic Sumati dwelt in a blissful meditative absorption.

At that time the Teacher called Dīpaṃkara appeared in the world. When he entered the womb, when he was born, when he awakened, and when he turned the wheel of Dharma, all the ten thousand world systems quaked, quaked violently, resounded, and resounded loudly. There were the thirty-two foretokens as well, but because the ascetic Sumati was dwelling in the bliss of meditative absorption, he did not hear those sounds and did not see those foretokens. Therefore it was said:

"Relying on a single seat,
I thus attained accomplishment.
The Victor called Dīpaṃkara,
Guide of the world, appeared.
He entered the womb and was born,
Awakened, and taught the Dharma.
The four signs I did not see;
Through the bliss of dhyāna I did not hear."

At that time Dīpaṃkara, possessor of the ten powers, together with a retinue of four hundred thousand whose defilements were exhausted, traveling on foot in due order for the benefit of beings, came to the city called Delightful

and stayed in the great monastery called Sudarśana. That very Dīpaṃkara, lord of renunciants, who was staying in the city called Delightful, had attained supreme, perfect awakening and turned the supreme wheel of Dharma.

When he had thus traveled gradually on foot for the benefit of beings, come to the city of Delightful, and was staying in the great monastery of Sudarśana, the people living there heard of it. Carrying fresh butter, ghee and the like, medicines, clothing, bedding and the like, and garlands, perfumes and the like, with minds turned toward the Buddha, toward the Dharma and toward the Saṅgha, bowing to them, delighting in them and filled with deep reverence for them, they went before the Teacher. They paid homage, made offerings of perfume and the like, sat down to one side, and listened to the teaching of the Dharma. They invited him as their guest for the following day and then left their places.

Having done this, they set about preparing a great almsgiving for the next day. They adorned the city and adorned the road by which the One with the Ten Powers would come. Wherever the ground had been made uneven by water, they filled it with earth and made the ground level.

It was strewn with sand the color of silver. Flower garlands were laid out and loose flowers were scattered. Banners, flags and the like, made of cloth of many colors, were raised. Plantain trees and full vases were arranged and set in place. At that time the ascetic Sumati rose up from his own dwelling. As he was travelling through the sky above those people, he saw them joyful and delighted. He came down from the sky to the ground, sat to one side, and asked the people, "Meritorious ones, who is adorning these roads?" Therefore it is said:

"Those who dwell at the borders of the land and its regions
Have invited the Tathāgata as their guest.
Having done so, upon this road,
With joyful minds, they work a stretch of the road.
At that time, at that very moment,
I went forth from my own dwelling,
My bark garments stirring in the wind,
And then I travelled through the sky.
With joy, delight and happiness,
I saw the people sweeping the road.
Coming down from the sky,

I at once asked the people:
'Joyful, delighted and happy,
Great crowd of the wise and learned,
As you level the road,
For whose sake do you repair this road?'"

The people said, "Venerable ascetic Sumati, do you not know? Dīpaṃkara, who has the ten powers, has attained perfect, complete buddhahood and has turned the wheel of Dharma. Wandering for the benefit of sentient beings, he has come to our city and is staying in the great monastery Sudarśana, and we have invited that Blessed One as our guest. That is why we are to adorn the road by which the Buddha, the Blessed One, will come."

The ascetic Sumati thought, "Even the mere sound of the word 'buddha' is hard to find in the world. Now that a buddha has come in this way, it is fitting that I, together with these people, adorn the road of the One with Ten Powers." He said to the people, "Since you are adorning these roads for the sake of the Buddha, give me too a place. I too will join you and adorn the road."

They thought, "Excellent!" Knowing that the ascetic Sumati possessed miraculous powers, they considered among themselves a place that had been damaged by water, and gave it to him, saying, "Adorn this place!"

Sumati, rejoicing in the Buddha, thought, "I could adorn this place by miraculous power. Yet however I adorned it that way, my mind would not be satisfied. Today I shall make my body weary." He took earth and poured it into that place.

Before he had finished adorning that stretch, Dīpaṃkara, the great sage with the ten powers, came along the road together with his retinue of four hundred thousand who possessed the six higher knowledges and had exhausted the defilements. The gods were worshipping them with divine perfumes, flower garlands and the like, and resounding with divine songs. The humans were worshipping with human perfumes, flower garlands and the like. Like a lion roaring upon a slab of red arsenic, with the boundless grace of a buddha, he came along the road adorned as if for the gods.

The ascetic Sumati looked with his eyes, and the One with Ten Powers was coming along the adorned road. He was adorned with the thirty-two excellent marks of a great being and lit up by the eighty excellent minor marks, encircled by a halo a fathom wide. Like the color of jewels, like flashes of

lightning of many forms in the expanse of the sky, appearing in season and out of season, pair upon pair, the mass of the Buddha's rays of six colors streamed forth. Seeing him, the very embodiment of supreme form, he thought, "Today it is fitting that I give up my life for the One with Ten Powers. It is not fitting that the Blessed One walk upon mud. As if stepping upon a bridge of jewel planks, may he, together with the four hundred thousand whose defilements are exhausted, step upon my back and go. That will be for my benefit and happiness for a long time."

He loosened his hair, and with his leopard skin and his bark garment upon the black mud, he lay down upon the mud as though it were a bridge of jewel planks. Therefore it is said:

"When I asked them, they answered:
'A buddha who has transcended the world,
The Victor called Dīpaṃkara,
The Guide of the world, has come;
We are repairing the uneven road
And cleaning the road for him.'
When I heard the word 'buddha,'
At once joy arose in me.
Saying, 'Buddha, Buddha,'
Gladness and joy arose.
With a mind in which delight and joy had arisen,
Lingering there, I reflected:
'If I sow a seed here,
It will at once spring up for me.
If you are cleaning for the Buddha,
Give me one spot not yet repaired;
I too will do the cleaning
And repair what is uneven.'
Then, to clean the road,
They gave me one spot not yet repaired.
Thinking, 'Buddha, Buddha,'
I then repaired this road.
Before my spot was finished,
The great sage Dīpaṃkara,
With the four hundred thousand,
Alike endowed with the six higher knowledges,

Stainless, their defilements exhausted,
The Victor came onto the road.
Those who went out to welcome him
Played their music;
Gods and humans rejoiced
And gave the cry, 'Excellent!'
The gods saw the humans,
And the humans too saw the gods;
Both of them joined their palms
And went along with the Tathāgata.
Gods with the music of the gods,
And humans with the music of humans,
Both alike played their music
And went along with the Tathāgata.
Divine mandārava flowers,
Lotuses and pārijātaka flowers
Were scattered in the directions and between them
By the gods abiding in the sky.
campakaṃ śālalaṃ nipaṃ
nāgāpunnāgāketakaṃ
Were scattered upward, in the directions and between them,
By the humans who walk upon the earth."

There I loosened my hair,
And my bark-cloth robe and leopard skin
I spread out upon the mud,
And there I lay face downward.
"Rather than walking through the mud,
Let the buddhas tread upon me;
With their disciples and retinue, I pray, may they pass.
This will be of benefit to me."

Lying on the mud, he raised his eyes once more and gazed in full upon the splendor of the buddha Dīpaṃkara, endowed with the ten powers, and he thought: "If I wished, I could destroy all my afflictions, become the most junior member of the Saṅgha, and enter the city of Ramma. But there is no point in destroying these afflictions in another's guise and attaining nirvāṇa. I shall do just as Dīpaṃkara, endowed with the ten powers, has done. I shall attain

supreme awakening, embark on a ship upon the ocean of saṃsāra, and ferry many beings across to the far shore, and only later attain nirvāṇa. This is what is fitting for me." Then, gathering the eight conditions into one and aspiring with longing for buddhahood, he lay there, watching his mind. Therefore it is said:

Lying there upon the ground,
I reflected in this way:
"If today I wished,
I could destroy my afflictions.
Though even in another's guise
I could realize this Dharma here,
I shall attain omniscience
And become a buddha in the world with its gods.
What use is it for me alone to be freed,
A man who has shown his strength?
Once I have attained omniscience,
I shall truly ferry gods and humans across.
Through this act of dedication of mine,
Having beheld the mighty one,
Once I have attained omniscience,
I shall ferry many beings across.
Cutting the knot of saṃsāra,
Bringing the three realms of existence to an end,
Embarking on the ship of Dharma,
I shall truly ferry gods and humans across."

Moreover, this is for one who seeks buddhahood:

A human body, endowed with the sign of a man,
The cause, and seeing the Teacher,
Going forth, being endowed with qualities,
The act of dedication, and resolve:
When these eight conditions are gathered,
The aspiration fully flourishes.

One who dwells in a human body and seeks buddhahood achieves a perfect seeking. Even if nāgas, garuḍas, or gods seek it, it is not achieved. One who has become human and in whom the sign of a man is present achieves that seeking. A woman, a eunuch, a paṇḍaka, or a hermaphrodite does not achieve

it. Having become a man, it is fully achieved by one who in that very body has what is needed to attain his wish and arhatship, and not by another. One who is endowed with the cause achieves the aim if he seeks it in the presence of a living buddha. After a buddha has passed into parinirvāṇa, one who seeks it before a stūpa or before a bodhi tree does not achieve it. Even when seeking it in the presence of a buddha, it is achieved by one who bears the signs of one gone forth, not by one who bears the signs of a householder. Even among those gone forth, the wish is achieved by one who has attained the five superknowledges and the eight meditative attainments, not by one lacking these qualities. Even when one is endowed with these qualities, it is achieved if one gives up one's living body entirely to the Buddha, and not otherwise. Through such an act of dedication, once the dedication is complete, it is achieved, and not by another. Even with that dedication, it is achieved through great resolve, great enthusiasm, great exertion, and diligence for the sake of the qualities of a buddha, and not by another.

Here, the example of great resolve is this. Suppose the entire circle of the world system were filled with water: if someone could cross to the far side swimming with his own hands, he would attain buddhahood. Or again, suppose the entire circle were filled with dense bamboo: if someone could cross to the far side trampling it with his feet and crushing it to dust, he would be able to attain buddhahood. Or again, suppose the entire circle were completely filled with weapons pointing upward, their blade tips without any gap between them: if someone could cross to the far side treading on them with his feet, he would attain buddhahood. Or again, suppose the circle of the world were completely filled with blazing coals: if someone could cross to the far side treading on them with his feet, he would attain buddhahood. Whoever regards none of these as suffering, but knows, "I shall cross these too, I shall go on, I shall reach the far shore," if he is thus fully endowed with great resolve, enthusiasm, exertion, and diligence, his seeking is achieved, and not that of another.

The ascetic Sumati, gathering once more these eight conditions, made the aspiration longing for buddhahood and lay there. The Blessed One Dīpaṃkara arrived and stood at the head of the ascetic Sumati. As though opening the window of a jeweled lion chamber, he looked out with his utterly clear eyes of five colors and saw the ascetic Sumati lying upon the mud. Thinking, "This ascetic lies here making an aspiration in order to attain buddhahood. Will his seeking be achieved or not?", he examined and investigated with his

knowledge of the future. Realizing, "Four incalculable eons and a hundred thousand more from now, he will become the buddha called Gautama," he made a prophecy in the midst of the assembly, declaring: "Do you see this ascetic of supreme austerity lying upon the mud?"

They replied, "Venerable One, we see him."

He declared, "He lies here intent on attaining buddhahood."

They asked, "Will his seeking be achieved?"

He declared, "When four incalculable eons and a hundred thousand more have passed from now, he will become the buddha called Gautama. He will be born in the city of Kapilavastu. The goddess called Mahāmāyā will be his mother, and the king called Śuddhodana will be his father. His foremost śrāvaka will be the elder Upatiṣya, and his second śrāvaka the elder Kolita.

The Buddha's attendant will be called Ānanda. The foremost of the female śrāvakas will be the elder nun called Kṣemā, and the second of the female śrāvakas will be the elder nun called Utpalavarṇā. When his wisdom has fully ripened, he will make the great renunciation and complete great austerities. He will receive milk-rice at the foot of a nyagrodha tree and eat it on the bank of the Nairañjanā River. He will go to the seat of awakening, and at the foot of the aśvattha tree he will become fully and perfectly awakened. Therefore it is said:

Dīpaṃkara, the knower of the world,
Appeared in the world for the benefit of beings.
Staying beside my head,
He spoke words like these:
"Look at this ascetic,
Who wears the matted locks of supreme austerity.
When many eons have passed,
He will become a buddha in the world.
Born in the delightful city of Kapila,
The Tathāgata will go forth.
Dwelling in a place of austerity,
He will practice austerities exceedingly hard.
At the foot of the ajapāla tree
The Tathāgata will sit,
And there he will receive the milk-rice,
And stay on the bank of the Nairañjanā.

On the bank of the Nairañjanā
The Victor will partake of the milk-rice.
For the sake of the supreme path
He will go to the ground of awakening.
Then, circling around
The unsurpassed seat of awakening,
At the foot of the aśvattha
He of great fame will become a buddha.
The mother who gives him birth
Will be called Māyā.
His father will be called Śuddhodana,
And he will be called Gautama.
With outflows exhausted, free of desire,
Endowed with peaceful, composed minds,
Kolita and Upatiṣya
Will be the foremost of the śrāvakas.
The attendant called Ānanda
Will serve that Victor.
Kṣemā and Utpalavarṇā
Will be the foremost of the female śrāvakas,
Free of outflows, free of desire,
Endowed with peaceful, composed minds.
The tree of awakening of that Blessed One
Is said to be the aśvattha."

Hearing this, the ascetic Sumati was filled with gladness, thinking that what he had sought would be accomplished. When the many people heard the words of Dīpaṃkara, endowed with the ten powers, joy and happiness arose in them because the ascetic Sumati had become the sprout of the seed of a buddha. With minds such as this, they thought: "When a man crosses to the far side of a river and cannot cross from the straight ford, he crosses from the ford lower down. In just this way, if we do not attain the fruit of the path in the teaching of Dīpaṃkara, endowed with the ten powers, then when you become a buddha in the future, as he has said, at that time we will be able to realize the fruit of the path directly in your presence." When they had made this aspiration, Dīpaṃkara, endowed with the ten powers, spoke in praise of the bodhisattva, scattered eight handfuls of flowers over him, circumambulated him, and

departed. The four hundred thousand whose outflows were exhausted also honored the bodhisattva with fragrances and flowers, circumambulated him, and departed. The gods and humans likewise made offerings, bowed, and went away.

When everyone had gone, the bodhisattva rose from the place where he had lain and, in order to contemplate the perfections, sat down cross-legged on a heap of flowers. When the bodhisattva had sat down in this way, the gods throughout the ten thousand world systems cried out, "Excellent!" "Noble ascetic Sumati, the bodhisattvas of the past also sat cross-legged contemplating the perfections, and just as the signs of suffering were seen when they sat in former times, so all those signs have arisen today as well. We know from these that without doubt you will become a buddha. Whoever sees these signs will certainly become a buddha. Therefore you yourself, take up firm and supreme diligence." Thus they offered various praises to the bodhisattva. Therefore it is said:

Having heard his words,
Gods and humans rejoiced
In the peerless great sage:
"This is the sprout of a buddha's seed."
They raised a mighty cry,
They laughed aloud,
And with joined palms they paid homage,
Together with the gods of the ten thousand worlds:
"If we do not gain the fruit in this teaching,
If this protector of the world
Has passed beyond, then in times to come
This one will be before us.
Just as people crossing to the river's far side,
Missing the ford they make for,
Take hold from the ford lower down
And cross to the far side of the great river,
So in just this way shall we:
If we miss this Victor,
Then after much of the future has gone by,
This one will be present before our eyes."
Dīpaṃkara, the knower of the world,
Declared, "So it will be."

Having made my deeds known,
He lifted his right foot.

Those who were there, the Victor's heirs,
All circled around me, keeping me to their right.
Humans, nāgas, and gandharvas
Bowed down and then departed.
When I saw the Guide of the World
Depart together with the Saṅgha,
Then, with a mind joyful and content,
I rose from my seat.
I became happy, truly happy,
Joyful, truly joyful,
And as joy arose in me,
At that time I sat cross-legged.
Seated in the cross-legged posture,
I then thought in this way:
"I have gained mastery in meditative concentration;
I have reached the far shore of wisdom.
In the thousandfold world
There is no sage equal to me.
In the powers of miraculous display none equals me;
Others have not attained such bliss as this."
When I had sat cross-legged,
Those dwelling in more than ten thousand worlds
Proclaimed with a mighty sound:
"Surely you will become a buddha!
The signs that the bodhisattvas of the past
Beheld when they sat cross-legged,
Those very signs are seen today.
Cold has vanished,
Heat is wholly stilled;
Today each of these is seen.
Surely you will become a buddha!
The ten thousand world systems
Have become free of fear toward one another;
Today each of these is seen.

Surely you will become a buddha!
The great winds do not rise,
And the waters turn back from their flow;
Today each of these is seen.
Surely you will become a buddha!
Flowers born on land and born in water
Are blooming everywhere;
Today they are in bloom.
Surely you will become a buddha!
Vines and trees alike
Have at once borne fruit;
All of them are in fruit.
Surely you will become a buddha!
In the sky and on the earth
Jewels are shining forth light;
Since today they shine forth light,
Surely you will attain buddhahood!
Gods and humans
Are sounding forth music;
Since today they make this sound,
Surely you will become a buddha!
Masses of many kinds of flowers
At once rain down;
Since today they are raining down,
Surely you will become a buddha!
The great ocean does not stir,
Yet the ten thousand worlds quake;
Since today these things have come to pass,
Surely you will become a buddha!
The hells of the ten thousand worlds
Are at once free of burning;
Since today they are stilled,
Surely you will become a buddha!
The sun is without stain,
And all the stars are seen;
Since today these are seen,
Surely you will become a buddha!

Though no rain has fallen,
The earth is moist;
Today this has come about on the earth.
Surely you will become a buddha!
The hosts of stars shine brightly;
In the expanse of the sky the stars
Seem to keep company with the moon.
Surely you will become a buddha!
Creatures in holes in the earth and clefts in the mountains
Look upon one another with a single mind;
Since today their minds rejoice,
Surely you will become a buddha!
Among beings there is no discontent;
At once they become joyful;
Since today they are joyful,
Surely you will become a buddha!
At that time illnesses are stilled,
And the sickness of desire is no more;
Since today these things are seen,
Surely you will become a buddha!
At that time attachment is thinned,
And faults and delusion are destroyed;
Since today all these are cast away,
Surely you will become a buddha!
At that time there is no fear;
Since today these things are seen,
By this sign we all know:
Surely you will become a buddha!
The dust above and below turns back;
Today, too, these things are seen.
By this sign we all know:
Surely you will become a buddha!
Foul odors have departed,
And divine fragrance has come;
Since today this fragrance rises,
Surely you will become a buddha!
All the gods are seen,

Leaving aside those of the formless realms;
Since today all these are seen,
Surely you will become a buddha!
All the hells, as many as there are,
At that time are all seen;
Since today they are all seen,
Surely you will become a buddha!
Small doors and mountains:
At that time nothing goes unseen;
Today all is seen as if through open space.
Surely you will become a buddha!
Dwelling in the womb and coming forth from it
Do not occur, even for an instant;
Today each of these is seen.
Surely you will become a buddha!
Make your diligence firm,
And do not turn back from renunciation;
Since we know these things well,
Surely you will become a buddha!"

When the bodhisattva had heard the words of Dīpaṃkara, endowed with the ten powers, and of the gods throughout the ten-thousandfold sphere, great happiness of mind arose in him, he became elated, and he thought: "What is called 'the unfailing word of the buddhas' means that it never turns out otherwise than the buddhas have spoken. Just as a stone thrown into the sky will fall, just as one who is born will die, just as when dawn breaks the sun will rise, just as a lion rising from its lair roars and goes forth, and just as a pregnant woman whose time has fully come will give birth, all these are certain. Certainly, in just the same way, the word of the buddhas is held to be certain and unfailing. Certainly I shall become a buddha."

Therefore it is said:

Having heard the words of the Buddha
And of the ten thousand worlds, both together,
Content, delighted, and overjoyed,
At that time I thought in this way:
"The buddhas do not speak with a double tongue;
The speech of the Victors is unfailing;

The buddhas do not speak otherwise.
Certainly I shall become a buddha.
Just as a stone thrown into the sky
Will surely fall to the ground,
So too the Buddha's word
Will surely come to pass.
Just as all sentient beings
Will surely die,
So too the Buddha's word
Will surely come to pass.
Just as, when the night is spent,
The sun will surely rise,
So too the Buddha's word
Will surely come to pass.
Just as from the lion's lair
The lion's roar is certain,

Just so, the word of the buddhas
Is certain to come true.
Just as a pregnant woman, when her time has come,
Will certainly give birth from her womb,
Just so, the word of the buddhas
Is certain to come true.

"Excellent! I shall become a buddha."

Having made certain of this, he sought the qualities that make a buddha. Where are the qualities by which one becomes a buddha? Are they above, or below, or in the cardinal or intermediate directions? Searching in order throughout the whole realm of phenomena, he saw first the perfection of generosity, which the bodhisattvas of the past had also cultivated and firmly relied upon. Thus I, too, admonished myself: "Wise Sumati, from now on you too should perfect the perfection of generosity. When a water pot is turned upside down, the water does not stay in the pot but flows onto the ground, and it does not return to the pot. In the same way, without regard for wealth, fame, children and wife, or limbs and lesser limbs, give everything to those who ask, whatever each one wants, holding nothing back; then, seated at the foot of the tree of awakening, you will attain buddhahood. First make the perfection of generosity firm and abide in it." Therefore it is said:

The qualities that make a buddha
I searched for here and there,
Above and below and in the ten directions,
As far as the realm of phenomena.
Then, as I searched, I saw
First the perfection of generosity,
The path of the great beings of old,
Which leads to the far shore.
This, for now, you too
Should make firm and take up.
If you wish to attain awakening,
Practice the perfection of generosity.
Just as a pot that is full,
Whenever anyone tips it over,
Pours out its water without remainder,
And none remains inside the pot,
So, when you see those who ask,
Whether high, low, or middling,
You should give to them without reserve,
Like the overturned pot.

Moreover, it should be seen that this is not the only quality that makes a buddha. Searching further, he saw the second, the perfection of moral discipline, and this thought arose in him: "Wise Sumati, ascetic, from now on you should perfect the perfection of moral discipline. For example, just as the creature called the wild yak, heedless of its own life, guards the hair of its tail, so too, if from now on you guard moral discipline without regard for your life, you will attain buddhahood. Make the second, the perfection of moral discipline, firm and abide in it." Therefore it is said:

This alone is not enough;
Other qualities that bring awakening
Must also be sought.
As I searched for the qualities that bring attainment,
At that time I saw
The second, the perfection of moral discipline,
For the great beings of old
Had cultivated it and relied upon it.
For now, this second one

Should be made firm and taken up.
If you wish to attain awakening,
Practice the perfection of moral discipline.
Just as the wild yak, when the hair of its tail
Is caught by anything at all,
Gives up its life without a care,
Cherishing its tail, without anger,
So too, upon the grounds,
Bring moral discipline to perfection,
And always guard your discipline in every way,
As the wild yak guards its tail.

Moreover, it should be seen that this is not the only quality that makes a buddha. Searching further, he saw the third, the perfection of renunciation, and this thought arose in him: "Wise Sumati, ascetic, from now on you should also perfect the perfection of renunciation. A man who has long been kept bound in prison does not desire it; moreover, with his mind in great suffering, he has no wish to remain there. In the same way, you too should regard all births as being bound in prison, and with a mind in great suffering throughout all births, a mind that longs for release, you will make renunciation manifest. If you do this, you will attain buddhahood." He made the perfection of renunciation firm and abode in it. Therefore it is said:

This alone is not enough;
Other qualities that bring awakening
Must also be sought.
As I searched for the qualities that bring attainment,
At that time I saw
The third, the perfection of renunciation,
For the great beings of old
Had cultivated it and relied upon it.
For now, this third one
Should be made firm and taken up.
If you wish to attain awakening,
Practice the perfection of renunciation.
Just as a man bound in prison,
Staying there long and suffering,
Takes no delight in it,

But longs only for swift release,
So you should regard all births
As a prison.
With renunciation going before,
You will be freed from birth.

Moreover, it should be seen that this is not the only quality that makes a buddha. Searching further, he saw the fourth, the perfection of wisdom, and this thought arose in him: "Wise Sumati, ascetic, from now on you should also perfect the perfection of wisdom. Without thinking in terms of low, middling, or great, go to where they dwell and question the wise. A monk going for alms goes to the dwellings of the low and the rest; without skipping over any distinction of family, going for alms in due order, he quickly obtains his measure of food. In the same way, if you too go before all the wise and question them, you will attain buddhahood. Make the fourth, the perfection of wisdom, firm and abide in it!" Therefore it is said:

This alone is not enough;
Other qualities that bring awakening
Must also be sought.
As I searched for the qualities that bring attainment,
At that time I saw
The fourth, the perfection of wisdom,
For the great beings of old
Had cultivated it and relied upon it.

For now, this fourth one
Should be made firm and held fast.
If you wish to attain awakening,
Bring wisdom to perfection.
Just as a monk on his alms round,
Not discriminating among families
Of low, middle, or high standing,
Thereby obtains food to eat,
So you too, at all times,
Should question the learned thoroughly;
Having gone to the perfection of wisdom,
You will attain awakening.

Moreover, one must see that this is not the only quality that makes a buddha. Searching further, he found the fifth, the perfection of diligence, and his mind turned to this: "Wise ascetic Sumati, from now on you must also complete the perfection of diligence. Just as the lion, king of beasts, at all times possesses steadfast diligence, so you too must be steadfast in diligence in all your births. If you exert unflagging diligence, you will attain buddhahood. Make the fifth, the perfection of diligence, firm and abide in it!" Therefore it is said:

This alone is not enough;
Other qualities that lead to awakening
Must also be sought.
Seeking the qualities that bring attainment,
He then saw, as he searched,
The fifth, the perfection of diligence,
Practiced and relied upon
By the great beings of the past.
For now, by this fifth one,
If you wish for supreme awakening,
Bring diligence to perfection;
Make it firm and hold it fast.
Just as the king of beasts,
Whether resting or on the move,
Through unflagging diligence
Keeps his mind ever steadfast,
So you too, at all times,
Make your diligence firm and hold to it;
Having gone to the perfection of diligence,
You will attain awakening.

Moreover, one must see that this is not the only quality that makes a buddha. Searching further, he saw the sixth, the perfection of patience, and his mind turned to this: "Wise ascetic Sumati, from now on you must also complete the perfection of patience. Be patient whether good or ill is done to you. The earth does not become angry when pure and impure things are smeared upon it. It endures, bears them, and remains steadfast, and you should do likewise. In this way, if you too are patient and forbearing whether harm or help is done to you, you will attain buddhahood. Make the sixth, the perfection of patience, firm and abide in it!" Therefore it is said:

This alone is not enough;
Whoever wishes to attain awakening
Must seek other qualities as well.
Seeking the qualities that bring attainment,
He then saw, as he searched,
The sixth, the perfection of patience,
Practiced and relied upon
By the great beings of the past.
For now, by this sixth one,
If you feel no aversion toward that,
You will attain perfect awakening.
Just as the ground,
When smeared with pure and impure,
Endures whatever is poured upon it
And feels no revulsion,
So you, toward all
Who do you help or harm,
Having gone to the perfection of patience,
Will attain perfect awakening.

Moreover, one must see that this is not the only quality that makes a buddha. Searching further, he saw the seventh, the perfection of truth, and his mind turned to this: "Wise ascetic Sumati, from now on you must also complete the perfection of truth. Even if a thunderbolt should fall upon your head, do not knowingly tell a lie for the sake of wealth or the like, under the sway of desire or the like. Aśvinī and the other lunar mansions never at any time abandon their own course to travel by another; they travel only along their own path. In this way, if you too hold to truth and do not lie, you will attain buddhahood. Make the seventh, the perfection of truth, firm and abide in it!" Therefore it is said:

This alone is not enough;
Other qualities that one who wishes for awakening needs
Must also be sought.
Seeking the qualities that bring attainment,
He then saw, as he searched,
The seventh, the perfection of truth,
Practiced and relied upon
By the great beings of the past.

For now, by this seventh one,
Make it firm and abide in it;
By not speaking falsehood there,
Attain perfect awakening.
Just as the one called Aśvinī,
Alike for gods and humans,
Through the seasons of the year
Never travels by another path,
So you too be truthful;
Holding to truth and never straying,
Having gone to the perfection of truth,
You will attain perfect awakening.

Moreover, one must see that this is not the only quality that makes a buddha. Searching further, he saw the eighth, the perfection of resolute determination, and his mind turned to this: "Wise ascetic Sumati, from now on you must also complete the perfection of resolute determination. Whatever you resolve upon, if you hold firmly to that resolve, you will become unwavering. A mountain, though buffeted by wind from every direction, does not tremble and is not moved, but stays in its own place. In this way, if you too become unwavering in your resolves, you will attain buddhahood. Make the eighth, the perfection of resolute determination, firm and abide in it!" Therefore it is said:

This alone is not enough;
Other qualities that one who wishes for awakening needs
Must also be sought.
Seeking the qualities that bring attainment,
He then saw, as he searched,
The eighth, the perfection of determination,
Practiced and relied upon
By the great beings of the past.
For now, by this eighth one,
Make it firm and abide in it;
Because you do not waver in it,
You will attain perfect awakening.
Just as the great crag of a mountain
Stands well, without wavering,
Unmoved by mighty winds,

Remaining in its own place,
So you, in your determination,
Never wavering in anything,
Having gone to the perfection of determination,
Will attain perfect awakening.

Moreover, one must see that this is not the only quality that makes a buddha. Searching further, he saw the ninth, the perfection of loving-kindness, and came into such a state of mind.

"Wise Sumati, ascetic, from now on you must also bring the perfection of loving-kindness to completion. Toward those who help you and those who do not, keep your mind the same. Water is cool alike for sinful people and for virtuous people, and it touches them all equally. In the same way, if your mind holds the same loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, you will attain buddhahood. Make the ninth, the perfection of loving-kindness, firm, and abide in it." Therefore it is said:

It is not this alone;
The dharmas of one who wishes to attain awakening
Must be sought further still.
Seeking the dharma that brings attainment,
At that time, as he searched, he saw
The ninth, the perfection of loving-kindness,
Which the great beings of the past
Practiced and relied upon.
"For now, by this ninth,
Abide in the practice of loving-kindness.
If you wish to attain awakening,
You will become unequaled in loving-kindness.
Just as the thing called water
Is cool alike for virtuous or sinful people,
Touching them all,
And washes away their dust and stains,
So you too must show loving-kindness equally
To those who harm and those who help.
Once you have perfected loving-kindness,
You will attain perfect awakening."

"Consider further that this is not the only dharma that makes a buddha." As he searched further, he saw the tenth, the perfection of equanimity, and this was his thought: "Wise Sumati, ascetic, from now on you must also bring the perfection of equanimity to completion. Whether in happiness or in suffering, remain in the middle. The earth stays neutral even when it is smeared with what is clean or with what is unclean. In the same way, if you too remain in the middle in happiness and suffering, you will attain buddhahood. Make the tenth, the perfection of equanimity, firm, and abide in it." Therefore it is said:

It is not this alone;
The dharmas of one who wishes to attain awakening
Must be sought further still.
Seeking the dharma that brings attainment,
At that time, as he searched, he saw
The tenth, the perfection of equanimity,
For the great beings of the past
Had practiced and relied upon it.
"For now, by this tenth,
Make yourself firm and abide in it.
Like a balance that rests level,
You will attain perfect awakening.
Just as the thing called the earth,
When smeared with what is clean or unclean,
Is unconcerned and even-minded,
And bears it all without anger,
So you too, in happiness and suffering,
At all times, like a balance,
Once you have perfected equanimity,
Will attain perfect awakening."

Then he thought: "These very dharmas in the world are what bring a bodhisattva's awakening to completion and what make a buddha. Apart from the ten perfections there are no others. These ten perfections are not in the sky above, nor in the earth below, nor in the directions such as the east. They dwell within the flesh of one's own heart." Having seen them dwelling, each one, in his heart in this way, he thought, "All of them should be made firm and abided in." He recollected them again and again and made them firm in forward order and in reverse order. He contemplated them starting from the last up to the first; he contemplated them starting from the first up to the last;

he contemplated them starting from the middle out to the first and the last; he considered them starting from the first and the last in to the middle.

Giving up the body completely is called a perfection. Giving up external possessions completely is called a secondary perfection. Giving up life completely is called an ultimate perfection. Thus there are the ten perfections, the ten secondary perfections, and the ten ultimate perfections.

Like sesame oil boiling over a fire, like the great ocean within its encircling ring churned by Meru, the supreme mountain, so he recollected them. When he had recollected the ten perfections, through the splendor of the Dharma this great earth, more than two hundred and forty thousand leagues thick, was pressed down as an elephant's foot crushes reeds. Squeezed like a sugarcane press, it roared aloud as though sounding a great cry. It shook; it shook violently, like a potter's wheel. It spun round and round, like an oil press. Therefore it is said:

These very dharmas of this world,
The dharmas that bring awakening,
Are not above, nor anywhere else.
"Make them firm and set them in the mind."
Unwavering by his very nature,
He recollected these dharmas.
On the ground of the Dharma, the earth,
The thousands of worlds, shook violently.
The earth, though without a mind,
Was squeezed like a sugarcane press,
Turned like an oil press;
Thus the earth shook violently.

As this great earth shook, the people who lived in the city of Ramma could not stay on their feet. Like great trees of the earth shaken by the wind at the end of an eon, they fainted and fell helplessly. Pots and other vessels spilled out, struck against one another with a clatter, and broke into powder and fragments. All the people, terrified, went before the Teacher and asked, "Blessed One, what is this? Are the nāgas here in turmoil, or the bhūtas, or the yakṣas, or the gods, or some others? We do not know. Moreover, harm has come upon this whole great multitude. What is the cause? Has this come from the evil of the world, or has it come from virtue? Please tell us the reasons for these things."

When the Teacher had heard their words, he said, "Do not be afraid. Do not be troubled in the least. In these signs there is no danger for you. Today I prophesied that the wise Sumati, the ascetic, will in the future become a buddha called Gautama. Here he is recollecting the perfections. He is recollecting the perfections and examining them."

"By the splendor of his Dharma, all the ten thousand world systems trembled for an instant and gave forth sound," it is said. Therefore it was said:

As long as the assemblies were there,
gathered closely about the Buddha,
right there, their minds in anguish,
they fainted and lay upon the ground.
Many thousands of jars
and many hundreds of great vessels
were ground there into fine powder,
striking one another and shattering.
Fainting, terrified and afraid,
they fell, their minds harmed and tormented.
All the people gathered as one
and went before Dīpaṃkara.
"Why has this befallen the people of the world?
Is it virtue, or is it evil, or what?
Harm has come upon the whole world.
O One with Eyes, please tell us clearly."
Teaching the Dharma to them all,
the great sage Dīpaṃkara said:
"Do not be afraid; take heart.
The earth here is shaking
because the one I prophesied today
will become a buddha for the people of the world.
He is recalling the Dharma.
He attended the victors of the past,
and because he recalls their teachings,
the entire ground of a buddha,
for that reason the grounds here shake,
ten thousand worlds together with their gods."

The great multitude, having heard the words of the Tathāgata, was filled with joy and contentment. Taking flowers, fragrances and ointments, they came out

of the city of Rammavatī and went before the bodhisattva. They worshiped him with the flowers and the rest, paid homage to him and praised him, and then stayed in that same city of Rammavatī. The bodhisattva, for his part, recalled the ten perfections, made his diligence firm, resolved upon it, and rose from his seat. Therefore it was said:

Having heard the words of the Buddha,
at once, their minds without fear,
all of them came before me
and bowed to me once again.
I contemplated the qualities of a buddha,
and at that time I rose from my seat
and bowed to Dīpaṃkara.

Then, when the bodhisattva rose from his seat, all the gods of the ten thousand worlds assembled and made offerings of divine flowers and fragrances, saying: "Today the noble ascetic Sumati, at the feet of Dīpaṃkara, who possesses the ten powers, has set his aspiration on a great aim. In these he will meet no obstacle, and they will be brought to fulfillment. He will be without fear and without faintheartedness. Not even the slightest illness will arise in your body. Swiftly complete the perfections and accomplish perfect, complete buddhahood! Just as a flowering tree or a fruit tree, in its season, brings its flowers and its fruit to ripeness, so you too, in that time, while holding to your resolve, swiftly perfect the supreme." With such praises and words of auspiciousness they praised him. Having praised him in this way, the gods went each to their own abode.

The bodhisattva too, having heard the praise of the gods and others, thought, "Having completed the ten perfections, I shall attain buddhahood at the end of four incalculable eons and one hundred thousand more." He firmly resolved upon diligence, rose into the sky, and went to the Himalaya. Therefore it was said:

With divine and human flowers,
gods and humans both,
when he had risen from his seat,
gathered flowers alike.
Gods and humans both
praised him, saying, "All is at peace.
You have aspired to the great;

you will attain it just as you wish.
Untimely death has gone far away;
all illnesses have waned.
No obstacle will arise for you;
you will swiftly attain supreme awakening.
Just as, when its season arrives,
a tree bursts into blossom,
so, through you, great hero,
the wisdom of a buddha has flowered.
Just as the perfect buddhas
completed the ten perfections,
so you, great hero,
complete the ten perfections.
Just as the perfect buddhas
fully reached the heart of awakening,
so you, great hero,
complete the awakening of a victor.
Just as the perfect buddhas
turned the wheel of Dharma,
so you, great hero,
turn the wheel of Dharma.
Just as the full moon,
being utterly pure, spreads its light,
so may you, your intention fulfilled,
send forth light through the ten thousand worlds.
The sun, freed from Rāhu,
blazes hot and spreads its rays;
so, having freed the world,
send forth your glorious rays.
Just as the rivers
flow on toward the great ocean,
so the world of gods and humans
will follow after you."
They praised and lauded you.
Abiding in the ten dharmas
and bringing those dharmas to completion,
you then went into the great forest.

Here ends the story of the wise Sumati.

Those who lived in the city of Rammavatī went into the city and gave a great offering to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha. The Teacher taught them the Dharma, and having taught it, established many people in going for refuge. He then departed from the city of Rammavatī and, abiding by his resolve, remained for as long as his life lasted, carrying out all the activities of a buddha. In due course he passed into complete nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa without remainder. Only a little has been said about this here; for all of it, one should understand it in the way it is told in the Lineage of the Buddhas (Buddhavaṃsa). There it is said:

At that time you held a feast of offering
for the guide of the world together with the Saṅgha,
and went for refuge to him,
to the Teacher Dīpaṃkara.
Some, as the Tathāgata had definitively taught,
went for refuge;
some were endowed with the five precepts,
and others with the ten precepts.
To some he gave the going forth
and the four supreme fruits;
to some the incomparable dharmas,
the analytical knowledges, he gave.
Upon some the bull among men bestowed
the supreme excellences as adornment.
Some entered upon the three knowledges
and the six superknowledges.
In this way the great sage gave his counsel
to the multitude of people;
through him the teaching of the Protector of the World
became widespread.

Bull among men, with great shoulders and broad jaw,
Dīpaṃkara, endowed with the major marks,
ferries many people across,
and frees them completely from the lower destinies.
Seeing people who were ready to be freed,
even a hundred thousand yojanas away,

he went to them in a single instant.
Because the great sage knew this,
at the first assembly the Buddha
brought a hundred koṭis to realization.
At the Protector's second assembly,
a hundred thousand came to realization.
When, in the abode of the gods,
the Buddha taught the Dharma,
ninety thousand koṭis
formed the third assembly.
These were the three assemblies
of the Teacher Dīpaṃkara.
With a hundred thousand koṭis
was the first assembly.
Again, on the summit of Nārada,
when the Victor dwelt in solitude,
a hundred koṭis, the stains of defilement exhausted,
were at peace.
As long as the great hero dwelt
on the mountain beautiful to behold,
ninety thousand koṭis
then formed the Sage's retinue.
At that time I
was a restrained one, supreme among ascetics.
I traveled through the sky
and had mastered the five superknowledges.
Ten thousand and twenty thousand
gathered for the Dharma.
The gatherings of one and of two
were countless, beyond number.
Vast, the caravan leader, wise and noble,
was then endowed with miraculous power and complete.
The Blessed One Dīpaṃkara:
his teaching was utterly pure and beautiful.
Four hundred thousand
possessed the six superknowledges and miraculous powers.
Dīpaṃkara, knower of the world,

always had a retinue that was wholly pure.
Those people who at that time
gave up their existence
without attaining their mind's aim
were held in reproach.
Having found the word in full flower,
the arhats were like that:
stainless, their defilements exhausted,
they adorned gods and humans.
The city was called Ramyavatī;
Sumati, of royal lineage;
the mother was Sumatī;
the Teacher was Dīpaṃkara.
Sumaṅgala and Upatiṣya
were the foremost of the śrāvakas.
The one called Svāgata was the attendant
of the Teacher Dīpaṃkara.
Nandā and Sunandā
were the foremost of the women śrāvakas.
That Blessed One's tree of awakening
was called the bimpala.
Eighty cubits in height
was the great sage Dīpaṃkara,
blazing brightly like a tree,
like a sāla tree in full flower.
A hundred thousand years
was the life of that great sage.
For that long he remained,
ferrying many people across.
Having made the light of the Dharma,
he truly freed many people.
Shining like a mass of fire,
he then passed away together with his śrāvakas.
His miraculous power, his fame,
the precious wheels on his feet,
all have entirely vanished,
and all conditioned things are relinquished.

After Dīpaṃkara
came the guide called Kauṇḍinya,
of measureless splendor and boundless fame,
far-reaching in mind and immeasurable.

Again, after the Blessed One Dīpaṃkara, when one incalculable eon had passed, the guide and teacher called Kauṇḍinya appeared. He too had three assemblies of śrāvakas. At the first assembly there were a hundred thousand koṭis. At the second assembly there were a thousand koṭis. At the third assembly there were ninety koṭis. At that time the bodhisattva called Vijaya was a universal monarch. He gave a great offering to the great Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha, numbering a hundred thousand koṭis. The Teacher prophesied that the bodhisattva would become a buddha and taught him the Dharma. Having heard the Teacher's Dharma, he renounced his kingdom and went forth. He trained in the three baskets and developed the eight meditative attainments and the five superknowledges. Without losing his meditative concentration, he was reborn in the world of Brahmā.

Again, the city of that Buddha Kauṇḍinya was Ramyavatī. King Sunanda was his father. Queen Sujātā was his mother. Bhadra and Subhadra were the foremost of the śrāvakas. The one called Anuruddha was the attendant. Tiṣyā and Upatiṣyā were the foremost of the women śrāvakas. His virtuous tree of awakening was the śālya. The height of his body was eighty-eight cubits. The length of his life was a hundred thousand years.

After him, when one incalculable eon had passed, within that very single eon four buddhas appeared: Maṅgala, Sumana, Revata, and Sobhita. The Blessed One Maṅgala had three assemblies of śrāvakas. His first assembly was of a hundred thousand koṭis of monks. At the second there were a thousand koṭis. At the third there were ninety koṭis. The youth called Ānanda, his kinsman on his mother's side, together with a retinue of ninety koṭis, went into the Teacher's presence in order to hear the Dharma. The former stories of that Teacher should be told in their proper order. He and his retinue attained the discriminating knowledges and arhatship. The Teacher, looking at the former conduct of those sons of good family and seeing bowls and robes produced by miraculous power, stretched out his right hand and said, "Come, monks!" At that very instant all of them were holding bowls and robes produced by miraculous power, became like elders of sixty years' standing, and, perfect in their deportment, bowed to the Teacher and became his retinue.

Now, for the other buddhas, the light extended all around to just the measure of their bodies, eighty cubits. The light of this Blessed One's body was not like that; it constantly radiated and remained throughout ten thousand world systems, so that the trees, the earth, the mountains, the oceans and all the remaining places, down to the cooking vessels and the like, were as though overlaid with gold. The length of his life was ninety thousand years. Before his light, the moon, the sun and the rest had no power to shine with their own light. The distinction between night and day was not known. Just as beings go about by day when the sun has risen, so they always went about by the light of the Buddha.

At night people knew day from night by such signs as the closing of flowers, and by the birds calling at dawn.

Why do the other perfectly complete buddhas not have such a light? It is not that they lack it. They too, when they so intend, radiate light through ten thousand world systems or even more. But the Blessed One Maṅgala, through the force of his earlier aspiration, remained with the light of his body pervading the ten thousand world systems without interruption, whereas the light of the others reached only a fathom.

At the time of his bodhisattva conduct he lived as one like Viśvantara. With his son and daughter he dwelt on a mountain like Mount Bhaga. Then a vicious single-fanged yakṣa heard that the great being gave gifts. He approached in the form of a brahmin and asked the great being for his son and daughter. The great being thought, "I will give my son and daughter to the brahmin," and from his joy and contentment the earth, down to its boundary of water, shook. Then the yakṣa sat squatting against the backrest at the end of the walking path, gazing at the great being. When the great being had given him the son and daughter, the yakṣa ate them as one eats radishes, and he looked at the great man. When he opened his mouth, streams of blood poured from it like blazing fire. Even on seeing that mouth, not so much as a hair-tip of displeasure arose in him, and he thought, "My giving was truly excellent." Once more great and supreme joy arose in his body. He made this aspiration: "By the benefit of the merit of giving these to him, may rays of light of this order shine forth in the future." By reason of that aspiration, when he became a buddha, the light of his body shone outward and remained pervading those worlds.

There is also another former deed of his. When he was a bodhisattva he saw the relic stupa of a buddha and thought, "It would be fitting for me to give up my life to the relics of this buddha." Just as one wraps something in cotton cloth, he had his whole body wrapped in cloth, put on a jeweled crown, and filled a golden vessel worth a hundred thousand with ghee. He set a hundred thousand wicks in it, lit the lamps, and placed it on his head. He also set his whole body ablaze, and circumambulated the relic stupa. Thus he strove the whole night until dawn broke, yet not even the pore of a single hair grew hot; it was as if he were sitting in a lotus grove. When one guards this thing called Dharma oneself, one is guarded by Dharma. Therefore it is said:

One who guards in accord with Dharma practices Dharma;
When Dharma delivers, one gains what accords with Dharma;
When it delivers well, that is the benefit of Dharma;
One who practices Dharma does not go to the lower realms.

As the fruit of this deed, the light of that Blessed One's body remained pervading ten thousand world systems.

At that time our bodhisattva had become a brahmin called Suruci. In order to invite the Teacher as his guest he went into his presence. When he had heard a sweet discourse on the Dharma, he made a request: "Venerable one, please come tomorrow for my midday meal."

The Blessed One said, "Brahmin, how many monks do you need?"

He asked, "Venerable one, how many are there in the Saṅgha together with your retinue?"

At that time there was only the Teacher's first assembly. Therefore he said, "There are a hundred thousand koṭis."

He requested, "Venerable one, please come to my house for the midday meal together with your entire retinue," and the Blessed One consented. The brahmin thus made his invitation for the next day.

As he went home he thought, "I am able to offer these monks soup, food, robes and so on. But what about a place for them to stay?"

At that moment the king of the gods, who dwells eighty-four thousand yojanas above, was seated on his stone slab of red wool, and it became warm. Śakra (Indra) thought, "Who has a mind to make me leave this abode of mine?" The lord of the gods looked with his divine eye and saw the great man. He thought, "So the brahmin Suruci has invited the Saṅgha of monks headed by the

Buddha, and he is wondering about a place for them to stay. It is fitting that I too go there and take a share of the merit." He emanated himself in the form of a carpenter, took an adze and an axe, appeared before the great man, and said, "Is there anyone who will pay me wages to do some work?"

The great man looked at him and said, "What work can you do?"

He replied, "There is no craft I do not know. A house, or a mansion, or whatever work there is to be done, I can do that craft."

The bodhisattva said, "Then I have work for you. For tomorrow I have invited the noble one together with a Saṅgha of a hundred koṭis of monks. Can you make a place for them to stay?"

He said, "I will do it. Can you pay me my wages?"

"Son, I can."

He said, "Excellent!" and took it well. He went, looked over a piece of ground, and leveled its surface over an area of twelve or thirteen yojanas in every direction, like the maṇḍala of a blue kasiṇa. Then he gazed at it, thinking, "Let a mansion made of the seven precious substances rise from beneath the earth, just large enough to house them." At once the ground split open and the mansion was formed. On pillars of gold stood capitals of silver, and on them beams of gold. Pillars of jewel had coral; pillars of coral had jewel; pillars of the seven precious substances had capitals of the seven precious substances. Then he gazed at the spaces of the mansion, thinking of hanging nets of bells, and the moment he looked, the nets hung there. Whatever the wind stirred gave forth the sweet sound of five-part music, like the singing of divine songs. He thought of garlands of incense and garlands of flowers hanging in between, and the garlands hung there. He thought of seats and backrests arising from the ground in the number of the Saṅgha of a hundred thousand koṭis of monks, and at once they appeared upon the ground.

He resolved that at every intersection a great water vessel should appear, and those great water vessels appeared. When he had emanated all of this, he went before the brahmin and said, "Noble one, please come here and look at the pavilion. It is fitting that you give me my wages." The Great Being went and looked at the pavilion, and at that very moment Śakra (Indra) vanished. The instant he looked, his whole body was filled with joy in five colors that streamed out without a break.

Then, gazing at the pavilion, he thought to himself: "This pavilion was not built by a human being. Surely, because of my superior intention and my qualities, Śakra's seat grew warm, and Śakra, king of the gods, made this pavilion. In a pavilion such as this, it would not be fitting for me to give gifts for a single day only. I shall give for seven days."

No outer gift, however great, can ever satisfy bodhisattvas. When they cut off their own adorned heads, pluck out their stainless eyes, or cut away the flesh of their hearts and give them, then bodhisattvas delight in having given. As for us bodhisattvas, in the Birth Story of Śibi, every day he gave gifts at the four gates and in the middle of the city, bought at a price of five loads of coins each. Giving those gifts, he was never satisfied. And when Śakra, king of the gods, came in the form of a brahmin and begged for his eyes, he delighted in plucking out his eyes and giving them. His mind did not suffer even by a hair's tip. In the same way, a bodhisattva is never satisfied with the practice of giving.

Therefore the Great Being thought, "It is fitting for me to give gifts for seven days to the Saṅgha of monks numbering a hundred thousand koṭis." Staying in that pavilion, for seven days he gave the gift called gavapāna. This is what is called "the joyful gift": very large vessels, the largest there were, were filled with milk and set upon great stoves, and the milk was boiled over the fire until it was very thick. A little rice was added and cooked, and honey, white powdered sugar and fresh butter were cooked in. This edible milk porridge is called gavapāna. Where humans could not serve it, the gods served it in between. Where the monks could not fit into the space of twelve or thirteen yojanas, the monks stayed there each by their own power.

At the end of the seven days he washed the alms bowls of all the monks and, as medicine, filled the bowls with fresh butter, ghee, honey and water boiled with molasses, and offered them together with the three robes. The junior monks of the Saṅgha received robe cloth worth a hundred thousand, such as a monk receives.

The Teacher rejoiced at this. He considered, "This person has given a great gift in this way. To what end will it come?" He saw that when two incalculable eons and a hundred thousand eons had passed in the future, he would become the buddha called Gautama. Calling the Great Being, he prophesied, "When these ages of yours have passed, you will become the buddha called Gautama."

When the Great Being heard the prophesy, he thought, "Since I am to become a buddha, there is no point in my living in a household. I shall go forth." Being of such a disposition, he abandoned his home as one spits out spittle, and went forth in the presence of the Teacher. Having gone forth, he studied the Buddha's word, developed the superknowledges and the meditative attainments, and at the end of his life was born in the world of Brahmā.

Furthermore, the city of the Blessed One Maṅgala was called Uttara. His father was King Uttara, and his mother was called Uttarā. Sudeva and Dharmasena were his chief śrāvakas. The one called Pālita was his attendant. Śivalī and Aśokā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the nāga tree. His bodily height was eighty-eight cubits. Ninety thousand years was the measure of his lifespan. Having lived ninety thousand years, he passed into nirvāṇa. As soon as the Buddha had passed into nirvāṇa, every direction of the ten thousand world-systems became dark, and the people of all the world-systems raised a great lament.

After Kauṇḍinya came
Maṅgala, guide of the world,
Who dispelled the darkness within the world
And spread the radiance of the light of Dharma.

Thus, having made the ten thousand world-systems pitch dark, he passed into nirvāṇa.

After that Blessed One there appeared the Teacher called Sumanas. He too had three assemblies of śrāvakas. At the first assembly there were a hundred thousand koṭis of monks. At the second assembly, on the Golden Mountain, there were ninety thousand koṭis. At the third there were eighty thousand koṭis.

At that time the Great Being was the nāga king called Atula. He possessed the power of miracles, and when he heard that a buddha had appeared, he took his relatives and friends as his retinue and came forth from the abode of the nāgas. He honored the Blessed One, together with his retinue of a hundred thousand koṭis of monks, with divine music, and offered a great gift. By offering each of them two divine garments, he became established in the moral discipline of going for refuge. That Teacher, too, prophesied that he would become a buddha in the future.

The city of that Blessed One was called Kṣema. The king called Sudatta was his father, and the one called Śrīmatī was his mother. Saraṇa and Bhāvitātman

were his chief śrāvakas. Udayana was his attendant. Soṇā and Upasoṇā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the nāga tree. His bodily height was sixty cubits. The measure of his lifespan was ninety thousand years.

After Maṅgala came
The guide called Sumanas,
Unequaled in all dharmas,
Supreme among all beings.

After him in turn there appeared the one called the Teacher Revata. He had three assemblies; the first assembly was called innumerable.

At the second assembly there were a hundred thousand koṭis of monks, and the same at the third. At that time the bodhisattva was a brahmin called Atideva. Having heard the Teacher explain the Dharma, he took his stand in the moral discipline of going for refuge. He joined his palms above his head and offered the Teacher a hymn of praise on his abandonment of the afflictions, and he honored him with his upper robe. The Teacher then prophesied, "He too will become a buddha."

Further, the city of that Blessed One was called Excellent Revatī. His father was a king called Vipula, and his mother was called Vipulā. Varuṇa and Brahmadeva were his chief śrāvakas. The one called Sambhava was his attendant. Bhadrā and Subhadrā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the nāga tree. His body was eighty cubits tall, and his lifespan was sixty thousand years.

After Sumanas came
the guide called Revata,
unequalled and beyond compare,
who became the supreme Victor without peer.

After him came the Teacher called Śobhita. He had three assemblies: at the first assembly there were a hundred koṭis of monks, at the second ninety koṭis, and at the third eighty koṭis. At that time the bodhisattva was a brahmin called Ajita. Having heard the Teacher teach the Dharma, he took his stand in the moral discipline of going for refuge. He gave a great gift to the community of monks headed by the Buddha, and the Buddha prophesied that he too would become a buddha.

Further, the city of that Blessed One was called Sudharma. His father was King Sudharma, and his mother was called Sudharmā. Asama and Sunetra were his chief śrāvakas. Anoma was his attendant. Nakulā and Sujātā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was again the nāga tree. His body was fifty-eight cubits tall, and his lifespan was ninety thousand years.

After Revata came
the guide called Śobhita,
composed, his mind at peace,
a person without equal or match.

After him, once an incalculable eon had passed, three buddhas appeared within a single eon: Anomadarśin, Padma, and Nārada. The Blessed One Anomadarśin had three assemblies: at the first there were a hundred thousand monks, at the second seven hundred thousand, and at the third six hundred thousand. Then the bodhisattva became a yakṣa, the lord of many hundred thousand koṭis of yakṣas possessed of great miraculous power and might. Hearing that the Blessed One had appeared, he came and gave a great gift to the community of monks headed by the Buddha. The Teacher in turn prophesied, "He will become a buddha in the future."

Moreover, the city of the Blessed One Anomadarśin was called Woolen Cloth. His father was King Yaśavat, and his mother was Yaśodharā. Nisabha and Anoma were his chief śrāvakas. Varuṇa was his attendant. Sundarī and Sumanā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the arjuna tree. His body was fifty-eight cubits tall, and a hundred thousand years was his lifespan.

After Śobhita came
the perfect Buddha, supreme among two-footed beings,
Anomadarśin, of deathless fame,
majestic and far-seeing.

After him came the Teacher called Padma. He too had three assemblies: at the first assembly there were a hundred thousand koṭis of monks, and at the second three hundred thousand. At the third, two hundred thousand monks were dwelling in a great grove in a wilderness far from any village. At that time, while the Tathāgata was staying in that great forest grove, the bodhisattva was born as a lion. The Teacher had entered the absorption of cessation. Seeing him absorbed, the lion's mind was filled with faith; he bowed, circumambulated him, and joy and gladness arose in him. Three times

he roared the lion's roar. For seven days he did not let go of the joy he felt for the Buddha, and sustained by that very joy and happiness he did not go off to his feeding grounds; thinking, "I have given up my life," he stayed there gazing. After seven days the Teacher arose from the absorption of cessation. Looking at the lion, he thought, "Let the community of monks also make his mind gladdened," and said, "He will pay homage to the Saṅgha." He wished, "Let the community of monks come," and at once the monks arrived. The lion's mind became filled with faith in the Saṅgha. The Teacher examined his mind and prophesied, "He will become a buddha in the future."

Further, the city of the Blessed One Padma was called Campaka. His father was King Padma, and his mother was called Asamā. Sāla and Upasāla were his chief śrāvakas. The one called Varuṇa was his attendant. Rādhā and Surādhā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the śoṇa tree. His body was fifty-eight cubits tall, and his lifespan was a thousand years.

After Anomadarśin came
the perfect Buddha, supreme among two-footed beings,
whose name was Padma,
a person without equal or match.

After him came the Teacher called Nārada. He too had three assemblies: at the first assembly there were a hundred thousand koṭis of monks, at the second nine million koṭis, and at the third eighty koṭis and a hundred thousand. At that time the bodhisattva went forth as a sage and gained mastery of the five superknowledges and the eight meditative attainments. He gave a great gift to the community of monks headed by the Buddha and honored him with red sandalwood, and the Buddha prophesied that he too would become a buddha in the future.

The city of that Blessed One was called Dhanyavatī. His father was a king called Sumati, and his mother was called Anomā. Bhadraśāla and Jitamitra were his chief śrāvakas. Vāsiṣṭha was his attendant. Uttarā and Phalgunī were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the great śoṇa tree. His body was eighty-eight cubits tall, and his lifespan was ninety thousand years.

After Padma,
the perfect Buddha, supreme among two-footed beings,
was the one whose name was Nārada,
a person without peer, without equal.

After the buddha Nārada, a hundred thousand eons before the present, the buddha called Padmottara appeared, alone in his eon. He too held three assemblies of śrāvakas. At the first assembly there were a hundred thousand koṭis of monks. At the second, on Mount Vaibhāra, there were ninety thousand koṭis. At the third there were eighty thousand koṭis. At that time the bodhisattva was born in a great kingdom as one called Jaṭila. He made a great offering, together with robes, to the Saṅgha headed by the Buddha. That buddha in turn prophesied that in the future he would become a buddha. Moreover, in the time of the Blessed One Padmottara even the name "non-Buddhist" (tīrthika) did not exist. All gods and humans went for refuge to the Buddha. His city was called Endowed with Clarity. His father was the king called Ānanda. His mother was called Excellent One. Divine Eye and Sujāta were the chief śrāvakas. The one called Sumanas was the attendant. Amitā and Asamā were the chief female śrāvakas. The tree of awakening was a sāla tree. His body was eighty-eight cubits tall. The light of his body spread twelve yojanas all around. His lifespan was a hundred thousand years.

Right after Nārada
came the perfect Buddha, supreme among two-footed beings,
the Victor called Padmottara,
unshakable like the ocean.

Three thousand eons after him, the ones called Sumati and Sujāta became two buddhas within a single eon. Sumati too held three assemblies of śrāvakas. At the first assembly, in the city called Sudarśana, there were a hundred koṭis of those whose defilements were exhausted. At the second assembly there were ninety koṭis. At the third assembly there were eighty koṭis. At that time the bodhisattva was a brahmin youth called Supreme Body. He distributed eighty koṭis of wealth that had been buried as treasure beneath the ground and offered a great gift to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha. Having listened to the Dharma, he abided in the vow of refuge. He went forth and went into the forest. He too was prophesied to become a buddha in the future. The city of the Blessed One Sumati was called Sudarśana. His father was the king called Sudatta. His mother was called Sudattā. Niḥsaraṇa and Sarvakāma were the chief śrāvakas. The one called Sāgara was the attendant. Rāmā and Surāmā were the chief female śrāvakas. The tree of awakening was a great nīpa tree. His body was eighty-eight cubits tall. His lifespan was ninety thousand years.

After Padmottara
came the guide called Sumati,
of fierce radiance and far-reaching mind,
the Sage supreme in all the world.

After him the Teacher called Sujāta appeared. He too held three assemblies of śrāvakas. At the first assembly there were sixty thousand monks. At the second there were fifty thousand. At the third there were forty thousand. At that time the bodhisattva was a wheel-turning king. Hearing that a buddha had appeared, he went to him and heard the Dharma. Then he gave to the Saṅgha headed by the Buddha his kingdom of the four great continents together with the seven precious things, and went forth in the presence of the Teacher. Taking the wealth produced in all the inhabited lands, he completed monasteries and offered a great gift to the monks headed by the Buddha. The Teacher in turn prophesied that he would become a buddha in the future. The city of that Blessed One was called Sumaṅgala. His father was the king called Ugra. His mother was called Prabhāvatī. Sudarśana and Deva were the chief śrāvakas. Nārada was the attendant. Nāgā and Nāgamālā were the chief female śrāvakas. The tree of awakening was a great bamboo. Inside it was hollow, with a narrow cavity. Its trunk was dense. Above, its branches bore leaves as beautiful as a peacock's parasol. The body of that Blessed One was fifty cubits tall. His lifespan was ninety thousand years.

In that very Essence Eon
came the guide called Sujāta,
with a bull's shoulders and a lion's jaw,
of far-reaching mind and beyond measure.

After him, a hundred and eighteen eons before the present, three buddhas appeared in a single eon: Priyadarśin, Arthadarśin, and Dharmadarśin. Priyadarśin too held three assemblies of śrāvakas. At the first assembly there were a hundred thousand koṭis of monks. At the second there were ninety koṭis. At the third there were eighty koṭis. At that time the bodhisattva was a brahmin youth called Kāśyapa. Having mastered the three Vedas, he heard the Teacher teach the Dharma. He gave away a hundred thousand koṭis of wealth, built a monastery for the Saṅgha, went for refuge, and abided in moral discipline. Then the Teacher prophesied, "After a hundred and eighteen eons have passed, he will become a buddha." The city of that Blessed One was called Endowed with Mind. His father was the king called Sudatta. His mother was called Candrā. Pālita and Sarvadarśin were the chief śrāvakas. Śobhita

was the attendant. Sujātā and Dharmadinnā were the chief female śrāvakas. The tree of awakening was a priyaṅgu tree. His body was eighty cubits tall. His lifespan was ninety thousand years.

After Sujāta
came the self-arisen guide of the world,
equal to the unequaled, of far-reaching mind,
Priyadarśin of great renown.

After him the Blessed One called Arthadarśin appeared.

He too had three assemblies of śrāvakas. At the first assembly there were nine million eight hundred thousand monks. At the second there were eight million eight hundred thousand, and the same at the third. At that time the bodhisattva was an ascetic called Susīma, endowed with miraculous powers. He took a parasol of mandārava flowers from the world of the gods and worshiped the Teacher with it, and that Teacher also gave him a prophecy. The city of that Blessed One (the Buddha) was called Śobhana. His father was a king called Sāgara, and his mother was Sudarśanā. Śānta and Upaśānta were his foremost śrāvakas. Abhaya was his attendant. Dharmā and Sudharmā were his foremost women śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the campaka tree. His body was eighty-eight cubits tall. The radiance of his body encircled him on every side and always extended a full yojana. His lifespan was one hundred thousand years.

In that very essence eon,
Arthadarśin, bull among men,
dispelled the great darkness
and attained supreme, perfect awakening.

After him there appeared a teacher called Dharmadarśin. He too had three assemblies of śrāvakas. At the first assembly there were a hundred koṭis of monks, at the second seventy koṭis, and at the third eighty koṭis. At that time the bodhisattva was Śakra (Indra), king of the gods. He worshiped him with divine fragrances, flowers and divine music, and he too was prophesied to become a buddha in the future. The city of that Blessed One was called Śaraṇa. His father was called King Śaraṇa, and his mother was called Sunandā. Padma and Puṣyadeva were his foremost śrāvakas. The one called Sunetra was his attendant. Those called Kṣemā and Satyā were his foremost women śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the bimbajāla tree. His body was eighty cubits tall. His lifespan was one hundred thousand years.

In that very essence eon,
Dharmadarśin of great renown
destroyed the great darkness
and brought light to the world with its gods.

After him, counting from ninety-four eons before now, there appeared in one eon a single buddha called Siddhārtha. He too had three assemblies of śrāvakas. At the first assembly there were a hundred thousand koṭis of monks, at the second ninety koṭis, and at the third eighty koṭis. At that time the bodhisattva was an ascetic called Sumaṅgala, of fierce splendor and endowed with the power of the higher knowledges. He took the fruit of a great jambu tree and offered it to the Tathāgata. The Teacher ate that fruit and prophesied, "Ninety-four eons from now, in the future, this bodhisattva will become a buddha." The city of that Blessed One was called Vaibhāra. His father was a king called Jayasena, and his mother was called Well-Become. Plentiful and Sumitra were his foremost śrāvakas. Revata was his attendant. Peace-Bringer and Steadfast were his foremost women śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the karṇika tree. His body was sixty cubits tall. His lifespan was one hundred thousand years.

Right after Dharmadarśin,
Siddhārtha, guide of the world,
destroyed all darkness,
like the sun risen in the sky.

After him, counting from ninety-two hundred thousand eons before now, there appeared in one eon two buddhas, called Tiṣya and Puṣya. The Blessed One Tiṣya also had three assemblies. At the first assembly there were a hundred koṭis of monks, at the second ninety koṭis, and at the third eighty koṭis. At that time the bodhisattva was a kṣatriya called Sujāta, of great wealth and great fame. He went forth in the going-forth of ascetics and came to possess miraculous powers. Hearing that a buddha had appeared, he took divine mandārava flowers, lotuses and pārijāta flowers, worshiped the Tathāgata, who had come into the midst of the fourfold assembly, and spread a canopy of flowers across the sky. That buddha prophesied, "Ninety-two eons from now, he will awaken." The city of that Blessed One was called Kṣemā. His father was of royal lineage, a king called Faithful Folk, and his mother was called Padmā. Brahmadeva and Udaya were his foremost śrāvakas. Truly Supreme was his attendant. Swift and Sudattā were his foremost women śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the asana tree. His body was sixty cubits tall. His lifespan was

one hundred thousand years.

Right after Siddhārtha came
a person without peer or equal,
of boundless moral discipline, of infinite renown:
Tiṣya, supreme guide of the world.

After him there appeared a teacher called Puṣya. He too had three assemblies. At the first assembly there were six million monks, at the second five million, and at the third three million two hundred thousand. At that time the bodhisattva was a kṣatriya called Vijaya. He gave up the royal lineage of a great king and went forth in the presence of the Teacher. He trained in the three baskets of scripture, taught and explained the true Dharma to many people, and brought the perfection of moral discipline to completion. He too was likewise prophesied: "He will awaken." The city of that Blessed One was called Kāśikā. His father was a king called Jayasena, and his mother was called Śrīmatī. Surakṣita and Dharmasena were his foremost śrāvakas. Fearful was his attendant. Mālā and Upamālā were his foremost women śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the myrobalan tree. His body was fifty-eight cubits tall. His lifespan was ninety thousand years.

In that very essence eon
he became the unsurpassed Teacher,
equal to the unequalled, beyond compare,
the guide of the supreme world.

After him, ninety-one eons before now, there appeared the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He too had three assemblies. At the first assembly there were nine million eight hundred thousand monks.

In the second there were one hundred thousand, and in the third eighty thousand. At that time the bodhisattva was an incomparable nāga king, endowed with miraculous power and great might, and he offered the Blessed One a great golden banner adorned with the seven kinds of precious things. That Blessed One prophesied of him, "Ninety-one eons from now he will become a buddha."

The city of that Blessed One was called Bandhumatī. His father was King Bandhuma, and his mother was Bandhumatī. Khaṇḍa and Tiṣya were his chief śrāvakas. Aśoka was his attendant. Candrā and Candramitrā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the pāṭali tree. His body was eighty cubits tall. The light of his body always shone out for seven leagues and

stayed so. His lifespan was eighty thousand years.

After Puṣya,
the perfect buddha, supreme among two-legged beings,
was named Vipaśyin;
the one with vision appeared in the world.

After him, thirty-two eons from now, the buddhas called Śikhin and Viśvabhū appeared. Śikhin too had three assemblies of śrāvakas. The first assembly had one hundred thousand monks, the second eight million, and the third one million. At that time the bodhisattva was a king called Lord of Sound. He offered a great gift, together with Dharma robes, to the Saṅgha with the Buddha at its head. He offered elephants, each adorned with the seven kinds of precious things, and then offered allowable requisites piled to the size of the elephants. That Blessed One too prophesied of him, "Thirty-one eons from now he will become a buddha."

Further, the city of that Blessed One was called Aruṇavatī. His father was a king called Aruṇavat, and his mother was called Prabhāvatī. Abhibhū and Sambhava were his chief śrāvakas. Kṣemaṃkara was his attendant. Magilā and Padmā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the puṇḍarīka tree. His body was thirty-seven cubits tall. The light of his body shone out for three leagues and stayed so. His lifespan was thirty-seven thousand years.

After Vipaśyin,
the perfect buddha, supreme among two-legged beings,
was the incomparable Victor Śikhin,
a person without peer, without equal.

After him the buddha called Viśvabhū appeared. He too had three assemblies. The first assembly had eight million monks, the second three million seven hundred thousand, and the third six million. At that time the bodhisattva was a king called Sudarśana. He offered a great gift, together with Dharma robes, to the Saṅgha with the Buddha at its head, and then went forth under him. Endowed with good conduct and good qualities, he held the Buddha Jewel in deep reverence and was filled with joy. The Blessed One prophesied of him too, "Thirty-one eons from now he will become a buddha."

Further, the city of that Blessed One was called Endowed with Mind. His father was a king called Supratiṣṭhita, and his mother was called Yaśovatī. Śroṇa and Uttara were his chief śrāvakas. Upaśānta was his attendant. Mālā and Samālā

were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the sāla tree. His body was sixty cubits tall. His lifespan was sixty thousand years.

In that very same Essence Eon,
the person without peer, without equal,
named Viśvabhū,
that Victor appeared in the world.

After him, in this present eon, four buddhas have appeared: Krakucchanda, Kanakamuni, Kāśyapa, and our own Blessed One.

Further, the Blessed One Krakucchanda had a single assembly of śrāvakas, with forty thousand monks. At that time the bodhisattva was a king called Kṣema. He offered the Saṅgha with the Buddha at its head a gift of alms bowls and Dharma robes, along with eye ointment, medicines, and other things. Having heard the Teacher teach the Dharma, he went forth. The Teacher prophesied of him as well.

Further, the city of that Blessed One Krakucchanda was called Kṣemavatī. His father was a brahmin called Agnidatta, and his mother was the brahmin woman Companion. Vidhura and Sañjīva were his chief śrāvakas. The brahmin Buddhija was his attendant. Sāmā and Campaka were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the great śirīṣa tree. His body was forty cubits tall. His lifespan was forty thousand years.

After Viśvabhū,
the perfect buddha, supreme among two-legged beings,
was named Krakucchanda,
immeasurable, of far-reaching mind.

After him the Teacher called Kanakamuni appeared. He too had a single assembly of śrāvakas, with thirty thousand monks. At that time the bodhisattva was a king called Parvata. Together with a great host of ministers and his retinue, he heard the Dharma taught, invited the Saṅgha of monks with the Buddha at its head as his guests, and offered them a great gift. Then he went before the Teacher and offered alms bowls, Chinese silk, cotton cloth from the land of the city called Radiant, wool, dukūla cloth, and gold-woven silk garments, and he went forth under the Teacher. He too was prophesied to become a buddha.

The city of that Blessed One was called Śobhāvatī. His father was a brahmin called Yakṣa, and his mother was a brahmin woman called Uttarā. Bhiyyosa

and Uttara were his chief śrāvakas. Svastika was his attendant. Samudrā and Uttarā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the udumbara tree. His body was twenty cubits tall. His lifespan was thirty thousand years.

After Krakucchanda,
the perfect buddha, supreme among two-legged beings,
was named the Victor Kanakamuni.

the bull among men, the lord of the world.

After him there came the Teacher called Kāśyapa. He too held a single assembly, and in it there were twenty thousand monks. At that time the bodhisattva was a young brahmin called Jyotipāla. He had mastered the three Vedas and was renowned throughout the earth and the sky. He was the friend of the potter Ghaṭīkāra, the maker of pots. Together with the potter, the bodhisattva went into the presence of the Teacher, heard a discourse on the Dharma, and went forth. Rousing great diligence, he trained in the three baskets of scripture, and through his good conduct he adorned the Buddha's teaching. The Teacher, in turn, made a prophecy about him.

The city in which that Blessed One was born was called Vārāṇasī. His father was the brahmin called Brahmadatta. His mother was the brahmin woman called Dhanavatī. Tiṣya and Bhāradvāja were his chief śrāvakas. Sarvamitra was his attendant. Anulā and Uruvelā were his chief female śrāvakas. His tree of awakening was the nyagrodha, the banyan tree. His body was twenty cubits in height. His lifespan was twenty thousand years.

After Kanakamuni
came the perfect Buddha, supreme among two-legged beings,
whose name was the Victor Kāśyapa,
the Dharma king, the maker of light.

Moreover, in the eon in which Dīpaṃkara, endowed with the ten powers, appeared, three other buddhas also appeared, but in their presence the bodhisattva received no prophecy. For that reason they have not been shown here either. Yet in order to show all the buddhas from the eon of this account onward, they are set out here:

Tṛṣṇaṃkara and Medhaṃkara,
and then there was Śaraṇaṃkara;
Dīpaṃkara, the perfect Buddha;

Kauṇḍinya, supreme among two-legged beings;
Maṅgala and Sumanas,
the sage Revata, and Śobhita;
Anomadarśin and Padma,
Nārada and Padmottara;
Sumedha and Sujāta,
the greatly renowned Priyadarśin;
Arthadarśin and Dharmadarśin,
Siddhārtha, the guide of the world;
Tiṣya, who became a perfect Buddha;
Vipaśyin, Śikhin, Viśvabhū;
Krakucchanda and Kanakamuni,
and the guide called Kāśyapa.
Those perfectly complete buddhas,
resting in meditative equipoise, with attachment destroyed,
arose like the hundred-rayed sun,
utterly vanquished the great darkness,
blazed like masses of fire,
and passed into nirvāṇa together with their śrāvakas.

Our bodhisattva made aspirations in the presence of the twenty-four buddhas beginning with Dīpaṃkara, and has come through four incalculable eons and a hundred thousand more. Moreover, after that Blessed One Kāśyapa there is no other buddha apart from this perfectly complete Buddha; and so he obtained prophecies in the presence of the twenty-four buddhas beginning with Dīpaṃkara.

Moreover, that bodhisattva:

Human birth, possession of the male sign,
the cause, and the sight of the Teacher,
going forth, possession of good qualities,
the act of dedication, and resolve:
when these eight factors come together,
aspirations are perfectly fulfilled.

Having brought these eight factors together, he made his aspiration at the feet of Dīpaṃkara, and an eagerness arose in him to search everywhere for these qualities that make a buddha.

Because he saw those he had sought,
first came the perfection of generosity.

Through the perfection of generosity and the rest he brought to completion the qualities by which buddhahood is attained, and so came to be in the person of Viśvantara. Having come thus far, the bodhisattvas praised the benefits of the aspiration of those who have done these things:

Thus, endowed with all the factors,
men certain of awakening,
though wandering long in saṃsāra
even for a hundred koṭis of eons,
are not born in Avīci hell.
Likewise, in the regions between the worlds,
hunger, thirst, craving and burning,
and the severing of all their limbs do not befall them.
They do not become tiny creatures,
and they are not born in the lower realms.
When they are born as human beings,
they are not blind from birth,
nor do they become deaf,
nor mute, nor lame on one side.
They are not born as women,
nor as eunuchs, neuters or hermaphrodites,
nor are they born in the borderlands.
They are men certain of awakening.
Free from the deeds of immediate retribution,
pure in all their spheres of activity,
they do not rely on wrong views,
for they see the working of karma.
Even while dwelling in the heavens,
they are not born among the gods without perception.
Among the gods of the Pure Abodes
there is no cause, not even in name, for their birth.
Holy beings, their minds set on renunciation,
are bound neither to existence nor to nonexistence.
They who travel for the sake of the world
bring all the perfections to completion.

Having obtained these benefits in full measure, he thereby brings the perfections to completion. In the time of the brahmin Akīrti, in the time of the brahmin Śaṅkha, in the time of King Dhanañjaya, in the time of King Mahāsudarśana, in the time of Mahāgovinda, in the time of King Nimi, in the time of Candrakumāra, in the time of Visayha, in the time of the king of the Śibis, and in the time of Viśvantara, he was the very embodiment of the perfection of generosity brought to completion; this is called the immeasurable. Above all, again and again, as the Jātaka of the bodhisattva, the wise hare, says:

Seeing a beggar who had come near,
I gave up my own body entirely.
None is equal to my giving.
This is the perfection of generosity.

Thus, by giving up his body entirely, the perfection of generosity arose that is called the ultimate perfection.

Likewise, in the time of the nāga king Śīlavat, in the time of the nāga king Campeyya, in the time of the nāga king Bhūridatta, in the time of Ṣaḍdanta, the six-tusked king of elephants, and in the time of the youth Alīnaśatru, son of King Jayadiśa, the perfection of moral discipline that arose in its completeness was immeasurable.

Furthermore, in particular, in his Śaṅkhapāla Jātaka it says:

Though I was pierced through with stakes,
and they took up weapons and struck me,
I did not grow angry with the headman's son.
This was my perfection of moral discipline.

Giving up his body completely in this way was the perfection of moral discipline, and what is called the ultimate perfection arose.

Likewise, when he was Prince Somanassa, when he was Prince Hatthipāla, and when he was the sage Ayoghara, the times he gave up a great kingdom and the perfection of renunciation arose in him are beyond measure. Furthermore, in particular, in his Cūḷasutasoma Jātaka it says:

A great kingdom had come into my hands,
yet I cast it off like a gob of spittle.
Though I gave up the kingdom, I had no attachment.
This was my perfection of renunciation.

In this way, giving up his own kingdom with certainty was the perfection of renunciation, and what is called the ultimate perfection arose.

Likewise, when he was the sage Vidhura, when he was the sage Mahāgovinda, when he was the sage Kuddāla, when he was the sage Araka, when he was the wandering ascetic Bodhi, and when he was the sage Mahosadha, the times the perfection of wisdom arose in him in full are beyond measure. Furthermore, in particular, in his Sattubhasta Jātaka, when he was the sage Senaka:

When I searched with wisdom,
I freed the brahmin from his suffering.
There is none equal to me in wisdom.
This was my perfection of wisdom.

His revealing the snake inside the bag was the perfection of wisdom, and what is called the ultimate perfection arose.

Likewise, the times the perfection of diligence arose in him in full are beyond measure. Furthermore, in particular, in his Mahājanaka Jātaka it says:

In the midst of the ocean, its shore unseen,
all the men had perished.
With a mind free of suffering,
this was my perfection of diligence.

What is called the perfection of diligence of crossing the great ocean arose.

In the Khantivādi Jātaka it says:

As though cutting something without mind,
they struck me with a sharp axe,
yet I was not angry with the King of Kāśi.
This was my perfection of patience.

Thus, enduring great suffering as if he were an insentient thing was the perfection of patience, and what is called the ultimate perfection arose.

In the Mahāsutasoma Jātaka it says:

Guarding the word of truth,
I gave up my own life
and set free a hundred kṣatriyas.
This was my perfection of truthfulness.

Thus, guarding the truth even at the cost of his life was the perfection of truthfulness, and what is called the ultimate perfection arose.

In the Jātaka of the Mute and Half-Paralyzed One it says:

I have no need of father and mother,
nor have I need of wealth and fame.
I delight in omniscience,
and therefore I held firm to my vow.

Thus, abandoning all desire for life and holding firm to his vow was the perfection of resolve, and what is called the ultimate perfection arose.

In the Ekarāja Jātaka it says:

There is no one who frightens me,
nor was I afraid of anyone.
Upheld by the power of loving-kindness,
I then delighted in emptiness.

Thus, paying no heed to giving up his life and practicing loving-kindness, that loving-kindness of his was a perfection, and what is called the ultimate perfection arose.

In the Lomahaṃsa Jātaka it says:

I resolved to dwell in the charnel ground,
and made a heap of bones my support.
They came near to where I stayed,
and the forms they showed were not few.

Thus, though the village boys took up stones and the like and struck him, and others honored him with flower garlands, incense and so on, producing pleasure and pain, he set it all aside in equanimity. That was the perfection of equanimity, and what is called the ultimate perfection arose.

These have been given here in brief. Their meaning in full should be taken from the Basket of Conduct (Cariyāpiṭaka).

Having thus fulfilled the perfections, he abode in the person of Viśvantara.

Though the earth is without mind
and knows neither pleasure nor pain,
through the power of my giving
it quaked seven times.

Thus, having performed great merit, such as causing the great earth to quake, at the end of his life he died, passed on, and was born in the Tuṣita heaven.

The span from his time at the feet of Dīpaṃkara until he was born in Tuṣita should be known as what is called the Distant Epoch.

Furthermore, while the bodhisattva was dwelling in Tuṣita, when what is called the buddha proclamation arose, three great proclamations came about in this world: the proclamation of the eon, the proclamation of a buddha, and the proclamation of a universal monarch.

Of these, the proclamation in the world's name, "At the end of a hundred thousand years the eon will be destroyed," is this: gods of the desire realm, their heads uncovered, their hair loosened, with weeping faces, wiping the tears from their eyes with their hands, wearing red garments, taking on an exceedingly ugly appearance, go about the roads of humankind and proclaim: "People of the world, a hundred thousand years from now the eon will be destroyed. These worlds will be destroyed. The great ocean too will dry up. This great earth and Mount Meru, king of mountains, will turn to ash and be destroyed. The world will be destroyed as far as the Brahmā world." So they proclaim. "People of the world, cultivate loving-kindness! Cultivate compassion! Cultivate joy! Cultivate equanimity! Serve your mother! Serve your father! Serve the elders of your family!" This is what is called the proclamation of the eon.

The announcement, "When a thousand years have passed, a buddha, an omniscient one, will once again come into the world," is this: the world-protecting gods go about, saying and loudly proclaiming, "People of the world, from now, when a thousand years have passed, a buddha will again come into the world." This is what is called the proclamation of a buddha.

Furthermore, the proclamation "After a hundred years a wheel-turning king will come" is made by the gods themselves. They wander about, loudly proclaiming to the people of the world, "After a hundred years a wheel-turning king will appear in the world." This is called the great proclamation of a wheel-turning king. These three are the great proclamations.

Of these, when they heard the great proclamation of a buddha, all the gods of the ten-thousandfold world system gathered in one place. Realizing that the bodhisattva called such-and-such would become a buddha, they approached him in order to make their request, and they made that request when the earlier signs had arisen. At that time, once again, from every one of those world systems the gods gathered: those of the realm of the Four Great Kings, Śakra (Indra), the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the

Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, and the gods together with Mahābrahmā, the gods of all the world systems. They went before the bodhisattva in the abode of Tuṣita heaven and said: "Great sage, you have completed the ten perfections not for the sake of the splendor of Śakra, not for the sake of Māra, not to fulfill an aspiration for the state of Brahmā, and not to fulfill an aspiration for the splendor of a wheel-turning king. Rather, you have completed them in order to bring the world across to liberation and in order to seek omniscience. Now, great sage, from this present moment, it is the time for you to become a buddha. Great sage, become a buddha!" So they requested.

The Great Being did not give the gods his consent. He looked at the time, the continent, the region, the family, the mother, and her life span, in particular how much of it remained. He carefully observed what are called the five great observations.

Of these, the first is what is called the right time and the wrong time; first he observed the time. Life spans increasing from a hundred thousand years upward are a matter of the right and wrong time of life span, for he looked at how, at such a time, beings undergo birth, aging, sickness, and death. The Dharma taught by the buddhas contains nothing apart from the five characteristics. When they teach impermanence, suffering, and selflessness, people say, "Why are they explaining these things?" and they do not listen, do not have faith, and do not reflect. That is not the time. Therefore it would be a teaching that is not reflected upon and is uncertain. Therefore that is not the time. When life span is less than a hundred years, that time of life span is not the time either, for at such a time beings have exceedingly strong afflictions. Because their afflictions are so strong, even when instruction is given, they do not abide by it, and it quickly fades, like a line drawn on water with a stick. Therefore that too is not the time. The time of life span from a hundred thousand years downward to the threshold of a hundred years is what is called the right time. And at that time, the life span was a hundred years. Thus he observed the time, seeing that it was fitting for the Great Being to be born then.

Then he observed the continent. Looking over the four continents together with their surrounding islands, he saw that buddhas do not appear in the other three continents; they appear only in Jambudvīpa. That is the observation of the continent.

Then, the continent called Jambudvīpa is vast, ten thousand yojanas in extent. Considering in which region a buddha would appear, and looking for a spacious and open place, he observed the Middle Country. As for what is called the Middle Country: in the east is the town called Kajaṃgala; beyond it are the great sāla trees; beyond that are the border regions, and this side of them is the interior. In the southeast is the river called Sālavatī; beyond that are the border regions, and this side of them is the interior. In the south is the town called Sautakarṇika; beyond that are the border regions, and this side of them is the interior. In the west is the brahmin town called Kapa; beyond that are the border regions, and this side of them is the interior. In the north is Mount Uśīra; beyond that are the border regions, and this side of them is the interior. So it is explained and taught in the Vinaya. In length it is three hundred yojanas, in breadth two hundred and fifty yojanas, and in circumference nine hundred yojanas. These regions are the places where buddhas, pratyekabuddhas, the chief śrāvakas, the eighty great śrāvakas, and wheel-turning kings are born, and also families renowned as great beings, brahmin families, and householders as great as the great sāla trees. Among them is this city called Kapilavastu. "It is fitting for me to be born there," he resolved in his mind.

Then, as for what is called the observation of the family: one who is called a buddha is not born into a vaiśya family or a caṇḍāla family. Rather, he is born into one of the two families the world esteems, the kṣatriya family or the brahmin family. At present the world thinks most highly of the kṣatriya family, so he is born into it. "My father is the king called Śuddhodana." Thus he observed the family.

Then he observed the mother. A woman who delights in sensual pleasure and liquor is not one who can be called the mother of a buddha. Rather, she is born having completed the perfections over a hundred thousand eons, and she keeps the five precepts unbroken. "This queen called Mahāmāyā is such a woman; she is my mother." And further, what is the extent of her life? He saw that it was ten months and seven days from the beginning. These are the observations of the five great things.

Having made these observations, the great sage gave his consent to the gods in words, saying, "It is my time to become a buddha." Saying, "Please go," he sent those gods away, and surrounded by the gods of Tuṣita he entered the Nandana grove of Tuṣita heaven. Indeed, every heaven of the gods has a Nandana grove. There, the gods of this realm who pass away from here are

born into a happy destiny; passing away from here, they are born into a happy destiny, and they go about recalling the virtuous deeds they did before. In this way, attended by gods recalling his virtue, he went about there. Then, passing away, he entered the womb of Queen Mahāmāyā. To tell this well, the former account is related here in its proper order.

At that time, in the city of Kapilavastu, the festival known as the asterism of the middle summer month was being held. All the people were celebrating the asterism festival, and Queen Mahāmāyā too, from seven days before the full moon, enjoyed the festival with an abundance of flower garlands and perfumes. At the end of the seven days she rose early in the morning and bathed in scented water. She distributed four hundred thousand pieces of wealth as a great act of giving, adorned herself with every ornament, ate fine food, and kept the eight-branched poṣadha observance. She entered her splendid chamber, adorned as was fitting, lay down on her splendid bed, and fell asleep, and she saw a dream like this.

The Four Great Kings lifted her up, bed and all, and went into the Himalaya. They set her down on the Manaśilā plateau, sixty yojanas wide, beneath a great sāla tree seven yojanas high, and stood to one side. Then their queens came and led Queen Mahāmāyā to Lake Anavatapta. To remove her human impurities they bathed her, dressed her in divine garments, anointed her with fine perfumes, and adorned her with divine flowers. Not far from there was a silver mountain, and within it stood a golden palace. There, on a divine bed with its head toward the east, they said, "Lie here," and she lay down.

Then the bodhisattva became a white elephant. Not far from there was a golden mountain; he climbed it, came down again, and climbed the silver mountain. Coming from the north, holding in his trunk, which was like a silver garland, a white lotus, and trumpeting an elephant's call, he entered the golden palace. He circled her bed three times, and then it was as though he pierced her right side and entered her womb. In this way, under the most excellent asterism, Bre, he entered her womb.

On the second day, waking in the morning, the queen told the king her dreams. The king summoned sixty-four brahmins and honored them with flower garlands and other auspicious offerings and marks of respect. He had great seats spread out on the ground, and to the brahmins seated on them he served milk-rice mixed with fresh butter, honey, and sugar, filling bowls made of gold and silver and covering each with a gold or silver bowl. He also gave

them garments like those the king himself wore, gold weighed out, and other gifts, and so satisfied them. Then, when they were all satisfied in every wish, he told them the dream and asked, "What will come of this?"

The brahmins said, "Great king, do not be afraid! A being has entered the womb of your queen, and the one within is a male. The one in the womb is not a girl. He will be your son. If he remains in the household, he will become a wheel-turning king. If he abandons the household and goes forth, he will become a buddha. Having turned back from the world, he will not be born again to dwell in a household."

Furthermore, the very instant the bodhisattva entered his mother's womb, in a single moment, all the ten thousand world systems shook, shook violently, and resounded. Thirty-two signs appeared as portents. Throughout the ten thousand world spheres, immeasurable light pervaded and remained. The splendor of it was such that the blind gained sight. The deaf heard sounds with their ears. The mute could speak. The hunchbacked became straight. The lame could walk. All sentient beings who were bound were freed from their bonds. The fires of all the hells were quenched. In the realm of the hungry ghosts, hunger and thirst were stilled. Animals no longer feared one another. The illnesses of all sentient beings were cured. All sentient beings spoke with joy. Horses neighed sweetly. Elephants trumpeted. Musical instruments sounded of their own accord. The ornaments on people's feet and hands each rang out without being touched. All the directions became perfectly clear. A gentle breeze arose to bring happiness to beings. Rain fell from the clouds out of season. Water sprang from the earth and every direction was filled with water. Birds gave up flying in the sky. The rivers stood still without flowing. The water of the great ocean became sweet. Everywhere, lotuses of five colors covered the whole surface of the earth. The flowers born on land and in water opened. On the trunks of trees, trunk lotuses bloomed; on the branches, branch lotuses; on the vines, vine lotuses. Breaking through the plains and the rocks, rising one above another in sevens, came forth what are called stalk lotuses. Lotuses hung down from the sky. Everywhere a rain of flowers fell. In the sky the music of the gods resounded. All the ten thousand world systems became supremely blessed with flowers, incense, and perfumed water.

Thus, from the very moment the bodhisattva entered the womb, four sons of the gods holding swords in their hands stood guard, in order to ward off any harm to the bodhisattva and to the bodhisattva's mother. The bodhisattva's mother felt no desire for men, and she obtained gain and renown. Happy, with

no weariness in her body, she saw the bodhisattva who had entered her womb like a perfectly clear precious jewel strung on a red thread. Since the womb that a bodhisattva has entered is like the interior of a stupa, no other being can touch it or make use of it. For that reason, the bodhisattva's mother passes away seven days after the bodhisattva's birth and is reborn in Tuṣita heaven. Other women give birth after less than ten months, or more, sitting or lying down.

The mother of a bodhisattva is not like that. She protects the bodhisattva in her womb for ten months and gives birth standing. This is the nature of reality for all the mothers of bodhisattvas.

Queen Mahāmāyā likewise sustained the bodhisattva in her womb for ten months, like oil within a vessel. When her pregnancy had come to term, she spoke before the great king Śuddhodana: "I shall go to the town of my kinsfolk. I wish to go to Devadaha, the great city of my family's line." The king said, "Excellent!" and gave his permission.

He had the road between Kapilavastu and the city of Devadaha made level, and had it decked with plantain trees, full vases, victory banners, pennants and other adornments. The queen was seated in a golden palanquin, borne by a thousand ministers, and sent off with a large retinue.

Between the two cities there was a grove called Lumbinī, which belonged to the people of both cities, and in it stood auspicious sal trees. At that time they burst into unbroken blossom everywhere, from the roots to the topmost branches. Among the branches and among the flowers hovered many bees of five colors, and flocks of many birds of every kind went about, singing sweet melodies. The whole Lumbinī grove was like the grove of Caitraratha, like an assembly hall adorned by the might and sovereignty of a king. When the queen saw it, the wish arose in her to amuse herself in the sal grove. The ministers carried the queen and set her down in the sal grove.

She went to the foot of the auspicious sal tree and thought to take hold of a sal branch. The sal branch, like a fine cane softened over fire and bent, bowed down and hung close to the queen's hand. She stretched out her hand and took hold of the tip of the branch. At that very moment the winds of karma stirred. Then a screen was set up all around her and all the people withdrew to a distance. And so, while she stood holding the sal branch, the child was born from her womb.

At once the four Brahmās, of pure mind, arrived bearing a golden net. There they received the bodhisattva in the golden net and stood before his mother, saying, "Queen, do not let your mind be troubled. A son endowed with power and fame has been born to you."

Other beings, when they emerge from the mother's womb, come out smeared with impurities and loathsome. The bodhisattva is not like that. Rather, like a teacher of the Dharma descending from the Dharma throne, or like a man coming down a ladder, he came forth with both hands and both feet outstretched. Untouched by even the slightest impurity from the mother's womb, he was pure and fearless. Like a precious jewel laid in cloth of Kāśi, he came forth from his mother's womb radiating light.

To purify the bodhisattva thus born and the bodhisattva's mother, two streams of water fell from the sky, and they purified the bodies of the bodhisattva and his mother.

From the hands of the Brahmās who stood holding him in the golden net, the Four Great Kings, for the sake of auspiciousness and so that he might rest in a pleasant touch, received him on a leopard skin, as before. From their hands humans received him on dukūla cloth. Released from the hands of the humans, he stood upon the ground.

He looked toward the east and saw the many thousands of world-spheres, open one to another. The gods and humans there worshipped him with garlands of flowers, incense and other offerings, and said, "Great Being, there is no one like you here; there is no one at all above you." In the same way he looked well in all ten directions, the four directions, the four intermediate directions, below and above, and saw that there was none equal to himself.

Then he took seven steps toward the north. Mahābrahmā held a white parasol and Suyāma waved a yak-tail fan, while the other gods followed, carrying in their hands every one of the articles a king requires. Then, standing at the seventh step, he spoke words of auspicious proclamation, beginning, "I am supreme among those of the world," and roared the lion's roar.

In three births the bodhisattva spoke the moment he emerged from the womb: when he was born as Mahauṣadha, when he was born as Viśvantara, and when he was born here.

When Mahauṣadha was born, at the very moment he emerged from his mother's womb, Śakra (Indra), king of the gods, came holding sandalwood

heartwood in his hand, and went away again. The child put it in his fist and came forth. Then his mother asked, "Son, what have you brought with you?" "Mother, it is medicine." Because he had come bearing medicine, he was named "Medicine Boy." She took the medicine and put it into a water vessel. The blind, the deaf and the others who came, one after another, had all their ailments cured by it, and so it became a remedy. Then people cried, "Great medicine! Great medicine!" and because of the words spoken at his birth, Mahauṣadha became his name.

Again, when he was born as Viśvantara, the moment he was born from his mother's womb he stretched out his right hand and came forth saying, "Mother, is there anything in our house to give away in generosity?" Then his mother said, "Son, you have been born into a wealthy family." She placed her son's hand upon her own hand and laid in it a vessel holding a thousand precious jewels.

Again, when this one was born, he roared the lion's roar. In this way, in three births, the bodhisattva spoke as soon as he was born from his mother's womb. And just as at the moment he entered the womb, so too at the moment of his birth the thirty-two prior signs appeared.

Furthermore, when our bodhisattva was born in the Lumbinī grove, at that very moment there were born Queen Rāhula's mother, the minister Chandaka, the minister Kālodāyin, Kaṇṭhaka the king of horses, the tree of awakening, and the vases of the four treasures.

Of these, one measured four leagues, one eight leagues, one twelve leagues, and one sixteen leagues. These seven came into being at the same moment.

The people living in the two cities took the bodhisattva and went to Kapilavastu itself. On that very day, in Kapilavastu, he was born as the son of the great king Śuddhodana. Saying, "This prince will sit at the foot of the tree of awakening and become a buddha," the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, joyful and delighted, raised their hands high, played, and sang praises.

At that time the great king Śuddhodana's revered teacher, the ascetic called Kāla Devala, who had attained the eight meditative attainments, had been enjoying fine food. So as not to stay out in the heat of the day, he went to the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and sitting there at ease he watched those gods. He asked them, "Why are you playing with such joyful minds? Tell me as well the reason for all this."

The gods said, "Great sage, a son has been born to the great king Śuddhodana. He will sit at the foot of the tree of awakening, become a buddha, and turn the wheel of Dharma. Then we shall behold the boundless play of a buddha and obtain the whole Dharma. For these reasons we have become joyful."

When the ascetic heard their words, he quickly descended from the realm of the gods and came to the king's residence. He sat down on the seat prepared for him and said, "I would see the child who has been born as the son of the great king."

The king took the adorned prince, intending to have him bow to the ascetic, but the bodhisattva's feet turned round and came to rest on top of the ascetic's matted hair. For the bodhisattva there is no one else to whom it is fitting to bow with his body. Had the ascetic's feet, through ignorance, been placed upon the bodhisattva's head, the ascetic's head would have split into seven pieces. It was not fitting for the ascetic to bring about his own ruin. He rose from his seat and joined his palms toward the bodhisattva. The king, seeing this great wonder, bowed to his own son.

The ascetic could recall forty past eons and forty future eons, eighty eons in all. Seeing the perfect marks of the bodhisattva, he examined whether he would become a buddha or not, and he understood that without any doubt he would become a buddha. Thinking, "This is a wondrous person," he laughed. Then he examined, "When he has become a buddha, will I see him or not?" and he would not. He saw with certainty that in the meantime his own time would run out, and he would be reborn in a formless realm, where even a hundred or a thousand buddhas, should they come, could not examine him. Thinking, "I shall not be able to see such a wondrous person as this," his mind became deeply sorrowful, and he wept.

The people saw this and asked, "Why is it that our noble one sometimes laughs and sometimes weeps? Will some obstacle befall our noble prince?"

He said, "No obstacle will arise for him; without any doubt he will become a buddha."

"Then why do you weep?" they asked.

He said, "I shall not see this person become a buddha in this way, and so I am deeply grieved. That is why I weep in sorrow for myself."

Then, wondering, "Will any of my own relatives see him once he has become a buddha, or not?" he examined, and he saw his nephew, the youth Nālaka. He went to his sister's house and asked, "Where is the youth Nālaka?"

"Noble one, he is in the house."

"Call him and bring him here."

When he had come to his presence, the ascetic said to Nālaka, "Nephew, a son has been born into the family of the great king Śuddhodana. He is the sprout of a buddha. When thirty-five years have passed he will become a buddha, and you will see him. So go forth right now."

The youth, who had been born into a family with wealth of eight hundred and seventy million, thought, "This uncle of mine does not speak to me without meaning or purpose." At once he took ochre robes and a clay alms bowl from the market, shaved off his hair and beard, and put on the ochre robes. Thinking, "With my mind on the one who is the highest of the highest of persons in the world, I shall go forth," he joined his palms toward the bodhisattva and bowed with the five limbs. He put the alms bowl in a bag, hung it from his shoulder, went to the Himalaya, and practiced the way of a renunciant.

Later he approached the Tathāgata who had attained supreme and perfect awakening, heard the discourse on the realization proper to Nālaka, went back again to the Himalaya, and attained arhatship. Having realized what is supremely hard to realize, within just seven months his life came to an end. Resting against a golden mountain, he passed into complete nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa without remainder.

As for the bodhisattva, after five days, thinking, "It is fitting to wash his head and give him a name," they smeared the royal palace with the four kinds of fragrance and strewed the floor with flowers of the five precious substances. They cooked a porridge of milk boiled without water, and invited as guests one hundred and eight brahmins who had mastered the three Vedas. Seated in the royal palace, these enjoyed fine food, and after showing them great honor, they asked, "What are his marks like?"

Among them were Rāma, Dhvaja, Lakṣaṇa, Mantrin, Kauṇḍinya, Possessor of Hands, Suyāma, and Sudatta; these were the eight brahmins of that time. Versed in the mantras of the six limbs of learning, these eight brahmins each declared the characteristics, and explained them by way of the signs of his

descent from the Tuṣita heaven into his mother's womb. Of them, seven brahmins raised two fingers and foretold two possibilities: "Since he is endowed with these marks, if he remains in the household he will become a wheel-turning king. If he goes forth, he will become a buddha." When they had finished describing all the glories of a wheel-turning king, among the others, the youngest of them all by lineage was the brahmin youth called Kauṇḍinya.

He conferred upon that bodhisattva, in full, the most excellent of names. "This one has no reason to dwell in a household. With complete certainty he will not remain in a household; he will become a buddha." So, raising a single finger, he made this prophecy.

This Kauṇḍinya, because he had laid the foundation in the past, was later, on becoming a man, endowed with wisdom. He surpassed the seven brahmins, and being versed in the knowledge of the characteristics, he saw that for this child there was not even the name of dwelling in a household. "Without any doubt he will become a buddha": he saw no destiny other than that one. That is why, raising a single finger, he made this prophecy.

Then those brahmins went to their own homes, called their sons, and said, "Sons, we have grown old, and it is uncertain whether or not we will meet the son of the great king Śuddhodana when he has attained omniscience. When his son has attained omniscience, you must go forth in his teaching."

The seven brahmins, for as long as their lives lasted, then passed on according to the deeds they had done. Only the brahmin youth Kauṇḍinya remained, free from illness.

When the great being, endowed with understanding, had come forth in the great renunciation and gradually gone to Uruvilvā, he thought, "This region is delightful; a son of good family would know this region as a place for practicing austerities," and so he stayed there. Hearing, "The great man has gone forth," Kauṇḍinya went to where the sons of the brahmins lived and said, "Prince Siddhārtha has gone forth, and without any doubt he will become a buddha. If your fathers were living, free from illness, they would set out this very day and go forth. If you too wish it, come here; I shall go forth after that man."

They were not all able to be of one mind. Of them, four, with Kauṇḍinya as their leader, five persons in all, went forth, and those five came to be of the lineage known as the Group of Five Elders.

Moreover, at that time the king asked, "Having seen what will my son go forth?"

"By seeing the four former signs."

"What are they?"

"One old and decrepit, one sick, one dead, and one gone forth."

The king took note of these and said, "Do not let any such form come near my son. Even if my son attains buddhahood, it is of no use. I wish to see my son rule as king, sovereign lord of the four great continents with their two thousand surrounding islands, and travel through the expanse of the sky with a retinue thirty-six leagues around."

Saying this once more, to keep these four kinds of people from coming into the prince's sight, he posted guards in the four directions, over four krośas in each.

On that same day, the eighty thousand kinsmen of the clan who had gathered at the auspicious place each resolved to give a son. "Whether this one becomes a buddha or becomes a king, I give one son of mine. If he becomes a buddha, he will go about surrounded before and behind by renunciants of the kṣatriya caste. If he becomes a king, he will go about surrounded on all sides, before and behind, by princes of the kṣatriya caste." So saying, they made their offering.

The king, for his part, gave the bodhisattva wet nurses of the finest form, free of every defect. The bodhisattva had a boundless retinue and was endowed with ever-increasing glory and good fortune.

Then one day the king held the auspicious ceremony of sowing rice. On that day the whole city was adorned like the abode of the gods. Servants, laborers and others put on fine clothes, adorned themselves with perfumes, flower garlands and the like, and gathered inside the royal palace. On the king's estates a thousand plows were made ready. Moreover, on that day the yoke ropes of the oxen, together with the eight hundred plows less one, were made of silver, and the plow held by the king was made of gold. The two horns of each ox were coated with gold, and the ropes for mouth and neck were also made of gold.

The king came with a great retinue, bringing his son along. At the estate there stood a rose-apple tree whose many leaves gave dense shade. Beneath it a great couch was made for the prince, and above it was stretched a canopy

studded with golden stars. It was enclosed on every side by a curtain like a wall.

The king, adorned with all his ornaments, went with his ministers and retinue to the plowing ground, and there the king took hold of the golden plow. The ministers took hold of the seven hundred and ninety-nine silver plows, and the farming folk took up the remaining plows. Holding the plows, they plowed this way and that. The king, for his part, went from here to the far side and came back from the far side.

Thinking, "His festival will be splendid," the wet nurses who were sitting with the bodhisattva and his retinue went to watch the king's splendor, and they went out from inside the curtain. The bodhisattva looked here and there and saw no one at all. Quickly he rose and sat cross-legged, and by holding the outgoing and incoming breath, the first meditative concentration arose in him.

The nurses, going here and there to eat, were somewhat delayed. The shadows of the other trees did not turn back, but the shadow of that tree remained all around.

The nurses cried out with one voice, "The noble prince!" Quickly lifting the curtain, they went inside and saw the bodhisattva seated cross-legged on the couch. Having seen that miracle, they went and told the king: "Your Majesty, the prince is seated in such a manner. Thus the other trees do not turn back their shadows, yet the shadow of the rose-apple tree remains all around."

The king came at once and looked at the miracle. Saying, "This is my second salutation to this son," he bowed to his son.

Then in due course the bodhisattva reached the age of sixteen. The king built for the bodhisattva three palaces suited to the three seasons: one of nine stories, one of seven stories, and one of five stories. And he had forty thousand dancing women attend upon him.

The bodhisattva, like a god, was attended by women who were like goddesses. With many adorned women around him, and attended by music played without any men, he enjoyed great splendor. As the seasons turned, he dwelt in one palace or another. Moreover, the mother of Rāhula became chief of the queens, and she likewise enjoyed great splendor.

One day this talk arose among the relatives: "Siddhārtha goes about lost in play and learns not the slightest skill. If war comes upon us from every side, what will he do?" Then the king summoned the bodhisattva and said, "Son,

your relatives are saying, 'Siddhārtha learns not the slightest skill and goes about at play. If war comes here, what will he do?'" He replied, "Lord, I have no need to learn skills. Have it proclaimed with the drum that the people of the city may come if they wish to see my skill. On the seventh day from now I shall show my skill to the relatives." The king did so. The bodhisattva gathered archers who shoot at a sound and archers who shoot at a hair, and in the midst of a great crowd he showed the relatives twelve skills not shared by any other archer. These should be understood as they are related in the Sarabhaṅga Jātaka. In this way he dispelled the doubts of his relatives.

Moreover, the bodhisattva, thinking to go to the pleasure garden, summoned the charioteer and said, "Make the chariot ready!" The charioteer said, "Excellent!" Having heard his words, he adorned the great chariot, foremost of wheeled vehicles, with every fitting ornament, yoked to it four auspicious horses the color of kumuda petals, and said, "The bodhisattva may set out." The bodhisattva mounted the chariot as if it were a celestial mansion of the gods and went toward the pleasure garden.

The gods thought, "The time of Prince Siddhārtha's perfect and complete awakening is near. It is fitting to show him the foretokens." A son of the gods displayed an old man: decrepit, with broken teeth and white hair, bent, his body stooped at the back, holding a staff in his hand and speaking in a quavering voice. The bodhisattva and the charioteer saw him. Then the bodhisattva asked the charioteer, "Who is this man? Why is even his hair unlike that of others?" The questions should be asked as related in the Mahāpadāna Sutta. Hearing the charioteer's words, he thought, "Birth is impermanent, and all who are born grow old." His mind was stricken with sorrow, he turned back right there, and went to his own palace.

The king asked, "For what reason, why has my son turned back so quickly?" "Lord, he has seen an old and decrepit man, and so he will go forth." The king said, "Quickly prepare dancers for my son! If he is made to enjoy splendor, he will not think of going forth." Having said this, he increased the guard and posted it for eight krośas in every direction.

Again, one day, when the bodhisattva went in the same way to the pleasure garden, he saw a sick man created by a god and asked as before. His mind was stricken with sorrow, and once again he turned back and went to his own palace. The king asked again, did as before, and once more increased the guard, posting it over an area of twelve krośas on every side.

Again, on another day, when the bodhisattva went in the same way to the pleasure garden, he saw a dead man created by a god and asked as before. His mind was stricken with sorrow, and once again he turned back and went to the palace. The king asked as before and did as before, and once more increased the guard, posting it all around over a distance of one yojana.

Once more, on another day, when he went to the pleasure garden, he saw in the same way, created by a god, one who had gone forth, well dressed in fine robes, and he asked the charioteer, "What is this called?" Since no buddha had appeared anywhere, the charioteer did not know the qualities of going forth, yet through the power of the god he said, "Lord, this is one who has gone forth," and he spoke in praise of the qualities of going forth. The bodhisattva, a longing for going forth having arisen in him, went to the pleasure garden that day.

Some teachers say this: "He saw the four foretokens on a single day." That is not correct.

There he played during the day, bathed in an auspicious pond, and when the sun had set, sat on a seat of auspicious stone slab. He thought to have himself adorned. Then his attendants, adorned with garments of many colors and ornaments of every kind, brought garlands of flowers, incense, unguents and the like, and sat surrounding him on all sides.

At that very moment the seat on which Śakra (Indra) sat grew warm. He considered, "Who is it in whom the thought has arisen to make me abandon my place?" He saw that it was the time of the bodhisattva's adornment. He summoned Viśvakarman and said, "Viśvakarman, tonight at midnight Prince Siddhārtha will go forth in the great renunciation. This is his last adornment. Go to the pleasure garden and adorn the great being with divine ornaments." Hearing this, Viśvakarman said, "Excellent!" and through divine power at once drew near. Taking on the likeness of his attendant, he took the cloth from the attendant's hand and wound it about the bodhisattva's head. When the bodhisattva touched his head with his hand, he knew, "This is not a human being but a son of the gods."

As soon as it was wound, the crest upon his head, in the form of precious jewels, was wound with a thousand dukūla cloths. When he wound it again, he wrapped it ten times with a thousand dukūla cloths, so that ten thousand dukūla cloths were wound. One should not think, "The head is small and the cloths are many; how could they be wound?" Among all of them, the largest

was the size of a sākala creeper flower, or else they were the size of a kuba flower.

The Bodhisattva's head was like a kijalaka flower, or else it was like a guspyaka flower. Then, each adorned with every kind of ornament, all the musical instruments sounded forth their own notes, and the brahmins sang hymns of praise with many kinds of auspicious words: "Be victorious! Be joyful!" Adorned with every ornament, he mounted the finest chariot.

At that time Yaśodharā gave birth to a son. When King Śuddhodana heard of it, he sent a messenger to bring the news to his son and gladden him. On hearing it, the Bodhisattva said, "Rāhula is born; a fetter is born." The king asked what his son had said, and when he heard his words he declared, "From this day on, my grandson, the young prince, shall bear the name Rāhula."

Then the Bodhisattva, in great glory, went into the city, which was full of joy, splendor and good fortune. At that time a kṣatriya maiden called Kṛśā Gautamī was sitting on the roof of her mansion. Seeing the glorious form of the Bodhisattva as he made his round of the city, she was filled with joy and delight, and she uttered this inspired verse:

Surely his mother has found peace.
Surely his father is at peace.
Surely the woman is at peace
Whose husband is the like of him.

When the Bodhisattva heard this, he reflected: "She speaks in this way: that by seeing a body of such a kind, the mother's mind becomes peaceful, the father's mind becomes peaceful, and the mind of the people and of the people's lady becomes peaceful. What, then, is the meaning of 'a peaceful mind'? It is said of a mind free from the attachment of the afflictions. When the fire of desire has been quenched, that is what is called peace. When the fire of hatred and the fire of delusion have been quenched, that is what is called peace. When all the afflictions that arise, such as pride and wrong views, have been stilled, that is what is called peace. She has spoken sweet words to me, and I am going forth to seek nirvāṇa, and I shall seek it. From this very day it is fitting that I abandon the household life, renounce it, go forth, and seek nirvāṇa. She has become a teacher to me."

He unfastened from his neck a string of pearls worth a hundred thousand and sent it to Kṛśā Gautamī. She thought, "Young Siddhārtha has fallen in love with me and has sent me a token of his heart," and she was filled with happiness.

The Bodhisattva went to his own glorious and fortunate mansion and lay down upon his splendid couch. At once, women of supreme beauty, like daughters of the gods, adorned with every ornament and well trained in song and dance, took up all kinds of musical instruments, surrounded him, and began to entertain him with dancing, singing, music and the like. But because the Bodhisattva's mind took no delight in the afflictions, he found no pleasure in the dancing and the rest, and in a moment he fell asleep. The women said, "The one for whose sake we were dancing and so forth has gone to sleep. Why should we tire ourselves now?" They put down the instruments they had each been playing on the ground and lay down to sleep.

The Bodhisattva, in the light of lamps of fragrant oil, woke up, sat cross-legged upon the couch and looked around, and he saw the women asleep with their instruments laid aside. Some were drooling, some had bodies smeared and soiled with spittle, some were grinding their teeth, some were snoring, some were muttering in their sleep, some lay with their mouths gaping, some had their clothes slipping off, and in some their private parts were exposed. Seeing their altered state, the Bodhisattva was dismayed at heart and lost all pleasure in sensual desires. That great and spacious mansion, richly adorned and like the palace of Śakra (Indra), now seemed to him like a charnel ground full of corpses reeking with every kind of stench. The three realms of existence seemed to him like a house on fire. Uttering the exclamation, "It oppresses me! It torments me!" he longed intensely to go forth.

Thinking, "This very day I shall depart in the great renunciation," he rose from his couch, went over to the door and asked, "Who is here?" The minister Chandaka had lain down to sleep with his head pillowed on the threshold. He replied, "Noble son, it is I, the minister Chandaka." "Now I wish to depart in the great renunciation. Saddle a horse for me." "Very well, my lord," he said, and taking the saddle he went to the stable. There, by the light of lamps of fragrant oil, beneath a silken canopy adorned with sumana flowers, in a most delightful spot, he saw Kaṇṭhaka, the king of horses, standing. Thinking, "Now it is this one I should saddle," he put the saddle on Kaṇṭhaka. Knowing that he was being saddled, Kaṇṭhaka held his breath as the saddle was put on, thinking, "On other days, when we went to play in the pleasure grove, I was never saddled like this. My lord, the noble prince, must now wish to depart in the great renunciation." With a joyful heart he neighed loudly, and the sound would have resounded through the whole city, but the gods stifled it so that no one heard it.

The Bodhisattva, having sent the minister Chandaka to the horse, thought he would look upon his son for a moment. He went to Yaśodharā's quarters and opened the door. Inside the bedchamber, lamps of fragrant oil were burning, and Yaśodharā lay asleep on a bed strewn with about a load of flowers, sumana, mallikā and others, her hand resting on her son's head. The Bodhisattva stood with one foot upon the threshold of the door and gazed at them. He thought, "If I draw my son out from under the queen's hand and lift him up, the queen will wake, and that will hinder my going. When I have become a buddha, I will see my son." With this thought he came down from the mansion.

Again, some masters say this: "At that time he was born seven days before the bodhisattva departed." Since nothing of the kind is stated elsewhere, only this account is to be accepted.

So the bodhisattva came down from the palace, went straight to the horse stable, and said, "My son Kanthaka, now carry me across for one night. Through your kindness I shall become a buddha and carry across the whole world together with its gods."

Then he mounted Kanthaka's back. From the neck onward Kanthaka measured eighteen cubits to the muzzle. He had a height to match, he had might and speed, and he was entirely white, like the color of a polished conch. If he had neighed, or if his hooves had sounded, the whole city would have resounded with the noise. Therefore the gods, by their own power, held back his sounds so that no one heard them. Under each of the hooves that clattered as he went, the gods placed the palms of their hands. The bodhisattva sat in the middle of the horse's back. Saying to the minister Chandaka, "Hold on to the horse's tail," he went at midnight to the great gate.

Now the great king had made sure that the bodhisattva could at no time open the gate of the great city and go out. He had ordered that each leaf of the double gate had to be opened by a thousand men. But the bodhisattva was mighty. He had the strength of elephants numbering ten thousand koṭis of elephants. Counted in men, he had the strength of a hundred thousand koṭis of men.

The bodhisattva thought, "If the gate does not open, then I will stay seated on Kanthaka's back, with Chandaka holding on to the tail, press Kanthaka with my thighs, and leap over the wall, which is eighteen cubits high."

The minister Chandaka thought, "If the gate does not open, I will carry the noble prince on my shoulder, tuck Kanthaka's belly under my right arm, and leap over the wall."

Kanthaka thought, "If the gate does not open, I will carry my master just as he sits on my back, together with Chandaka holding on to my tail, and leap over the wall."

Had the gate not opened, one of these three things would surely have happened, just as each had thought. But the gods who guard the gate opened it.

At that very moment Māra came, thinking to turn the bodhisattva back. He stood in the sky and said, "Great sage, do not go out to renounce the world! On the seventh day from now you will obtain the precious wheel. You will rule the four great continents surrounded by two thousand lesser islands. Great sage, turn back!"

"Who are you?" he asked.

"I am the Lord of the World," he said.

"Māra, I know that the precious wheel would come to me, but I have no need of kingship. I shall make my voice resound through the ten-thousandfold world system and become a buddha," he declared.

Māra said, "From now on, whenever a thought of desire, a thought of ill will, or a thought of harm arises in your mind, I will know it." And never parting from him, like a companion, he followed close behind him like a shadow.

And the bodhisattva, though the kingdom of a wheel-turning monarch lay in his hand, cast it away without a second glance, as one throws away spittle, and with great honor went out of the city. He went out on the full moon of the middle summer month, at the time of the supreme constellation. Then he thought to turn around and look back at the city. The instant this arose in the bodhisattva's mind, the great earth split and turned round like a potter's wheel, as if to say, "Great being, have you not already done the deed of merit, so that you need not turn back to look?"

The bodhisattva stood facing the city and gazed at it, and there he pointed out a place for the shrine of Kanthaka's turning back. Then he set Kanthaka facing the road he was to travel and went on, with great honor, glory, and good fortune.

At that time the gods lit sixty thousand great lamps in front of him. Behind him also they lit sixty thousand great lamps. On his right also they lit sixty thousand great lamps. On his left also they lit sixty thousand great lamps. Other gods lit countless thousands of lamps on the encircling mountains at the rim of the world (Cakravāla). Other gods, together with nāgas, garuḍas, and the rest, went along making offerings of divine incense, garlands of flowers, scented powders, fragrant smoke, and so on. Pāricchatta flowers and mandāra flowers fell from the sky without a break, thick as clouds, a rain of flowers like a ceaseless downpour. Divine songs rang out. All around, sixty-eight thousand musical instruments sounded. It was like thunder roaring in the midst of the ocean. It went on like the time when the ocean roars against the flank of Mount Yugandhara.

In this way the glorious and fortunate bodhisattva, departing in a single night, left three kingdoms behind, and at the end of thirty yojanas he came to the bank of the river called Mind-Endowed.

Why could this horse not go any farther? It was not that he could not. He could go around the whole of one world system in a single morning, come straight back that same morning, and eat the food set before him. But at that time the gods, nāgas, garuḍas, and the rest, stationed in the sky, again rained down incense, garlands of flowers, and so on. The horse's body sank in them up to his thighs, so that he could not get out. The incense, garlands, and the rest had become so very obstructive that they could no more be pulled apart than matted hair.

For that reason, he traveled thirty-two leagues. Then the bodhisattva, halting on the bank of a river, asked his minister Chandaka, "What is the name of this river?"

"My lord, it is called the Mindful."

"Then my going forth too shall be called mindful."

He struck the horse with his heel and urged it on. The horse leapt and landed on the far bank of the river, which was eight bull's-calls wide. The bodhisattva dismounted from the horse's back and sat on a heap of sand like silver. He called Chandaka and said, "Take my ornaments and Kanthaka and go. I am going forth."

"My lord, please let me go forth as well."

The bodhisattva said, "You may not go forth, so go." Though Chandaka asked three times, he did not permit it.

He handed over the ornaments and Kanthaka, and he thought, "This hair of mine does not suit a renunciant." There was no one else fit to cut the bodhisattva's hair, so he resolved to cut it with his own sword. Grasping the sword in his right hand, he grasped the topknot with its crown jewel in his left and cut it off. His hair became two finger-breadths long, curled to the right, and lay against his head. It stayed at that very length for as long as he lived. He had no beard either, and he never again needed to shave his hair or beard.

The bodhisattva took the topknot with its crown jewel and said, "If I am to become a buddha, may it stay in the sky. If not, may it fall to the ground." With these words he threw it into the sky. The topknot, bound with its crest jewel, rose about a league and stayed in the sky. Śakra (Indra), king of the gods, looked with his divine eye, placed it in a jeweled casket a league in size, and in the palace of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three he built a stupa to house the crest jewel.

The topknot steeped in supreme fragrance was cut,
And the supreme person cast it into the sky.
The Thousand-Eyed One caught the hair upon his head
And bore it in a golden casket to the abode of the gods.

The bodhisattva thought again, "This cloth of Kāśi does not suit my way of life as a renunciant." Now, in the time of the Buddha Kāśyapa, a former friend of his had been a potter, and he had become the Great Brahmā. Thinking, "For the span of a whole buddha-age I have not met my friend," he went on, "This friend of mine has come forth in the great renunciation. I shall take these requisites of a renunciant and go to him."

The three robes and the alms bowl,
Razor, needle and belt,
Together with the water strainer, these are eight,
Fitting and needed by renunciants.

He brought these eight requisites a renunciant needs and offered them. The bodhisattva put on the banner of those worthy of veneration and took up the supreme garb of one gone forth. He said to Chandaka, "Tell my mother and father, in my own words, that I am well," and sent him away. Chandaka bowed to the bodhisattva, circumambulated him, and left.

Then Kanthaka, hearing Chandaka and the bodhisattva talking, thought, "I shall never meet my lord again." Once he was out of the bodhisattva's sight, he could not bear the grief that overwhelmed him. His heart broke, he died, and he was reborn in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three as a son of the gods called Kanthaka. For Chandaka, that was the first grief. Then, tormented by a second grief on account of Kanthaka's death, he went back to the city weeping and lamenting.

In that same region where the bodhisattva was, there was a mango grove called Anupiya. There he dwelt for seven days in the bliss of going forth, passing the days and nights. Then in a single day he traveled thirty leagues on foot and came to Rājagṛha. When he arrived, he went for alms from door to door in order. When all the townspeople saw the bodhisattva, they were thrown into an uproar, like Rājagṛha when the elephant Dhanapāla entered it, or like the city of the gods when the lord of the asuras entered it. The king's men came and said, "Lord, a being with a form like this is going for alms in the city. Whether he is a god, a human, or a garuḍa, we do not know."

The king, standing on the roof of his palace, saw the great being and was filled with wonder and amazement. He summoned a man and ordered him, "Go and find out. If he is not human, he will leave the city and vanish. If he is a god, he will go into the sky. If he is a nāga, he will go beneath the earth. If he is human, he will eat whatever food he has received."

The great being gathered up the mixed food and, recognizing that this much was enough for him, left the city by the same gate through which he had entered. He sat down in the shade of Mount Paṇḍava, facing east, and began to eat the food. Then his intestines turned over, so that it seemed they would come out through his mouth. For with that body of his, he had rarely even seen food of this kind with his eyes. So, feeling disgust at the various kinds of food, he admonished himself in this way: "Siddhārtha, you were born in a place where food and drink were easy to come by, where there was fragrant three-year-old rice and every kind of food with every flavor. Then you saw a rag-robed renunciant and thought, 'When shall I too become like this, go for alms, and eat such food? When that time comes, may it be so for me.' And with that thought you went forth. Now what is this you are doing?" Having admonished himself in this way, he ate the food without disgust.

The king's man saw how he behaved, went, and told the king. When the king heard the messenger's report, he quickly left the city, approached the

bodhisattva, and was filled with faith at his bearing. He offered the bodhisattva his entire sovereignty. The bodhisattva said, "Great king, I have no use for desire for objects or for the desire of the afflictions."

"I have come seeking supreme, perfect awakening." Although the king offered gifts of every kind, they did not please him. "You will surely become a buddha. Once you have become a buddha, please come first of all to my city," the king said, and he took a promise from him. This is told here in brief; for the full account, this matter and this story should be looked up and learned together with the Sūtra on Going Forth.

The bodhisattva gave the king his promise and went on his wanderings stage by stage. He approached Ārāḍa Kālāma and Udraka Rāmaputra and attained the meditative absorptions, but he saw that this was not the path to buddhahood. Although he had attained those absorptions he was not satisfied. Wishing to show the world with its gods his own strength and diligence, and intent on practicing great austerities, he went to Uruvilvā. Thinking, "This place is most delightful," he settled there and practiced great austerities.

The five renunciants, Kauṇḍinya and the others, were wandering for alms through villages, towns and royal capitals, and they came to the place where the bodhisattva was staying. For six years after that he practiced great austerities. Saying, "Now he will become a buddha, now he will become a buddha," the five swept his dwelling, did other such tasks and attended to his person, and they stayed close by him.

The bodhisattva resolved to carry his austerities to their utmost limit. He passed his days on a single sesame seed, a single grain of rice and the like, and at last he gave up all food entirely. The gods infused nourishment into him through every pore of his skin. Then, without food, his body grew emaciated; his golden body turned dark, and even the thirty-two marks of a great being could no longer be seen. On another day, as he practiced meditation with restrained breath, a great pain arose in his body; he lost consciousness and collapsed on his walking path.

Then one god said, "The ascetic Gautama has died." Another said, "Fallen like this, he has attained arhatship." The one who had said he had died went and told the great King Śuddhodana, "Your son has died." The king asked, "Did my son die without attaining buddhahood, or did he die after attaining it?" "He was unable to attain buddhahood. He collapsed at the place of his austerities and died." Hearing this, the king did not believe it. "My son will not die without

having attained buddhahood," he said, rejecting it. Why did the king again refuse to believe? Because he had seen the miracles, at the time the ascetic Kāladevala bowed before the child and beneath the rose-apple tree.

Then the bodhisattva regained consciousness and rose. The god went and said, "Great king, your son has recovered." The king said, "I knew my son was not dead."

The Great Being, having practiced austerities for six years, came to this conclusion: "Practicing austerities such as these is not the path to awakening." So he began to take a little food, and he lived on alms, wandering for alms in villages and towns. Then the thirty-two marks of a great being became clear again, and his body became like the color of gold.

The group of five monks said, "Although this man practiced austerities for six years, he has not attained the wisdom of omniscience. Now he goes for alms in villages and elsewhere and eats the food he begs. If he becomes attached to tastes, what can he achieve? He was mistaken in his austerities. It is like someone who wants to bathe his whole body hoping that a mere drop of water will enter every one of his pores. What are we to do, staying in a place where his thoughts of desire are present?" Abandoning the Great Being, they took up their robes and alms bowls, traveled a road of eighteen yojanas, and settled in the grove of Ṛṣipatana.

At that same time, in Uruvilvā, a girl named Sujātā, born into a farmer's household in the market town of Senānī, had come of age and made a prayer at a nyagrodha tree: "If I go to the house of a family equal in birth to my own, conceive at my first pregnancy and have a son, I will make a torma offering worth a hundred thousand every year." Her prayer was fulfilled.

As the Great Being was completing his six years of austerities, she thought to make the torma offering on the full moon of the last month of spring. Beforehand, she had a thousand milk cows graze on licorice in a licorice grove, milked them, and gave their milk to five hundred milk cows. She milked those and gave the milk to two hundred and fifty milk cows. In the same way, she milked sixteen milk cows and gave their milk to eight. Seeking milk that was thick, sweet, nourishing and well colored, she boiled the milk.

She intended to make the torma offering on the morning of the full-moon day of the last month of spring. At daybreak the cowherd rose and went to milk the eight milk cows. Although no calf had come near the udders, the moment new vessels were placed beside the udders, streams of milk filled the vessels by

their own nature. Sujātā saw this great wonder. She carried the milk in her own hands, poured it into a new vessel, lit the fire with her own hand and began to cook it. As the milk porridge boiled, great bubbles rose and turned to the right, yet not so much as a spoonful fell to the ground, and there was not the slightest smoke in the hearth.

At that time the four World Guardians came and guarded the hearth. Great Brahmā held a parasol. Śakra (Indra) tended the fire as was fitting. The gods and humans of the four great continents, each surrounded by two thousand lesser islands, gathered nourishment as was fitting, the gods each by their own power, and put it in. The humans did the same. At other times the gods infuse nourishment into each morsel of food.

And again, on the day of awakening and on the day of final nirvāṇa, they put it into the vessel itself.

On that very day Sujātā was there in person, and she saw many great wonders. She called her servant girl, named Pūrṇā, and said, "Pūrṇā, today our deity is greatly pleased. In all this time I have never seen great wonders of this kind. So go quickly and sweep the deity's dwelling place well."

Pūrṇā said, "Very well," took to heart the words of her noble mistress, and hurried as fast as she could to the foot of the tree.

During that night the Bodhisattva had seen five great dreams. Reflecting on them, he made the firm resolve, "Without any doubt, today I shall attain buddhahood." When that night had passed, he attended to his body, and early in the morning, at the time for going for alms, he came and sat at the foot of the nyagrodha tree, lighting up the whole tree with his own radiance.

Then Pūrṇā arrived. She saw the Bodhisattva at the foot of the tree, gazing toward the world-system of the east, and she saw that the light of the rays streaming from his body had turned the whole tree the color of gold. She thought, "Today our deity has come down onto the tree and sits there to receive the torma with his own hand." With that thought she was filled with delight, went quickly, and told all this to Sujātā.

Hearing her words, Sujātā was delighted and said, "From this day on, live in the household as my eldest daughter," and she gave the girl every ornament befitting one.

Moreover, since on the day of attaining perfect buddhahood it is fitting that a great golden bowl worth a hundred thousand be used, she resolved to pour the

milk-rice into a great golden bowl. She brought out a great golden bowl worth a hundred thousand, and turning the pot of cooked milk-rice upside down, she poured it in. All the milk-rice, like water on a lotus leaf, gathered into a single drop and flowed into the golden bowl. It came to exactly one golden bowl full. She covered that golden vessel with another golden vessel and wrapped it in cloth.

Sujātā adorned her whole body with ornaments, set the golden bowl on her head, and went with great majesty to the foot of the nyagrodha tree. When she saw the Bodhisattva, great joy arose in her. Thinking, "Is this the deity of the tree?" she advanced from where she had first seen him, bowing again and again. She lowered the golden bowl from her head and opened it, took up a golden pitcher of water perfumed with sweet scents, approached the Bodhisattva, and stood beside him.

The earthen alms bowl offered to him by his friend the potter, who had become Mahābrahmā, had never been given up by the Bodhisattva in all that time, yet at that very moment it vanished. The Bodhisattva could not see his alms bowl. He stretched out his right hand and accepted the water. Sujātā placed the milk-rice, together with its vessel, in the hand of the Great Being. When the Great Being looked at Sujātā, she understood his expression and said, "Noble one, I offer this wholly to you. Please accept it, and go wherever you wish." She bowed to him and said, "Just as my own wish has been completely fulfilled, so may your intention also be completely fulfilled." And she went away, caring no more for the great golden bowl worth a hundred thousand than for a withered leaf of a tree.

The Bodhisattva rose from his seat and circled the tree. Taking up the golden bowl, he went to the bank of the river Nairañjanā. There is a ford there called Supratiṣṭhita, the place where countless many hundreds of thousands of bodhisattvas went down to bathe on the day of their full awakening. He set the bowl down on its bank, went down, and bathed. Then, wearing the robe worthy of veneration that had been worn by many hundreds of thousands of buddhas, he sat facing east. He made forty-nine balls, each about the size of a single palm-fruit stone, and ate all of the thick milk-rice, which had no water in it.

This was what became his food for forty-nine days, for once he had become a buddha he remained for forty-nine days at the seat of awakening. During those days he took no other food, he did not bathe, he did not rinse his mouth, and he performed no bodily functions. He passed the days and nights in the

bliss of meditative concentration, the bliss of the path, and the bliss of the fruit.

Further, having eaten that milk-rice, he took the golden bowl in his hand and said, "If I am able to become a buddha today, may this bowl travel upstream on the water. If not, may it travel downstream," and he cast it into the water. Cutting across the waves of the current, it went to the middle of the river, and right there in the very middle, like a swift horse running, it traveled upstream for about eighty cubits. Then, sinking in a whirlpool, it went down to the abode of the nāga king Kāla. There it struck against the great golden bowls from which the three previous buddhas had eaten their meals, making a clinking sound, and it came to rest in one place, beneath all of them. When the nāga king Kāla heard that sound, he said, "Yesterday a buddha attained awakening, and now again today a buddha has attained awakening," and he praised him at length.

The Bodhisattva spent the day in a grove of sāl trees on the riverbank. In the evening, at the time when the kumuda flowers open, he set out along a road that the gods had adorned, its width eight times the distance at which a bull's bellow can be heard. Roaring like a lion, he went forward, facing the tree of awakening. The nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas, and others honored him with divine incense, flowers, and the like, and with divine songs and the like. The ten thousand world-systems became fragrant and were turned into garlands of flowers, and all cried out, "Excellent!"

At that time a grass-seller named Svastika came along the road carrying grass. Recognizing the bearing of the Great Being, he offered him eight handfuls of grass. The Bodhisattva took the grass, approached the seat of awakening, and stood on its southern side, facing north. At once the southern rim of the world sank down, as though it reached down as far as Avīci, and the southern rim rose up, as though it reached the peak of existence. The Bodhisattva thought, "This is not the place for attaining perfect buddhahood." Circling around, he went to the western side and stood facing east. Then the western rim sank down, as though it reached as far as Avīci, and the eastern rim rose up, as though it reached the peak of existence. Wherever the Bodhisattva stood, that place sank, sinking deeper and deeper into the great earth, like a great cartwheel lying flat when it is pressed down at the edge of its rim. Thinking, "This is not the place for attaining awakening," the Bodhisattva circled around, went to the northern side, and stood facing south. Then the northern rim sank into the earth, as though it reached as far as Avīci, and the northern rim rose

upward, as though it reached the peak of existence. The Bodhisattva thought, "This is not the place for attaining awakening," and circling around he went to the eastern side and stood facing west.

There on the eastern side, the place where all the buddhas had sat cross-legged did not move and did not tremble. The Great Being understood: "This is the unmoving place that no buddha has abandoned, the place where every net of the afflictions is destroyed." He took the grass by the tips and spread it out, and at once it became a seat fourteen cubits in measure. Nor did it stay simply as it had been laid down; it became like a picture drawn by painters skilled in forms. The Bodhisattva rested his back against the trunk of the tree of awakening and sat facing east. With a steadfast mind he resolved, "Even if my skin, sinews, bones, blood, and flesh dry up, I shall not move my body from this seat until I have attained perfect buddhahood." And he sat cross-legged on the seat, unbreakable even if a hundred thunderbolts were to fall, invincible to any adversary.

Then Māra, the son of the gods, wishing to keep Prince Siddhārtha under his own power, thought, "Now I will not let him pass beyond me." He went to the army of Māra and spoke of this matter, and raising the cry known as "Māra's call," he led the army of Māra forth. The host of Māra extended twelve yojanas in front of Māra, and twelve yojanas to the right and to the left. Behind, it stretched as far as the edge of the world's rim, and above it rose nine yojanas. The sound of the whole host talking was heard for a thousand yojanas, a sound like the earth splitting apart. Then Māra, the son of the gods, mounted the back of the elephant called Girimekhala, a hundred and fifty yojanas in size, and conjuring up a thousand arms, he took up weapons of every kind. Among the rest of Māra's retinue, no two companions took up the same kind of weapon. Of every kind of color and with faces of every kind, they came to destroy the Great Being.

The gods of the ten thousand world-systems, meanwhile, remained there praising the Great Being. Śakra (Indra), king of the gods, stood blowing the conch called Vijayottara, the Unsurpassed Victory. That conch measured a hundred and twenty cubits; when it was blown well it sounded without a break for four months, and only then did its sound cease. The great nāga king Kāla remained there, offering many hundreds of praises. Mahābrahmā stood holding a white parasol.

But the army of Māra kept coming on and on toward the seat of awakening, and the gods, unable to stay together there, fled to their own abodes. The nāga king Kāla sank into the earth and went to his nāga palace Mañjerika, five hundred yojanas in extent, and lay down with both hands covering his face. Śakra slung the Unsurpassed Victory conch across his back and stood upon the summit of the world's rim. Mahābrahmā planted the white parasol on the summit of the world's rim and went off to the Brahmā world. Not a single god was able to remain; the Great Being sat there entirely alone.

Māra spoke to his retinue: "Sons, there is no other man like Siddhārtha, son of Śuddhodana. I cannot do battle with him face to face, so we will make war from behind."

The Great Being looked in three directions and saw that every place was empty, for all the gods had fled. Then, looking to the north, he saw the armies of Māra coming to destroy him. He thought: "These hosts of soldiers have come to this place, striving mightily to overpower me alone, and here I have no mother, father, brother, or any kinsman at all. Yet I have long cultivated these ten perfections, delighting in them as in a cherished pursuit. Therefore it is fitting that I take the perfections themselves as my shield, wield the perfections themselves as my weapon, and destroy these hosts of soldiers." With this thought he sat, contemplating the ten perfections in his mind.

Then Māra, the son of the gods, said, "Siddhārtha must be made to flee at once," and setting the masses of wind in readiness, he came on.

At that very moment the wind-maṇḍalas of the east and the other directions rose up and came on. They lifted up masses of mountains half a yojana, two yojanas and more in size, and tore dense forests, trees and the like out of the ground. Their power could grind villages and towns everywhere to powder and dust, but it was scattered by the might of the splendor of the Great Being's merit. When the winds reached the bodhisattva, they could not stir even the hem of his upper robe.

Then, thinking to come and kill him by overwhelming him with water, Māra made a great rain fall and keep falling. By his power great clouds gathered, stacked one above another by many hundreds and many thousands, and poured down rain. The force of the torrents gouged into the ground. Great rain-clouds came over the forests, the trees and all the rest, yet they could not wet the Great Being with even a single drop.

Then he called down a rain of stones. Masses of mountains greater still came through the sky, smoking and blazing, but when they reached the bodhisattva they fell in the form of bunches of divine flowers.

Then he called down a rain of every kind of weapon. Single-edged and double-edged blades, swords, short spears, razors and other weapons came through the sky, smoking and blazing, but when they reached the bodhisattva they turned into divine flowers.

Then he called down a rain of embers. Embers the color of the blossoms of the lac tree came through the sky, but at the bodhisattva's feet they turned into divine flowers and fell.

Then he called down rains of ash. Fire-colored ash, fiercely hot, came through the sky, but at the bodhisattva's feet it fell as a rain like sandalwood powder.

Then he called down a rain of sand. The finest sand came through the sky, smoking and blazing, but at the bodhisattva's feet it became like divine powder and fell as rain.

Then he called down rains of mud. The mud came through the sky, smoking and blazing, but at the bodhisattva's feet it turned into divine ointment and fell.

Then, to terrify Siddhārtha in this way and make him flee, he set about bringing on darkness. It became a great black darkness of four kinds, but when it reached the bodhisattva it vanished, as darkness is destroyed by the light of the sun. So these nine assaults of Māra, wind, rain, stones, weapons, embers, ash, sand, mud and darkness, rained down, yet they could not make the bodhisattva flee.

Shouting to his retinue, "What is this? Why do you stand there? Seize this youth! Strike him! Drive him away!" Māra himself mounted the back of the elephant Girimekhala and raised his discus weapon. He came up close to the bodhisattva and said, "Siddhārtha, get up from that seat! It is not fitting for you. It is fitting for me."

When the Great Being heard his words, he replied: "Māra, you have not completed the ten perfections, you have not completed the secondary perfections, and you have not completed the ultimate perfections. You have not made the five great renunciations, you have no conduct for the benefit of your kin, you have no conduct for the benefit of the world, and you have not completed the conduct of a buddha. Therefore this seat is not fitting for you.

This seat is fitting for me alone."

Māra grew furious. Unable to contain the force of his rage, he hurled the weapon-wheel at the Great Being. But as he sat contemplating his ten perfections, it became like a canopy of flower garlands hung above him. When Māra hurled that discus weapon at others in his fury, it would pierce through solid rock, or a pillar of solid stone, and go on. Yet here it turned into a canopy of flowers for him and stayed there. Then the rest of Māra's retinue, thinking, "Now he will get up from the seat and go," hurled masses of mountains greater still. These too, as the Great Being sat contemplating the ten perfections, turned into bunches of flowers and fell to the ground.

The gods stationed at the rim of the world-sphere craned their necks to watch. Raising their heads again and again, they wondered, "Has the person of Siddhārtha, the supreme youth, been destroyed? What will he do?" And they watched.

Then the Great Being declared, "The seat that the bodhisattvas who have completed the perfections attain on the day of their perfect and complete awakening is fitting for me." And he said to Māra, who stood before him, "Māra, who is witness that you have given gifts?"

Māra said, "All these are my witnesses," and stretched out his hand toward Māra's armies. At once Māra's retinue cried out, "I too am a witness! I too am a witness!" and the roar of their cry was as though the very earth were splitting apart.

Then Māra said to the Great Being, "Siddhārtha, who is witness to the gifts that you have given?"

The Great Being said, "Māra, for the gifts that you have given, there are, for now, witnesses who have minds. But for me, in this place, there is no witness with a mind at all. Let the giving I did in other births stand aside for now. For the great gift of seven hundred of each of seven things, which I gave while I lived in the body of Viśvantara, this great, solid earth, which has no mind, is my witness."

So saying, he drew his right hand out from inside his robe and stretched it out toward the great earth, saying, "When I lived in the body of Viśvantara and gave that gift of seven hundred of each of seven things, were you witness or were you not? Speak!"

The great earth roared out, "I was the witness at that time!" With a hundred, a thousand, a hundred thousand mighty roars, it drowned out the clamor of Māra's army.

Then the Great Being, recalling the generosity of Viśvantara and saying, "The great gift given by Siddhārtha is the supreme gift," was seated, while the elephant Girimekhala, a hundred and fifty leagues in size, knelt down with its knees planted on the ground. The retinue of Māra fled in all the directions and the intermediate directions, so that no two of them went by the same road. Throwing away their head ornaments and the clothes they wore, they fled, each to his own quarter.

Then the hosts of gods saw Māra fleeing, and saying, "The māras are defeated, and Prince Siddhārtha has become victorious!" they resolved to make an offering of victory. The nāgas urged on the nāgas, the garuḍas the garuḍas, the gods the gods, and Brahmā urged on the brahmās. Holding incense, garlands of flowers and the like in their hands, they came near the Great Being, who was seated cross-legged at the foot of the tree of awakening. So it was that the māras fled.

The glorious Buddha has become victorious;
Māra, the evil one, has been defeated.
Rejoicing, at the seat of awakening they proclaimed it:
then the hosts of nāgas proclaimed the sage's victory.

The glorious Buddha has become victorious;
Māra, the evil one, has been defeated.
Rejoicing, at the seat of awakening they proclaimed it:
the hosts of garuḍas proclaimed the sage's victory.

The glorious Buddha has become victorious;
Māra, the evil one, has been defeated.
Rejoicing, at the seat of awakening they proclaimed it:
then the hosts of gods proclaimed the sage's victory.

The glorious Buddha has become victorious;
Māra, the evil one, has been defeated.
Rejoicing, at the seat of awakening they proclaimed it:
then the hosts of Brahmā proclaimed the victory.

And at last the gods of the ten thousand world spheres made offerings with flowers, incense and unguents, and remained there, offering praises of many

kinds.

In this way, as the sun was setting, the Great Being vanquished Māra, and the leaves of the tree of awakening, like young shoots, fell upon his robe, as though making offering to him with red coral. In the first watch of the night he realized, through wisdom, the recollection of former lives; in the middle watch, through the purified divine eye, he attained wisdom; and in the last watch he attained the wisdom of dependent origination. Then he reflected, and reflected again, on the twelve links of dependent origination, the way of their operating and of their ceasing to operate through conditions, in forward order and in reverse order. The ten thousand world systems, down to their boundary of water, quaked twelve times.

Once again the Great Being made a great sound resound through the ten thousand world systems, and at the time of dawn he personally experienced the wisdom of omniscience. All the ten thousand world systems became as though adorned. The streamers of the banners and pennants planted upon the eastern world rim reached across to the western rim. Likewise the streamers of the banners and pennants planted upon the edge of the western rim reached across to the eastern rim. The streamers of the banners and pennants planted upon the northern rim reached across to the southern rim. The streamers of the banners and pennants planted upon the southern rim reached across to the northern rim. The banners and pennants rising from the surface of the earth reached up to the abode of Brahmā. The banners and pennants fastened in the abode of the Brahmā world reached down to the surface of the earth. Throughout the ten thousand world spheres, the flowering trees burst into bloom, and the fruit trees became laden with fruit. On the trunks bloomed trunk lotuses; on the branches, branch lotuses; on the vines, vine lotuses. From the sky lotuses hung downward. Breaking through the plains and the rocks, they rose up in sevens, one above another, bringing forth what are called chain lotuses. The ten thousand world systems became like a cushion of the most excellent flowers. The hells between the worlds, in the spaces of eight thousand leagues between the world rims, are places where light is rare, for even the light of seven suns does not illumine them; those hells between the worlds were at that very moment illumined. The waters of the great ocean, some eighty-four thousand leagues deep, became sweet. The rivers stood still in their flowing. The blind saw forms with their eyes; the deaf heard sounds with their ears; the lame became able to walk. Beings who were bound were freed from their bonds.

Thus, amid immeasurable splendor, offerings and marvelous phenomena arose. He realized for himself the wisdom of omniscience, and he uttered the inspired utterance that is spoken by all the buddhas:

Through all the round of births
I searched, poisonless, utterly free of poison.
When I was seeking the houseless,
there was the suffering of birth, again and again.
The houseless has now been seen;
no more will a house be made.
All its suffering is destroyed;
the house's peak, that bears the name of poison, is undone.
The mind is freed from formations;
craving is exhausted and has ceased to be.

This account, beginning from his dwelling in the palace of Tuṣita heaven up to his attaining omniscience here at the seat of awakening, the account of those places, is called the Intermediate Introduction.

Further, the Proximate Introduction is this: the Blessed One dwelt at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, and he dwelt at Vaiśālī, in the Great Forest, at the Hall of the Peaked House. Thus it is said that, as he dwelt in this place and that, it is found in each of those very places. Although whatever is said is to be understood in this way, it should nevertheless be understood as follows, taking it from the very beginning. When the Blessed One was seated, having uttered the inspired utterance, a thought of this kind arose in him:

"For four incalculable eons and a hundred thousand more, for the sake of this cross-legged posture, through all these ages I cut off at the neck my own head, adorned with its head ornaments, and gave it away. I gave away my fine eyes. I cut out the flesh of my heart and gave it away. I gave away sons like the prince Jālin, I gave away daughters like the maiden Kṛṣṇājinā, and I gave away wives like the queen Mādrī to be the servants of others. This is my posture. It is the posture of the Victor. It is the supreme posture. Seated in it, all my aspirations have been fulfilled. For now I shall not rise from this seat." With this thought he entered many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of meditative attainments, remained in equipoise, and stayed right there for seven days. That is why he is called a buddha.

Then the Blessed One remained for seven days in a single posture. He remained experiencing liberation and bliss.

Moreover, certain gods thought, "Does Siddhārtha surely still have something left to do? He has not given up his attachment to this posture," and doubts arose in them. The Teacher knew the doubts of the gods, and in order to calm their doubts he stood in the sky above and displayed a miracle. The miracle performed at the seat of awakening, the miracle performed at the time of the gathering with his kinsmen, and the miracle performed at the meeting connected with the Reading Sūtra all resembled the miracle performed with the mango keeper at the foot of the mango tree. In this way the Teacher performed such a miracle and calmed the doubts of the gods.

He stood in a posture to the northeast, and in that posture he contemplated the wisdom of omniscience. In the posture in which he fully realized the fruit of having perfected the perfections over four incalculable eons and a hundred thousand more, he gazed without blinking and remained there for seven days. At that place there arose the shrine called the Unblinking Shrine.

Then he made a walkway between the seat and the place where he had stood, and he remained for seven days walking back and forth, east and west, on a jeweled walkway. At that place there arose the shrine called the Jewel Walkway Shrine.

Further, in the fourth week, the gods created a jewel house to the northeast of the bodhi tree. Seated there in posture, he contemplated the entire Abhidharma Piṭaka, all of it in its infinite modes, and remained there for seven days. The Abhidharma masters, for their part, say: "'Jewel house' means a house made of jewels." The compilers, for their part, say: "It is the jewel house where he called to mind the Abhidharma of seven treatises." Since both of these statements are reasonable here, both should be accepted. Then that place in turn came to be called the Jewel House Shrine.

Having thus spent the fourth week close by the bodhi tree, in the fifth week he went from the foot of the bodhi tree to the goatherds' nyagrodha tree, and there too, reflecting on the Dharma, he remained experiencing liberation and bliss.

At that time Māra, the son of the gods, had been following him through all these weeks like a shadow, never leaving him in any direction. He did not see even the slightest fault in the bodhisattva. "Now he has passed beyond my control," he thought, and he became unhappy. Sitting on the great road, he

reflected on sixteen reasons and drew sixteen lines on the ground.

Thinking, "Because I did not perfect the perfection of generosity as he did, I have not become like him," he drew one line. Likewise, thinking, "I have not perfected, as he has, the perfection of moral discipline, the perfection of renunciation, the perfection of wisdom, the perfection of diligence, the perfection of patience, the perfection of truth, the perfection of resolve, the perfection of loving-kindness, and the perfection of equanimity. Therefore I have not become like him," he drew ten lines. Thinking, "Because I have not perfected, as he has, the ten perfections through which the uncommon wisdom that discerns the supreme and higher faculties becomes present, I have not become like him," he drew sixteen lines. Likewise, thinking, "Because I have not perfected, as he has, the ten perfections through which there become present the uncommon knowledge of dispositions and latent tendencies, the great compassion of wisdom, the wisdom of meditative attainment, the wisdom of the miracle, unobstructed wisdom, and the wisdom of omniscience, each in its own right, I have not become like him," he drew sixteen lines. Thus, reflecting on these reasons, he remained on the great road, having drawn sixteen lines.

At that time Tṛṣṇā, All-Delight, and Delight, the three daughters of Māra, said, "We do not see our father. Where is he now?" Looking about as they wandered, they saw him grown unhappy and drawing lines on the ground. They went up to their father and asked, "Father, why are you suffering and unhappy?"

"Daughters, this great ascetic has passed beyond my control. I have watched him all these weeks and have not seen even the slightest fault. That is why suffering and unhappiness have arisen in me."

"If that is how things are, do not think that way. We three will bring him under our control and lead him here."

He said, "Daughters, you cannot. No one can bring him under control, for this man abides in unshakable faith."

They said, "Father, we are women, so this very moment we will bind him with the noose of desire and lead him here. Do not worry."

Then those women went up to the Blessed One and said, "Ascetic, we will serve at your feet." The Blessed One paid no attention whatever to their words.

He did not even open his eyes to look at them. Just as he was, his mind liberated in the unsurpassed exhaustion of rebirth, he remained there, experiencing only the bliss of solitude.

Then the daughters of Māra said, "The minds of men have many inclinations. Some delight in young girls, some delight in women in the first stage of life, some delight in women in the middle stage of life, and some delight in women in the last stage of life. We shall make him attached through the allure of such various forms."

So each daughter emanated her own body in hundreds upon hundreds of forms, such as the form of a young girl. In the form of girls, in the form of young women, in the form of women who had borne a son or a daughter once, in the form of women of middle age, and in the form of stout matrons, six times they approached the Blessed One and said, "Ascetic, we shall serve at your feet." Again the Blessed One paid no heed to their words. Just as he was, he remained liberated in the unsurpassed exhaustion of rebirth.

Moreover, a certain teacher says this: "Possessing miraculous power, he looked at the women as they came, and the Blessed One transformed them into such forms, with their teeth fallen out and their hair turned white." His words should not be accepted. The Teacher did not transform them into such forms.

Rather, the Blessed One said, "What do you see, that you make such efforts? Go away now! Behaving in such a manner is fitting before those who are not free from desire and the like." For the Tathāgata has abandoned desire, abandoned aversion, and abandoned delusion; it was with regard to the abandonment of his own desire that he spoke:

"He whose victory none can undo,
he whom no one in this world can conquer,
the Buddha, whose range is endless, does not dwell there;
the trackless one is beyond the reach of those with tracks.

He who has drawn himself out of the net of existence,
in him there is no craving whatsoever.
In the Buddha, whose range is endless,
the trackless one is beyond the reach of those with tracks."

Having spoken these two verses from the Buddha chapter of the Collection of the Supreme Dharma, he taught the Dharma. The daughters said, "What our

father told us was true: the Arhat, the Sugata, is supreme among men in the world," and they went back to the god.

The Blessed One stayed here for seven days and then went to the place of Mucalinda. There, for seven days, in order to ward off bad weather and cold from his body, the nāga king called Mucalinda wrapped his body around him seven times and spread his hood over him. As though dwelling in a very spacious perfumed chamber, he remained for seven days experiencing the bliss of liberation, and then he went to the Rājāyatana tree. There too he remained, experiencing the bliss of liberation.

Thus, for the time being, seven weeks were completed. During that time he did not wash his face, did not tend to his body, and did not eat any food. He passed the days and nights in the bliss of meditative concentration, the bliss of the path, and the bliss of the fruit. Then, at the end of those seven weeks, on the forty-ninth day, while he stayed there, the thought arose in him to wash his face. Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, took a choice myrobalan fruit and offered it. When the Teacher ate it, his body was cleansed. Then Śakra himself offered a tooth stick of medicinal wood and water for washing his face. The Teacher took the tooth stick, cleaned his teeth, and washed his face with water from the great lake Anavatapta. Then he stayed right there at the foot of the Rājāyatana tree.

At that time two merchants called Trapuṣa and Bhallika were traveling with five hundred carts from the southern region to the Middle Country. A former relative of theirs who had become a god caused all the carts to sink so that they could not move, and through this the eagerness arose in them to give food to the Teacher. Taking cakes of pastry churned with honey, they approached the Teacher and stood before him, saying, "Venerable Blessed One, please, arousing great compassion, accept this food."

Since his bowl had disappeared on the very day he accepted the milk rice, the Blessed One thought, "Do the tathāgatas receive with their hands, or should one receive with a bowl?" Then, knowing his mind, the Four Great Kings of the four directions brought bowls of sapphire, but the Blessed One did not accept them. Then again they offered four bowls made of stone the color of mung beans. Out of compassion for the four sons of the gods, the Blessed One accepted the four bowls, stacked them one on top of another, and transformed them into one. So that all four could still be seen, four lines appeared at the rim, and they became a single bowl of medium size. In that bowl of priceless

stone offered to the Blessed One, he accepted the food in order to eat it, partook of it, and expressed his appreciation.

The two merchant brothers went for refuge to the Buddha and the Dharma and became lay followers of the twofold formula. Then they asked, "Venerable One, please grant us something worthy of veneration." He then stroked his head with his right hand and gave them hair relics. They carried them off to their own city and built a stupa.

Then the Perfectly Awakened Buddha rose from there and went once again to the Goatherd's nyagrodha tree, and sat at the foot of the nyagrodha. As soon as he had sat down there, he reflected on the profound Dharma that he himself had fully realized, and thought, "This which the buddhas have fully realized is the Dharma; others cannot teach it." And so there arose in him a thought inclining in that way.

Then Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, thought, "The world will be ruined." He led the Śakras, Suyāmas, Tuṣitas, Nirmāṇaratis, Paranirmitavaśavartins, and Mahābrahmās of the ten thousand world systems, went before the Teacher, and made this request: "Venerable Blessed One, please teach the Dharma! Please teach the Dharma in the former manner!" The Teacher granted them his consent.

He considered, "To whom shall I first teach the Dharma?" and the thought arose that the wise Ārāḍa would quickly understand this Dharma. Looking again, he realized that Ārāḍa had passed away seven days before. When he examined Udraka, he knew that he too had passed away. Thinking, "The monks of the group of five did me much service," he thought of the five and examined where they were staying. He knew that they were in the deer park of the city of Vārāṇasī. Thinking, "I will go there and turn the wheel of Dharma," he stayed for some days quite close to the seat of awakening, going for alms. Then, intending to reach the city of Vārāṇasī by the full moon of the middle summer month, at the end of the night of the fourteenth day, very early at dawn, he took up his alms bowl and outer robe and set out on the road, which was eighteen leagues long. On the way he saw an ājīvika called Upaka, and told him that he himself had become a buddha.

That same day, in the evening, he arrived at Ṛṣipatana. The Group of Five Elders saw the Tathāgata coming from a long way off, and they talked among themselves: "This ascetic Gautama, from eating a great deal, has become full in body and full in his faculties, and comes here golden in color. We shall not

bow to him or show him any such respect. Since he was born into a great family, it is fitting merely to prepare a seat. So a seat alone is appropriate."

The Blessed One possesses wisdom able to know the minds and conduct of the world with its gods. So, thinking, "What are these men thinking?" he knew their minds. Then, by a power unseen by any god or human, he gathered a mind of loving-kindness able to pervade everything, and by that unseen power the Blessed One meditated, pervading them with his mind of loving-kindness. As the Tathāgata drew near and arrived, they were unable to keep their earlier agreement, and they bowed to him and performed every attendance and service.

Moreover, because those monks did not know that he had become a perfectly complete buddha, when they spoke his name they addressed him with the ordinary word "āyuṣmān." Then the Blessed One said, "Monks, it is not proper to address the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, by name or with the ordinary word 'āyuṣmān.' Monks, I am the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha." Thus he established himself as a buddha. The Buddha sat on the excellent seat that had been prepared, and at the threefold conjunction of the supreme lunar mansion Bre, surrounded by a retinue of one hundred and eighty million Brahmās, he called the Group of Five Elders and taught them, through to the end of the Sūtra of the Turning of the Wheel of Dharma. Among them, the elder Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya, following the teaching, attained wisdom, and at the end of the sūtra the one hundred and eighty million Brahmās attained the fruit of stream-entry.

The Teacher spent the rainy season right there. Then on the second day, saying, "I shall give the Dharma to the elder Vāṣpa," he stayed in the monastery, while the remaining four went for alms. Within half a day the elder Vāṣpa attained the fruit of stream-entry. By this same method, on the following day the elder Bhadrika, on the next day the elder Mahānāman, and on the next day the elder Aśvajit were all brought to attain the fruit of stream-entry. Then, on the twentieth day, he taught the sūtras on the characteristic of selflessness to the five monks gathered together. At the end of the teaching the Group of Five Elders attained the fruit of arhatship.

Then the Teacher saw that Yaśas, a son of good family, would no longer rely on household life. That night, as Yaśas left his home with a mind full of suffering and went out, the Teacher called to him, "Yaśas, come here!" In that same part of the night he brought him to the fruit of stream-entry, and on the

second day he brought him to accomplish the fruit of arhatship. Moreover, his fifty-four friends then went forth, became monks, and attained arhatship. Thus there came to be sixty-one arhats in the world.

The Teacher completed the rainy season, held the invitation ceremony, and sent the sixty monks out in every direction. On the road by which he himself went to Uruvilvā lay the Kārpāsika grove, at a distance of ten leagues. There he tamed the Bhadravargīya youths. Of them, the very last became stream-enterers and the first became non-returners. He had them, too, go forth in the form of monks, sent them out in every direction, and went on to Uruvilvā.

With two thousand five hundred miracles to behold, he tamed the three brothers, Uruvilvā Kāśyapa and the others, together with a thousand matted-haired ascetics, and had them go forth in the form of monks. To those staying on the summit of Mount Gayā he taught the Sūtra of the Discourse on the Sun and made them arhats. Then, with those thousands of arhats as his retinue, intending to fulfill the promise he had given to King Bimbisāra, he went to the Yaṣṭivana grove near the city of Rājagṛha.

The keepers of the pleasure grove told the king, "The Teacher has arrived." When the king heard this, he went to the Teacher with a retinue of one hundred and twenty thousand brahmins and householders. The Tathāgata was seated, light like a golden canopy streaming out in every direction above the manifold wheel marks. The king bowed his head respectfully at the Tathāgata's feet, and then sat down to one side together with his retinue.

Then again the brahmins, householders and others came to think, "Has the great ascetic lived the holy life as a follower of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, or has Uruvilvā Kāśyapa lived the holy life as a follower of the great ascetic?" The Blessed One (the Buddha) knew in his mind the thoughts in their minds, and he spoke a verse to the elder:

Having dwelt at Uruvilvā, what have you seen?
What reason do you give for casting off the fire offering?
Kāśyapa, I ask you the meaning of this:
How is it that you have given up the fire offering?

The elder understood the Blessed One's intent, and replied:

Forms and sounds, and likewise tastes and smells,
And women and desires: these the sacrifices serve.

Having well understood that these are stains,
I have therefore given up this offering into fire.

When he had spoken this verse, in order to make clear that he himself was a disciple, he touched his head to the soles of the Tathāgata's feet and said, "Venerable Teacher, I am a disciple (śrāvaka) of the Blessed One." He rose into the sky to the height of one palm tree, of two palm trees, of three palm trees, and so on up to about seven palm trees, then came down, paid homage to the Tathāgata, and sat to one side.

Watching his miracle, the many people said, "How wonderful is the great power of the Buddha! Uruvilvā Kāśyapa held such a view and thought of himself as what is called an arhat, yet his net of views has been cut and he has been tamed by the Tathāgata." And so they spoke of the very qualities of the Teacher.

The Blessed One said, "It is not only now that I have tamed Uruvilvā Kāśyapa. In the past as well I tamed him." Having said this, he told of this matter as it happened in the past, in the birth story of Mahānārada Kāśyapa, and he clearly taught the Four Truths. At that very moment the king of the land of Magadha, together with a retinue of one hundred and ten thousand, attained the fruit of stream entry, and ten thousand became lay followers.

The king sat close to the Teacher, heard the five bases of training one by one, and went for refuge. Then he invited him as a guest for the next day's midday meal, rose from his seat, circumambulated the Blessed One, and departed.

Early the next morning, all who lived in Rājagṛha, both those who had seen the Blessed One and those who had not, people numbering eighteen koṭis, wishing to see the Tathāgata, went early in the morning from Rājagṛha to the Yaṣṭivana Grove. They could not fit within twelve krośas, and the whole of the Yaṣṭivana Grove was filled with an unbroken stream of people. All the people, gazing at the body of the one of ten powers, who had attained supreme form, could not have their fill of looking. Such was the color of the ground. In such a setting of form, all the sections on the Tathāgata's major marks, his excellent minor marks, and so forth deserve to be praised for the splendor of his form body. Thus, in order to see the body of the one of ten powers, who had attained supreme form, the crowds of people never thinned. In the park and on the road there was no chance for even a single monk to get out. On that day it seemed as though the time for the Blessed One's midday meal would pass.

At that very moment Śakra (Indra) noticed that the seat on which he sat had grown warm, and he investigated. Knowing the reason for it, he magically took on the form of a young brahmin and uttered praises fitting for each of the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. Going ahead of the one of ten powers, he opened a way by his divine power:

Tamed, together with his former companions, tamed,
With the brahmin matted-hair ascetics now liberated,
Coming forth in the form of a lion,
The Blessed One entered Rājagṛha.

Freed, together with his former companions, freed,
With the brahmin matted-hair ascetics now liberated,
Coming forth in the form of a lion,
The Blessed One entered Rājagṛha.

Ferrying across, together with his former companions, ferried across,
With the brahmin matted-hair ascetics now liberated,
Coming forth in the form of a lion,
Into Rājagṛha the Blessed One came.

The one of ten powers, who speaks the ten,
Skilled in the ten dharmas, abiding in the ten,
Accompanied by a retinue of ten thousand,
The Blessed One entered Rājagṛha.

With these verses he extolled the Teacher in praise. The people walking in front saw the splendor of the young brahmin's form and thought, "This young brahmin is extremely handsome. Yet we have never seen him before." And they said, "Where does this young brahmin live? Whose man is he?" Hearing this, the young brahmin said:

He who tames through all that he teaches,
The peerless person, the Buddha,
The Arhat, the Sugata in the world:
It is he whom I attend.

When he had spoken this verse, the Teacher, along the way that Śakra had opened, surrounded by a thousand monks, entered Rājagṛha. The king offered a great gift to the Saṅgha headed by the Buddha, and said, "Venerable One, I cannot remain apart from the Three Jewels. I wish to come to the Blessed One both in season and out of season. The Yaṣṭivana park is very far away. But this

place of ours called the Bamboo Grove is very near, so that going and coming are very easy. Since it is a place fit for the Buddha, I beg you to accept it."

He took a golden water vase, scented with the fragrance of flowers, and drew water the color of a jewel. Giving away the whole Bamboo Grove, he poured the water into the hand of the one of ten powers. When the park was accepted there, it was proclaimed "the foundation of the Buddha's teaching," and the great earth shook. In all of Jambudvīpa, apart from the Bamboo Grove, there is no other place whose acceptance made the earth shake. In the island of Siṃhala, apart from the Great Monastery, there is no other place whose acceptance made the great earth shake.

The Teacher accepted the park of the Bamboo Grove, expressed his rejoicing to the king, rose from his seat, and, surrounded by the Saṅgha of monks, went to the Bamboo Grove.

At that time Śāriputra and Maudgalyāyana, the two wanderers, were living near Rājagṛha, their minds set on seeking the deathless.

Among them, Śāriputra saw the elder Aśvajit on his alms round, and his mind became deeply serene. He offered him food, and when he heard the verse that begins, "Whatever phenomena arise from causes," he attained the fruit of stream-entry. He recited that same verse to his friend, the wandering ascetic Maudgalyāyana, and Maudgalyāyana too attained the fruit of stream-entry. The two of them then looked to the Victor themselves, and together with their followers they went forth in the presence of the Teacher. Of them, the great Maudgalyāyana attained arhatship after seven days. The elder Śāriputra attained arhatship after half a month, and both of them were established as the foremost among the Teacher's śrāvakas. On the very day the elder Śāriputra attained arhatship, the Blessed One held the first assembly of his śrāvakas. And the Tathāgata stayed on in that same Bamboo Grove.

At that time the great king Śuddhodana heard: "My son practiced austerities for six years, attained supreme and perfect awakening, turned the wheel of Dharma, and is now staying in the Bamboo Grove at Rājagṛha." He summoned one of his ministers and said, "Come here! Take a retinue of a thousand men, go to Rājagṛha, and say in my words, 'Your father, King Śuddhodana, wishes to see you.' Then bring my son back."

The minister said, "Your Majesty, I shall do so," and received the king's command upon the crown of his head. Taking with him that retinue of a thousand men, he quickly traveled the road of sixty leagues, and he entered

the monastery at the time when the One of Ten Powers was seated in the midst of the fourfold assembly, teaching the Dharma. Setting aside for the moment the business on which the king had sent him, he sat down at the edge of the whole assembly and listened to the Teacher's teaching of the Dharma. Just as he sat there, together with the thousand men he attained arhatship, and they asked to go forth. The Blessed One stretched out his hand and said, "Come here, monks!" On the spot all of them were holding alms bowls and the three robes produced by miraculous power, and they became like elders of a hundred years' standing.

From the moment they attained arhatship, they remained for the time being in equanimity, as those called noble ones do. The message the king had sent was not delivered to the One of Ten Powers. Not a single one of the men the king had sent came back, and no message was heard from them either. With the order, "Come here, you go!" he sent another minister. He went, and just as before, he and his retinue attained arhatship and remained without saying a word. In this way the king, issuing the same order, sent nine ministers, each with a retinue of a thousand men. All of them accomplished their own aim, fell silent, and stayed right there.

The king thought, "I have not had so much as word of a message." He reflected, "Because these men have no love for me, they do not report even so much as a message. Who would carry out my word?" When the king looked over all his people, he saw Kālodāyin. He was the minister who carried out all of the king's affairs, one of his inner household, and greatly trusted. He had been born on the same day as the Tathāgata, and he was his dear friend.

Then the king summoned the minister and said, "Son Kālodāyin, since I wished to see my son I sent nine thousand men, yet not one of them has come back, and there has not been so much as word of a message. Have they all been struck down by illness, or have their lives been cut short? While I am still alive I wish to see my son. Can you let me see my son?"

"Your Majesty, I can. Even if I go forth, I can let you see him."

The king said, "Son, whether you go forth or not, let me see my son."

Saying, "Excellent, Your Majesty," he accepted the king's command and went to Rājagṛha. At the time the Teacher was teaching the Dharma, he sat down at the edge of the assembly and listened to the Dharma, and together with his retinue he attained the fruit of arhatship, and each of them was established in the state of a monk.

In the first year after becoming a buddha, the Teacher spent the rainy season at Ṛṣipatana. After holding the invitation ceremony he went to Uruvilvā and stayed there three months. Having tamed the brothers who were matted-haired ascetics, he went, with a retinue of a thousand monks, to Rājagṛha on the full moon of the middle winter month, and stayed there two months. All this, from his leaving the city of Vārāṇasī until his arrival, took five months, and the whole winter season had passed. Seven or eight days had gone by since the elder Kālodāyin had arrived.

On the full moon of the first month of spring he thought: "The winter season is over and springtime has come. People have gathered in the crops, roads have opened up in every direction, and the grasses have turned green. The ground and the trees of the forest and the rest are bursting with countless flowers: it is the time for setting out on the road. It is the time to set out on the road to meet the relatives of the One of Ten Powers."

Then he approached the Blessed One and said:

"Venerable One, those trees have turned green;
the leaves of the trees bend down to the ground,
and from among them rays of light spread forth.
Great Hero, it is the time to go to your kinsmen's home.
It is neither too hot nor too cold,
and there is neither famine nor hunger.
The trees upon the earth have turned green:
Great Sage, this is the time."

With some sixty verses such as these he offered to the One of Ten Powers fitting praise, so that he would go to the city of his clan. Thus Kālodāyin, in a sweet voice, spoke to the Teacher praise fitting to his journey.

"Venerable One, your father, the great king Śuddhodana, wishes to see you, so I beg you to show kindness to your relatives."

"Excellent, Kālodāyin. I shall show kindness to my relatives. Tell the Saṅgha of monks. Tell them to put in order all the stopping places on the journey."

"Excellent, Venerable One," said the elder, and he went and told them.

The Blessed One set out from Rājagṛha with an assembly of monks whose defilements were all exhausted: ten thousand sons of good family who lived in the lands of Aṅga and Magadha, together with all ten thousand who lived in Kapilavastu. Traveling one league each day, he planned to reach Kapilavastu,

sixty leagues from Rājagṛha, in two months, and so he went at a moderate pace, neither slow nor fast.

The elder thought, "I shall go and tell the king that the Blessed One is coming." He went through the sky and arrived at the king's residence. When the king saw the elder he was delighted, and had him sit on a seat that had been prepared. He had food prepared just as it was made for himself, filled the bowl with food of many flavors, and offered it. When the elder thought to rise and leave, the king said, "Son, sit down and eat."

"Great king, I shall go to the Teacher and eat there."

"But son, where is the Teacher?"

"Surrounded by twenty thousand monks, he is coming in order to see you, great king."

The king was delighted and said, "Eat this. Then, until my son arrives in this city, take food from here in your bowl and go."

The elder heeded the king's words. When the elder had finished eating, the king washed the bowl, rubbed it with fragrant powder, and filled it with the finest food. Saying, "Offer this to the Tathāgata," he placed it in the elder's hand. As all the people watched, the elder tossed the bowl into the sky. He too rose into the sky, caught the bowl of food, and placed it in the Teacher's hands, and there the Teacher partook of the food. In this way the elder offered food every day, and throughout the journey the Teacher partook of the king's own midday meal. Each day, when the meal was over, the elder would say, "Today the Blessed One has come this far. Today the Blessed One has come this far." Recounting the true qualities of the Buddha, he brought the whole royal family to faith in the Teacher before they had even seen him.

For that reason the Blessed One said of the elder, "Monks, of my śrāvakas who inspire faith in families, the foremost is this one, Udāyin." Thus he was declared foremost.

The Śākyas, for their part, before the Blessed One arrived, gathered together, saying, "Let us see the chief of our kinsmen." They looked for a place for the Blessed One to stay and prepared the delightful park of the Śākya Nyagrodha. When everything there had been made ready, they went out to welcome him, each holding incense and flowers in hand. Adorned with every kind of ornament, the boys and girls of the city were sent ahead first, and after them came the princes and princesses; between them all, each made offerings of

incense, flowers, powders, and the like. The Blessed One accepted them and went to Nyagrodha Park. There, surrounded by twenty thousand monks whose defilements were exhausted, the Buddha sat upon the finest prepared seat.

The Śākya clan was proud, and they were harsh of mind. They thought, "This Prince Siddhārtha is young, and grew up along with us. We are his elder brothers. This one is a sister's son. This one is a grandson." So they spoke to the boys and the young princes, intending, "You do the bowing, and we shall stay behind you." They remained in that way.

The Blessed One saw their intention and thought, "Although my kinsmen do not want to bow to me, I must now make them bow. I must give rise to the basis of the higher knowledges, to wisdom, meditative concentration, and meditative attainment." He rose and went up into the sky. Then, as though the dust of his feet were falling on their heads, he performed a miracle equal to the miracle at the foot of the mango tree of the mango-keeper.

The king said, "I see a great wonder in this. Blessed One, on the day you were born, when the ascetic Kāla Devala bowed and came close to you, your feet moved and came to rest on the brahmin's head. When I saw that, I too bowed to you. That was my first bow. On the day of the auspicious sowing, while you sat on the splendid couch in the shade of the rose-apple tree, I saw that the shade of the rose-apple tree did not leave you, and then too I bowed at your feet. That was my second bow. Now, since I have seen a miracle I had never seen before, I bow at your feet. This is my third bow."

When the king had bowed to the Blessed One once more, there was not a single member of the Śākya clan who could keep from bowing. Every one of them bowed. Then, as his kinsmen bowed to the Blessed One, he descended from the sky and sat in the middle of the finest prepared seat. Once the Blessed One was seated among his assembled kinsmen, all of them remained with minds one-pointed.

Then from a great cloud there fell a rain like water that does not cling to a lotus petal. Copper-colored water fell, resounding on the ground. Those who wished to be wet were wet; those who did not wish to be wet were not, and not even a single drop fell on them. Seeing this, wonder and amazement arose in everyone, and they exclaimed, "How wonderful, how great a marvel! How wonderful, how amazing!"

The Teacher said, "It is not only now that, when I met my kinsmen, a rain fell like water that does not cling to a lotus petal. In the past, too, I made such a

rain fall." The story of this is told in the Viśvantara Jātaka.

When they had heard the Dharma taught, they all rose, paid homage, and departed. Of all those who left, the king, the viceroy and the ministers, not a single one said, "Tomorrow, come to my residence for alms."

On the second day the Teacher, with a retinue of twenty thousand monks, set out for alms in the city of Kapilavastu. No one invited him as a guest, and no one took his alms bowl. The Blessed One stood at the city gate and considered how the buddhas of the past had gone for alms when they came to the city of their own clan. Did they go, as they saw fit, to the houses of great men, or did they go for alms from house to house in order? He saw that not a single buddha had gone selectively as he saw fit, and so he thought, "I belong to this lineage. Just as this was the lineage of the former buddhas, I too shall uphold that lineage. My śrāvakas too will train after my example and go for alms in full." Beginning from the house where he stood, he went for alms from house to house in order.

People cried out, "The noble young Siddhārtha has come for alms!" In the mansions of two stories, three stories and more, they opened the upper windows, and everyone looked out. Queen Rāhula's mother also thought, "In this very city my noble lord once rode in a golden palanquin and the like, by the power of a great king. Now, from today, he has shaved his hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and goes for alms carrying a bowl in his hand. Is that beautiful or not?" She opened an upper window and looked. She saw him free from every kind of desire, perfectly ablaze, the light of his body illuminating the whole city above, surrounded on all sides by a radiance one fathom wide, utterly brilliant, possessed of the eighty excellent minor marks and adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being, the glory of a buddha shining forth beyond compare, from the crown protuberance on his head down to the soles of his feet.

The hair of his head curls to the right, soft, black and glossy;
His brow is stainless, like the disk of the sun.
His nose is high, in proportion to his body;
The lion among men sends forth bright rays of light.

With verses such as these she praised the lion among men. Then she told the king, "Your son is going for alms."

The king's mind was stricken with sorrow. Holding up his robes, he hurried out in great haste, stood before the Blessed One, and said, "Venerable one, why

do you go for alms and shame us? Did you think that I would not know how to provide food for these monks? What is this?"

"Great king, it is the custom of our lineage."

"Venerable one, we are of the lineage called the Śākya lineage. In it not a single kṣatriya has ever had so much as the name of going for alms."

"The lineage called the royal lineage, great king, is this lineage of yours." He declared, "Great king, do not be displeased. Our lineage, that of Dīpaṃkara, Kauṇḍinya and Kāśyapa, is the lineage of the buddhas. These and many thousands of other buddhas lived by going for alms." And standing right there in the middle of the street, he taught and explained this verse on the Dharma:

Not heedless, neglecting nothing,
One practices the Dharma and practices it well.
When one practices the Dharma, happiness arises,
In this world and in the next.

At the end of the verse the king attained the fruit of stream-entry.

One who practices the Dharma practices it well;
He does not practice what is wrong.
Through practicing the Dharma, happiness arises,
In this world and in the world beyond.

Having heard this verse on the Dharma as well, he attained the fruit of once-returning. Having heard the Jātaka of Dharmapāla, he attained the fruit of non-returning. And at the time of his death, as he lay on a splendid couch beneath a white parasol, he attained arhatship. The king had no need to dwell in the forest and practice austerities.

Having realized the fruit of stream-entry, the king once more took the Blessed One's alms bowl, invited him together with his retinue up into the great mansion, and served them choice food and refreshments. When the midday meal was over, all the royal ladies with their attendants came and paid homage to the Blessed One, all except Rāhula's mother. Moreover, when the people of her retinue told her, "Pay homage to the noble lord," she said, "If I have any virtue, the noble lord will come to my own dwelling himself. When he comes, I shall pay homage to him," and she did not come.

The king took the alms bowl, and the Blessed One, together with his two foremost śrāvakas, went to the princess's mansion. Saying, "Let the princess pay homage in whatever way she herself wishes, and let no one oppose her in

the slightest," he sat down in the middle of the excellent seat that had been prepared. She came quickly, clasped his ankles, laid her head upon his feet, and paid homage as she wished.

The king and the princess spoke of the Blessed One with great joy, praising him as endowed with good qualities and the like, and the king said, "Venerable one, from the time my daughter heard that you had put on saffron robes, she has worn saffron robes until this day. Hearing that you take your meal only once a day, my daughter too has eaten only once a day. Hearing that you had given up great couches, she sleeps on a small bed. Hearing that you are without craving for garlands of flowers, perfumes and the like, she too has given up attachment to garlands of flowers, perfumes and the like. When her relatives sent word, 'We will look after you,' she would not so much as look at a single kinsman. Blessed One, such are the virtues of my daughter."

He replied, "Great king, that is no great wonder. This princess, whom you now protect, protects herself even though her wisdom has not fully ripened. In the past, when she had no protector and wandered in the mountains and elsewhere, she protected herself even though her wisdom was not yet complete." Having said this, he told the Jātaka of Candakinnara, rose from his seat, and departed.

On the second day, Prince Nanda was to be consecrated as king, to enter a new house, and to take an auspicious bride, and he was there for it. The Blessed One went to his house and, intending to have him go forth, said, "Young man, hold this bowl." He spoke words of blessing, rose from his seat and left. Janapadakalyāṇī, the fairest maiden in the land, saw Nanda going. "Noble son, come back quickly!" she called, and watched him go. But he could not bring himself to hand the bowl back to the Blessed One, and so he went all the way to the monastery. There the Blessed One had him go forth, though he had no wish for it. In this way, after the Blessed One came to the city of Kapilavastu, he had Nanda go forth on the third day.

On the seventh day, Rāhula's mother adorned the boy with ornaments and sent him to the Blessed One. She told him: "Son, look at him, surrounded by a retinue of twenty thousand monks. This śramaṇa, golden in color, with a complexion like the form of Brahmā, is your father. He had great treasures, and since the day he left we have not seen those treasures. Go and ask him for your inheritance. Say to him, 'I am your son, the prince. Once I am consecrated as king, I shall rule as a universal monarch. Please give me

wealth, for I have need of it. The son is the owner of the father's wealth.'"

The boy went up to the Blessed One, and joy arose in him in his father's presence, and his heart was glad. "Śramaṇa, your shadow is pleasant," he said, and he went on saying many other things in his own way, and stayed close by. When the meal was over, the Blessed One gave his words of rejoicing, rose from his seat and left. The boy followed the Blessed One, saying, "Give me my inheritance, monk! Give me my inheritance, monk!" The Blessed One said, "Boy, turn back. Do not follow me." But those in attendance, who were walking along with the Blessed One, could not turn him back, and the boy went with the Blessed One all the way to the park.

Then the Blessed One thought, "He wants his father's wealth, but worldly wealth brings harm. If I now give the boy the sevenfold noble wealth that I obtained at the seat of awakening, he will become master of a wealth that transcends the world." With this in mind he called the venerable Śāriputra and said, "Therefore, Śāriputra, you must have the boy Rāhula go forth." And so Rāhula was made to go forth.

Then great sorrow over the boy arose in the king, and since he could not bear it, he went to where the Blessed One was. "Venerable noble one," he said, "it is not good to have a son go forth without the consent of his mother and father," and he asked for a boon. The Blessed One granted him the boon.

The next day, when the Blessed One had taken his meal at the king's palace, the king sat down to one side. The king said, "Venerable one, at the time when you were practicing austerities, a god came to me and said, 'Your son has died.' I did not believe his words. 'My son will not die before he attains awakening,' I said, and I rejected what he told me." The Blessed One said, "Why would you believe it now? Once before, even when you were shown bones and told, 'Your son is dead,' you did not believe it." The story behind this is told in the birth story of Mahādharmapāla. At the end of the talk the king was established in the fruit of the non-returner. Thus the Blessed One's father was established in each of the three fruits in turn, and the Blessed One, surrounded by the Saṅgha of monks, went once more to Rājagṛha and stayed in the Śītavana grove.

At that time the householder Anāthapiṇḍada brought five hundred cartloads of goods to Rājagṛha and went to the house of a dear friend of his. There he heard that the Buddha, the Blessed One, had appeared in the world. Very early in the morning, a door was opened for him by the power of the gods, and he

went to the Teacher, heard the Dharma, and attained the fruit of stream-entry. On the second day he offered a great gift to the Saṅgha headed by the Buddha. He obtained the Teacher's promise to come to Śrāvastī, and along the road between, forty-five yojanas long, he spent a hundred thousand at each stage and built a monastery at every yojana. He bought the Jetavana grove for one hundred and eighty million gold coins and began new construction. In the middle he built a perfumed chamber for the One of Ten Powers. Around it were the dwellings of the eighty great elders: single-storied and two-storied buildings, long halls, retreats and other dwellings, ponds, walking paths, night quarters and day quarters. Spending a further one hundred and eighty million in wealth, he built a monastery in a delightful place, pleasing to the mind. Then he sent a messenger to ask the One of Ten Powers to come. When the Teacher heard the messenger's message, he set out from Rājagṛha surrounded by a great Saṅgha of monks, and by stages he came to the city of Śrāvastī.

The great patron had made the great monastery ready, and on the day the Tathāgata arrived at Jetavana, he adorned his son with every ornament. He sent him off together with five hundred youths, all likewise adorned. The son and his companions carried five hundred banners blazing with cloth of five colors and went ahead of the One of Ten Powers. After them came his two daughters, Great Subhadrā and Little Subhadrā, with five hundred maidens, carrying in their hands vases filled with gold. After them came the merchant's wife, adorned with every ornament, with five hundred women, carrying great platters filled with gold. When all of them had gone ahead, the merchant himself put on fine clothes.

Likewise, wearing fine clothes, he went before the Blessed One (the Buddha) together with five hundred merchants. The Blessed One placed these lay followers of his retinue in front and was surrounded by the great Saṅgha of monks. With the radiance of his body, like a lump of refined gold, he lit up the whole grove. With the boundless play of a buddha and a buddha's splendor beyond equal and beyond compare, he entered the Jeta Grove.

Then Anāthapiṇḍada asked, "Venerable One, how should I offer this monastery?"

"Householder, offer this monastery to the Saṅgha of monks who come and who go."

"Excellent, Blessed One!" said the great merchant. He took up a golden ewer and poured water into the hand of the One of Ten Powers, and offered it with the words, "I give this monastery of the Jeta Grove to the Saṅgha of the four directions, headed by the Buddha, those who come and those who go." The Teacher accepted the monastery and expressed his rejoicing:

"Untroubled by cold and heat,
and likewise by wild beasts and the like,
by snakes and by gnats,
by frost and by rain;
and likewise by wind and fierce heat,
each of which assails the body,
one dwells within a house and happiness arises.
In the dwelling there are meditative concentration and insight.
Offering a monastery to the Saṅgha
is praised by the supreme Buddha.
Therefore the wise person,
for his own sake,
builds monasteries with joy
and lodges the learned there.
To them food and drink,
clothing, bedding and seats
he offers with an upright mind,
with a mind of perfect faith.
They then teach him the Dharma
for the stilling of all suffering;
whoever understands their Dharma
passes into nirvāṇa without support."

Thus were the benefits of a monastery explained.

From the second day onward, Anāthapiṇḍada began to give gifts. The mansion made of earth was completed in four months. Further, Anāthapiṇḍada's great monastery was completed in nine months. On the great monastery, eighteen thousand koṭis were spent. On this, on this great monastery itself, wealth amounting to fifty-four koṭis was spent in all.

Furthermore, in the past, at the time of the Blessed One Vipaśyin, a merchant called Friend of All bought the ground by covering it with gold in the shape of elephant footprints, and on this very place made a park for the Saṅgha one

yojana in extent. At the time of the Blessed One Śikhin, the merchant's son called Śrīvardhana bought the ground with an unbroken covering of golden plates, and on that very place made a park for the Saṅgha about twelve krośas in extent. At the time of the Blessed One Viśvabhū, a merchant called Auspicious bought the ground, ground covered with gold like golden footprints, and on that very place made a park for the Saṅgha half a yojana in extent. At the time of the Blessed One Krakucchanda, a merchant called Acyuta bought the ground with an unbroken covering as of golden bricks, and on that very place made a park for the Saṅgha four krośas in extent. At the time of the Blessed One Kanakamuni, a merchant called Ugra bought the ground with an unbroken covering as of golden tortoises, and on that very place made a park two krośas in extent. At the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, a merchant called Sumaṅgala bought the ground with an unbroken covering as of golden bricks, and on that very place made a park one krośa in extent. And again, at the time of our Blessed One, the merchant Anāthapiṇḍada bought the ground with an unbroken covering of eighteen koṭis of wealth made into pieces of gold, and on that very place made a park half a krośa in extent. This place is a place that no buddha has ever forsaken.

Thus, the account of all the places where the Blessed One himself dwelt, from the time he attained omniscient wisdom at the seat of great awakening until he finally passed into parinirvāṇa, is what is called the Proximate Introduction. In this manner he is praised in all the birth stories.

The explanation of the Introduction to the Birth Stories is complete.

It was translated, edited and finalized by the paṇḍita Ānandaśrī and the learned translator, the Śākya monk Nyima Gyaltsen Palsangpo, at the great monastery of glorious Tharpa Ling, the seat of translators.

May it be like the sun and moon upon the earth!

Translator's Notes

• The elder □□□□□□□□ is rendered Arthadarśin, the usual Sanskrit equivalent of the Tibetan. The brahmin □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, called Sumedha in the Pāli Jātaka introduction, is given in the standard Sanskrit equivalent Sumati. The city □□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("possessing fearlessness") corresponds to Amaravatī in the Pāli. Since the Sanskrit form behind this Tibetan cannot be fixed with confidence, the name is translated as "Fearless."

In one sentence the text reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("as the cause of buddhahood"). It has been read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the "Lineage of the Buddhas" (Buddhavaṃsa), which the text cites elsewhere in this passage.

The verse line □□□□□□□□□□□□□ could be read as "fourteen sounds." It is translated as "ten sounds," in line with the prose explanation that follows.

• In the jewel simile, "leaves them behind" renders a pronoun that most likely refers to the robbers, as in the parallel Pāli account of Sumedha, where the traveler parts from the robbers to save his goods. Grammatically it could also refer to the jewels.

• This piece corresponds to the Sumedha story of the Pāli Nidānakathā. In the opening prose the Tibetan literally reads that the five faults were "not turned away and not abandoned"; since the verse and the commentary both say the walking path was free of the five faults, the negation appears to be a scribal slip and the passage is rendered accordingly. In the explanation of the first fault, "hot and uneven" is read as "hard and uneven," matching the opening of that explanation. "The great elder Mahendra" renders "Wangchen," taken as the Pāli Mahinda; this identification is probable but not certain. Several sentences of the commentary are elliptical in the Tibetan and are rendered by their most likely sense.

• The commentary announces nine faults of the garment, but its list as it stands is not cleanly numbered and can be counted as eight or nine. It also announces the eight faults of the leaf hut, but then goes straight on to describe how he put on the ascetic's attire. Both are translated as they stand. "At a bend of the river" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, following the parallel Pāli phrase (nadīnivattana).

• The sentence "now it is right for me to cast off what passes for my solitude" renders the Tibetan as it stands; the sense in context seems to be that the comfortable hut undermines his solitude and must be given up. The Pāli parallel phrases this differently. The city name rendered "Delightful" corresponds to Rammavatī or Ramma in the Pāli Nidānakathā; since the Sanskrit form behind this Tibetan could not be fixed with confidence, the meaning has been translated. The creatures in the eighth fault ("lice, bedbugs and fleas") are approximate renderings of the Tibetan insect names.

• The two lines given in romanized form are a Pāli-style verse line kept in Indian script by the translators; they name flowers: campaka, sālala, nīpa, nāga, punnāga and ketaka. In the verse "I went forth from my own dwelling," the Tibetan reads literally "making my own dwelling"; the sense "leaving my hermitage" follows the parallel and the context. The monastery name rendered Sudarśana translates the Tibetan "beautiful to behold."

• "The city of Ramma" renders "the city of the joyful one" (dga' ba can), following the parallel Pāli account of Sumedha, where Dīpaṃkara visits Rammanagara. In the explanation of the eight conditions, the text reads sgyu ("deceit"), which makes no sense here; it has been read as rgyu, "cause," the third of the eight conditions. "The act of dedication" renders both rigs pa in the verse and gzhi in the prose, which correspond to the Pāli adhikāra, the act of service or self-offering to the Buddha.

• "Signs of suffering" renders the Tibetan as written. The parallel Pāli Nidānakathā speaks simply of the omens that appeared when former bodhisattvas sat in this way, so "of suffering" may be a transmission error. In the last verse the Tibetan reads "having cleared away my deeds." I have followed the evident reading "having made clear" (proclaimed) my deeds, in line with the Pāli parallel, where Dīpaṃkara proclaims Sumedha's deed and then lifts his right foot. Kolita and Upatiṣya, the earlier names of Maudgalyāyana and Śāriputra, are identified from that parallel.

• In the line "those dwelling in more than ten thousand worlds," the Tibetan reads "more than ten thousand" (□□□□□□□); the parallel Pāli speaks simply of the dwellers of the ten thousand worlds, and □□□ may be a slip for □□ ("the gods of the ten thousand"), but the reading as written makes sense and has been kept. Several portents in this Tibetan version differ from the Pāli Nidānakathā (for example, the great ocean "does not stir," and the "sickness of desire" is pacified); the translation follows the Tibetan as it stands.

• This passage parallels the Sumedha episode of the Pāli Nidānakathā, but this text gives

renunciation as the third perfection and wisdom as the fourth, and I have followed its order. The verse line rendered "Cherishing its tail, without anger" is terse in the Tibetan and its exact sense is uncertain. "Upon the grounds" may correspond to the "four stages" of the Pāli parallel, but the Tibetan gives no number.

• "Resolute determination" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□, corresponding to Skt. adhiṣṭhāna, the eighth perfection in the Jātaka list. The Tibetan □□□□□ normally denotes the lunar mansion Aśvinī; the Pali parallel speaks instead of the morning star (osadhī), but this text's own term has been followed.

• The city name □□□□□□□□ ("delightful") is taken as Ramma (Rammavatī), the city where Dīpaṃkara gave the prophesy in the Pāli Jātaka-nidāna, which this narrative closely follows. The unit of the earth's thickness is not stated in the Tibetan; "leagues" (yojanas) is supplied from the parallel. This text assigns giving up the body to the ordinary perfection and external possessions to the secondary perfection, the reverse of the usual Pāli scheme; the translation follows the Tibetan.

• The city □□□□□□□□ ("Joyful") is identified with Rammavatī, the city in the Buddhavaṃsa account where Dīpaṃkara met Sumedha. In the final verses, □□□□□□□□□ ("you") stands where the parallel Pāli has "they," and is kept as written. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□ is unclear. It is rendered "the going forth" following the parallel (sāmaññā, the state of a renunciant), but this is tentative. Likewise □□□□□ in "the multitude of people" seems to correspond to Pāli "by that means" and has not been rendered separately.

• The text follows the Pāli Nidānakathā closely, and names are given in Sanskrit forms matching that tradition. The same Tibetan name is rendered "Sumaṅgala" for Dīpaṃkara's chief disciple and "Maṅgala" for the later buddha, following the Pāli parallel. The attendant of Kauṇḍinya, literally "Unopposed," is given as Anuruddha after the Pāli; the fourth buddha, literally "Uncertain One," is given as Sobhita after the Pāli list. Both identifications are not certain. The city name, literally "Delightful," is rendered Ramyavatī (Pāli Rammavatī). The word rendered "cooking vessels" is obscure in the Tibetan and is read in light of the Pāli parallel.

• The Buddha called □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is identified as Maṅgala, the Buddha following Kauṇḍinya in the Nidānakathā, whose story this passage matches. The brahmin □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is given as Suruci, the bodhisattva's name in that parallel. "Mount Bhaga" is kept as the Tibetan spells it; the parallel has Vaṅka. The text gives the Saṅgha first as "a hundred thousand koṭis" and later as "a hundred koṭis"; both are translated as written. The obscure verb □□□□□ in the verse is rendered "delivers"; the Pāli parallel speaks of Dharma "well practiced."

• The Tibetan renders the Pāli name of the milk-rice gift (gavapāna) as "joy" plus a sound-spelling of pāna, apparently reading gava as "joy"; it is given here as gavapāna. □□□□□□□ is read as a slip for □□□□□□ "Sudeva", matching the parallel list for Maṅgala. The names of Sumanas's chief disciples and female disciples (□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□, □□□□, □□□□□□□□□□) are identified from the Nidānakathā parallel (Saraṇa, Bhāvitatta, Soṇā, Upasoṇā); the Tibetan renderings are interpretive, so these identifications are somewhat tentative. The text gives Sumanas's height as sixty cubits, though the Pāli parallel has ninety.

• Several names are identified from the corresponding Pāli list of past buddhas (Buddhavaṃsa / Jātaka-nidāna). Two city names could not be matched to the Tibetan with confidence and are rendered by meaning: "Excellent Revatī" (Tibetan nam gru bzang ldan; the Pāli parallel has Sudhaññavatī) and "Woolen Cloth" (Tibetan la ba can; the Pāli parallel has Candavatī). Nakulā (Tibetan rig ma), Rādhā and Surādhā (Tibetan dga' ma, shin tu dga' ma), and Nisabha (Tibetan nges bzang) follow the Pāli parallels, but the Tibetan renderings do not clearly correspond to those names. The tree srid sgrub kyi shing is taken as the arjuna tree, following the parallel. Numbers are given exactly as this text has them, even where they differ from the Pāli, for example Anomadarśin's first assembly and Padma's lifespan.

• This section parallels the Pāli Jātakanidāna and Buddhavaṃsa; buddha names are given in

their Sanskrit forms (Padma, Nārada, Padmottara, Sujāta, Priyadarśin, Dharmadarśin), with Sumati kept as already established for this buddha (Pāli Sumedha). Several names that could not be confidently identified are translated literally: the city "Endowed with Clarity" (Pāli Haṃsavatī), the mother "Excellent One" (Pāli Sujātā), the disciple "Divine Eye" (Pāli Devala), the bodhisattva "Supreme Body" (Pāli Uttara), and the city "Endowed with Mind" (Pāli Sudhañña). Niḥsaraṇa (Pāli Saraṇa) and Rāmā and Surāmā follow the Tibetan with the Pāli in view. The female disciples of Sujāta are written "glu ma" (singer) in the Tibetan; this is read as a slip for "klu ma" (nāga), giving Nāgā and Nāgamālā, as in the Pāli. The verse phrase rendered "far-reaching mind" corresponds to Pāli durāsada, "hard to approach."

• The Tibetan says Tiṣya and Puṣya appeared "ninety-two hundred thousand eons" ago, though Tiṣya's own prophecy in the same passage says ninety-two eons. It is translated as written. The buddha names Tiṣya and Puṣya, the disciple Puṣyadeva, and most other names are identified from the parallel list of buddhas in the Pāli Nidānakathā, which this text closely follows. Several names could not be securely matched to an Indian form and are translated by meaning: Well-Become (Siddhārtha's mother), Plentiful, Peace-Bringer and Steadfast (Siddhārtha's disciples), Faithful Folk (Tiṣya's father; the Pāli has Janasandha), Truly Supreme and Swift (Tiṣya's attendant and disciple), and Fearful (Puṣya's attendant; the Pāli has Sabhiya).

• This text is the Tibetan version of the Pāli Nidānakathā, and many names were rendered from Pāli forms, sometimes by misreading them. The incomparable nāga king corresponds to the nāga king Atula, meaning "Incomparable," in the Pāli. In the first verse the Tibetan reads "after the one who became," which makes little sense. It is taken here as a slip for the previous buddha's name, Puṣya (Pāli Phussa). The king "Lord of Sound" (Śikhin's era; Pāli Arindama) could not be identified and is translated literally. The phrase rendered "held the Buddha Jewel in deep reverence" literally reads "made a picture of the Buddha Jewel," apparently a calque of Pāli cittīkāra, "reverence." Viśvabhū's city, "Endowed with Mind" (Pāli Anoma), is translated literally. For Krakucchanda, the father's name is written "Midatta"; it is read as Agnidatta (Pāli Aggidatta), taking "mi" as a slip for "me," fire. The mother's name, "Companion" (Pāli Visākhā), is translated literally. The attendant is rendered following the Pāli Buddhija, although the Tibetan reads "the brahmin Lodrö." Kanakamuni's father appears as "Yakṣa," evidently a misreading of Yañña (Yajña)datta. The "city called Radiant" is translated literally. The assembly numbers, eons and heights are given as this text states them, even where they differ from the Pāli.

• This is the Tibetan version of the Pāli Jātaka introduction (Nidānakathā). Where the Tibetan has translated Pāli names word by word, the Indian name has been taken from the Pāli parallel. The Tibetan word forms are: "light-protector" for Jyotipāla, "maker of pots" for Ghaṭīkāra, "wealthy woman" for Dhanavatī, and "follower" and "thousand-increasing" for Anulā and Uruvelā. Two forms are less certain. "Endowed with fame" stands for the brahmin Akitti/Akīrti, although the literal sense is the opposite. "Great Viṣṇu" stands for Mahāgovinda, since govinda is an epithet of Viṣṇu. Other identifications are also somewhat tentative: "cause/sign" for Nimi, "supreme of the domain" for Visayha, "having discipline" for Śīlavat, and "without shrinking, enemy" and "like a victor" for Alīnaśatru and Jayadiśa. The list of buddhas omits Puṣya, as the Tibetan does. The syllable □□□□, in the list of eight factors and in the line on the Pure Abodes, is read as □□□□ "cause" (Pāli hetu); □□□□ "illusion" makes no sense there. "The act of dedication" renders □□□, corresponding to Pāli adhikāra. The verse on the regions between the worlds is rendered as closely as the Tibetan allows; it corresponds loosely to the Pāli on hungry ghosts and kālakañjika asuras.

• This text closely parallels the Pāli Nidānakathā, and several jātaka and hero names are identifiable only from their Pāli forms (Somanassa, Hatthipāla, Ayoghara, Cūḷasutasoma, Mahāgovinda, Kuddāla, Araka, Mahosadha, Sattubhasta, Senaka, Mahājanaka, Khantivādi, Mahāsutasoma, Ekarāja, Lomahaṃsa). I have used those Pāli forms rather than inventing

Sanskrit ones. The Tibetan renderings are often literal or mistaken: "Basket" for Sattubhasta ("bag of meal"), "goose feather" for Lomahaṃsa, and "Viṣṇu the Great" for Mahāgovinda.

In the Ekarāja verse the Tibetan reads "emptiness" where the Pāli parallel has "forest" (pavana). I have translated the Tibetan as it stands.

The Lomahaṃsa verse is obscure in the Tibetan, and its rendering is approximate.

The phrase rendered "in the world's name" probably reflects the Pāli name of the gods who make this proclamation, Lokabyūha. The description of the proclaiming gods as "people" going on the roads has been read as their going about the roads of humankind.

• The text speaks of "five characteristics" of the buddhas' teaching but then lists only three (impermanence, suffering, selflessness); this is translated as written. Several place names (Kajaṃgala, Sālavatī, Sautakarṇika, Kapa, Mount Uśīra) are given as the Tibetan spells or renders them; the Pāli parallel has Kajaṅgala, Salalavatī, Setakaṇṇika, Thūṇa and Usīraddhaja. "The great sāla trees" renders the Tibetan's reading of what in the Pāli is the place name Mahāsālā. The sentence about the Tuṣita gods passing away into a happy destiny is somewhat obscure; in the Pāli parallel it is an exhortation spoken to the departing god.

• "Bre" in "the most excellent asterism, Bre" is unclear as an asterism name; the parallel Pāli Nidānakathā has the conception under Uttarāṣāḍhā, which this phrase likely renders. The brahmins' clause "having turned back from the world, he will not be born again to dwell in a household" is rendered literally; it seems to reflect a loose rendering of the Pāli epithet "one who removes the veil in the world."

• "Caitraratha" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("grove of various chariots"), the celestial pleasure grove of that name. The Tibetan gives a leopard skin (□□□□) where the Pāli Nidānakathā has an antelope skin; the Tibetan is followed. □□□□□□□□□□ is identified as Kālodāyin (Pāli Kāḷudāyī), in line with the parallel list of those born together with the Buddha.

• The opening sentence continues the preceding list of things born simultaneously with the bodhisattva; the four measurements appear to refer to the four treasure urns, and "leagues" renders yojanas. Of the eight brahmins, "Mantrin" for the Tibetan "mantra-knower of the family" follows the Pāli parallel (Manti). "Possessor of Hands" is a literal rendering of a name I cannot identify with confidence; the Pāli list has Bhoja at this point, possibly read as bhuja, "arm". The phrase about the formless realm, "could not examine him," is literal; the Pāli sense is that buddhas could not reach him there to teach him.

• The text reads that each of the eighty thousand kinsmen resolved to give "a hundred sons," but the very next sentence has each give one son, as in the Pāli parallel; I have followed the evident sense "a son." The phrase rendered "passed on according to the deeds they had done" is unusual in the Tibetan; it appears to correspond to the Pāli statement that the seven brahmins went according to their karma.

• "Archers who shoot at a hair" reads □□□ "hair" for the written □□□□ "sibling," which makes no sense here; the parallel list of archers in the Pāli Nidānakathā supports this. The plant names sākala and kuba are given as the Tibetan spells them; their identification is uncertain. The phrase rendered "the largest" (□□□□□□□□ ... □□□□) is obscure; □□□□□□□ is taken as □□□□□□□ "creeper," in line with the Pāli parallel.

• The flowers kijalaka and guspyaka are given as the Tibetan spells them; they could not be identified with confidence. The phrase rendered "the fire of hatred" literally reads "the fire of fault," evidently translating Pāli or Sanskrit doṣa, which means both "fault" and "hatred"; the triad with desire and delusion makes the sense clear. "The people and the people's lady" renders the Tibetan literally; it likely stands for the wife of the inspired verse.

• The river □□□□□□□ is translated literally as "Mind-Endowed". In the Pāli Nidānakathā this is the river Anomā, but the Tibetan form is not a certain rendering of that name. The phrase

□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ in Māra's threat seems to be a slip for □□□□□□ ("at that time, I will know it") and is translated that way. "The supreme constellation" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) probably corresponds to Uttarāṣāḍhā, as in the Pāli account, but the Tibetan wording is unusual.
• The river's name, rendered "the Mindful," is the Tibetan's meaning-rendering. In the Pāli parallel it is the Anomā, and the Bodhisattva's reply plays on that name, so the wordplay is kept in English. The mango grove "Rejoicing" is identified with the Anupiya grove of the Pāli account. "Mount Paṇḍava" renders "Pale Mountain." The elephant "Wealth-Protector" is given as Dhanapāla. The text reads sgyu ma ("illusion"), which makes no sense here, so it is taken as rgyu ma ("intestines"), as the Pāli parallel confirms.
• The two teachers are given in an unusual Tibetan rendering ("Kun nas tshon dang Nag po can" and "'Char byed gser dang dGa' byed bu"); they are identified here as Ārāḍa Kālāma and Udraka Rāmaputra on the basis of the parallel account. The simile of the five monks is obscure in the Tibetan (literally "like water entering at each pore of the body becoming a drop of desire"); the Pāli parallel compares hoping for his success to wanting to wash one's head in a dewdrop, and the rendering follows that sense loosely. "Sūtra on Going Forth" corresponds to the Pāli Pabbajjā Sutta.
• The opening sentence continues the preceding account of the gods infusing nutritive essence into the food; "it" refers to that essence. The road width "eight times the distance at which a bull's bellow can be heard" corresponds to the Pali unit usabha (eight usabhas). The phrase rendered "he praised him at length" literally reads "praised with many," corresponding to the Pali account of praise in many verses.
• As the text stands, the southern rim both sinks and rises in the first episode and the northern rim both sinks and rises in the third, whereas in the western episode the opposite (eastern) side rises; the parallel Pāli Nidānakathā has the opposite side rise in each case. The translation follows the Tibetan as written. The grass-seller Svastika corresponds to Sotthiya in Pāli. The elephant name ("mountain girdle") and the nāga palace ("having flower-spikes") are identified with Girimekhala and Mañjerika from the Pāli parallel; the conch is rendered Vijayottara on the same basis.
• "Rain of sand" reads the evident □□ ("rain") for the written □□, which makes no sense here and is clearly a copyist's slip; the parallel showers in the passage all use □□. The "flowers of the lac tree" are probably kiṃśuka blossoms, as in the Pāli parallel. "Darkness of four kinds" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the traditional fourfold darkness. The "great gift of seven hundred of each of seven things" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, following the Pāli sattasataka-mahādāna. "Let the giving I did in other births stand aside for now" interprets the terse □□□□□□□□□□□□ ... □□□□□□□□□□□□ in the light of the Pāli parallel.
• The verse of the inspired utterance reflects the Pali "housebuilder" verse (Dhammapada 153–154), apparently read through misunderstandings: "poisonless" seems to render Pali anibbisaṃ as if from visa, "poison"; "the houseless" stands where the Pali has the housebuilder; and "bearing the name of poison" seems to come from visaṅkhataṃ. It is translated here as the Tibetan stands. The word rendered "light is rare" in the passage on the hells between the worlds is literally "rare." The Pali parallel says these hells had never been lit before.
• This is the Tibetan version of the introduction to the Pāli Jātaka commentary. "The Reading Sūtra" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□ literally. It appears to correspond to the Pāli account of the meeting with Pāṭikaputta, apparently misunderstood as pāṭha, "reading." "The mango keeper" corresponds to the Pāli Gaṇḍa, the gardener at whose mango tree the twin miracle was performed.

The second and third daughters of Māra, □□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□, are rendered by meaning as "All-Delight" and "Delight." Their Pāli counterparts are Arati and Ragā, but no Sanskrit form can be fixed with confidence from these Tibetan words.

The text says "sixteen lines" at both the eleventh-line step and the final step, where the Pāli parallel counts lines eleven through sixteen. This is kept as written.

• This passage parallels the Pāli Nidānakathā. "Aversion" renders □□□□□, literally "fault," evidently the translator's rendering of doṣa (Pāli dosa) as the second of the three poisons. The verses are Dhammapada 179–180 (Buddhavagga); the Tibetan last lines are terse, literally "the trackless cannot [prevail] over the tracked," and are rendered here according to their evident sense. "Cleaned his teeth" follows the evident reading □□□□□□□ for □□□□□□ ("rubbed the ground"). The final clause, literally "a thought of the kind that inclines," corresponds to the Pāli statement that his mind inclined toward not teaching.

• The account closely follows the Pāli Nidānakathā. □□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□ are taken as Ārāḍa (Āḷāra Kālāma) and Udraka (Uddaka Rāmaputta), the Bodhisattva's former teachers. □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the ājīvika Upaka, and □□□□□□ as Mahānāman. □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□, "licorice," that is, Yaṣṭivana, the Palm Grove. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ corresponds to the Pāli Ādittapariyāya, the "Fire Sermon." The Tibetan reads "sun," probably from a confusion of āditta, "burning," with āditya, "sun," and the translation keeps the Tibetan. The phrase about Yaśas, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is uncertain. It may reflect upanissaya, "supporting condition," with an anomalous negative. The number of miracles is 2,500 as written, where the Pāli has 3,500.

• This passage follows the Pāli Jātaka introduction (Nidānakathā). The phrase rendered "to make clear that he himself was a disciple" reads literally "to dispel the wish of a disciple"; the parallel ("to make known his discipleship") suggests reading gsal ("make clear") for bsal ("dispel"). The name rendered Mahānārada Kāśyapa (Tibetan "great man-giver Kāśyapa") is identified from the Pāli Mahānāradakassapa Jātaka. The grove rendered Yaṣṭivana (Pāli Laṭṭhivana) is identified from the parallel; the Tibetan name is literally "grove of sweet wood". The "form of a lion" in Śakra's verses and "ten thousand" in the fourth verse reflect this text, not the Pāli (golden-hued; one thousand).

• The sentence about the arhats remaining "in equanimity, as those called noble ones do" renders a terse Tibetan phrase, literally "the so-called noble ones remained in the middle for the time being." In the parallel Pāli Nidānakathā this is the saying that noble ones are impartial or indifferent, which explains why the arhat envoys did not deliver the king's message.

• The jātaka title is written □□□□□□□□□□□□, which makes no sense as it stands; it is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□, the standard Tibetan rendering of Viśvantara (Pali Vessantara), which matches the parallel Nidānakathā. Likewise □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "not only now." The elder is Udāyin (Kāludāyin), named here by the Tibetan □□□□□. The "mango-keeper's mango tree" corresponds to the Gaṇḍamba tree of the Pali tradition, the site of the twin miracle. The Tibetan does not name the keeper, so the phrase is translated literally.

• The Tibetan calls Rāhula's mother "the king's daughter" (bu mo); in the parallel Pāli account she is his daughter-in-law. The passage is translated as written. The two jātakas named correspond to the Pāli Mahādhammapāla and Candakinnara Jātakas.

• The words to the Buddha read literally "That śramaṇa, your shadow is that," which makes little sense; I have read them as "Śramaṇa, your shadow is pleasant," taking de'o as a slip for bde'o and des as a slip for the vocative. This is the reading of the parallel Pāli Nidānakathā. "The fairest maiden in the land" is taken as the standard rendering of Janapadakalyāṇī, the name of Nanda's bride in that parallel. Great Subhadrā and Little Subhadrā translate the Tibetan; the Pāli calls them Mahāsubhaddā and Cūḷasubhaddā.

• The merchants under Vipaśyin and Viśvabhū, called "Friend of All" and "Auspicious," could not be matched with confidence to Sanskrit forms; their names are translated by meaning. The Pāli parallels are Punabbasumitta and Sotthiya. The phrase rendered "made into pieces of gold" is uncertain; the Pāli parallel has coins (kahāpaṇas). The figures for cost, measure and duration, and the "mansion made of earth" completed in four months, are translated exactly as

this Tibetan gives them, though they differ from the Pāli Nidānakathā. "Proximate Introduction" renders the Pāli santike-nidāna, the third section of the Jātaka introduction.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.